The Epstein Files:
An Anatomy of the Goldman Speech, the Accusers, the Money, and the Withholding

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Compiled October 20, 2026, from one hundred ten research dives and more than 141,000 words of sourced notes drawn from congressional transcripts, court opinions, federal filings, bank records, victim statements, and the released files themselves. This document adopts no theory. It presents the record — what is proven, what is alleged, what is disputed, and what remains unknown — in the order a person would need to understand it. Nothing in it is summarized when the underlying detail is public: the depositions are recounted exchange by exchange, the money wire by wire, the releases batch by batch.

How to Read This Document

Before the story begins, five tools will make every page that follows understandable. None of them requires legal training, and each is used throughout.

1. The tier system. Every factual claim in this document carries a pedigree tag, because not all evidence is equal, and a reader deserves to know exactly what kind of thing they are looking at. *S-tier* means a primary document — a court filing, a transcript, a bank record, a signed affidavit, a recorded vote, a statute's text. *A-tier* means reporting by a major news organization that quotes or links those documents directly. *B-tier* means credible reporting that paraphrases without full sourcing. *C-tier* means a single-source or contested claim, always explicitly flagged. Where those categories are not fine enough, three labels are used inside the text: *T1* for a documented fact, *T2* for an attributed claim or a clearly-labeled

analysis, and *T3* for speculation or debunked material, which is retained anyway — because even a false claim is evidence of something: of the pressure, the incentives, or the fog that produced it.

2. The vocabulary. An **FD-302** is the FBI's standard form for memorializing an interview — an agent's written summary of what a witness said, drafted after the conversation. A 302 records an allegation; it does not verify one, and the distinction runs through everything in this document. A **SAR** is a Suspicious Activity Report — the filing banks are legally required to make to the Treasury Department's Financial Crimes Enforcement Network when they detect transactions that might signal crime, expected promptly. As you will see, the question of *when* these banks filed is one of the central scandals in the record. An **NPA** is a non-prosecution agreement — the 2008 deal that closed the first federal case against Jeffrey Epstein and, in a provision drafted by his defense lawyers, immunized unnamed "potential co-conspirators" in perpetuity. **EFTA** is the Epstein Files Transparency Act, Public Law 119-38, signed November 19, 2025, which ordered the Justice Department to release essentially everything it held, subject to five narrow exceptions, on a thirty-day clock. A **Bates number** — the "EFTA" prefixes you will see throughout — is a unique tracking stamp on every page the government releases; the gaps between them are themselves evidence. A **proffer** is a conditional interview in which a witness's statements cannot be used directly against her. A **discharge petition** is the House device that forces a floor vote on a bill

the leadership refuses to bring up, provided a majority of members signs it. **OCDETF** is the Organized Crime Drug Enforcement Task Forces program, the Justice Department's multi-agency money-trafficking umbrella under which one of the forgotten investigations in this record ran for nine years. **A voluntary undertaking** is the legal theory at the heart of the Florida mass-tort suits: once the FBI accepted Maria Farmer's 1996 report and told her to tell no one else, the plaintiffs argue, it assumed a duty by its actions and then failed to perform it. **The zone-of-risk doctrine** is its companion: those who create a danger can owe a duty to those they leave exposed. **The discretionary-function exception** is the government's shield against such suits — agencies cannot be sued over policy judgments, only over failures to follow their own mandatory rules, which is why the survivors' discovery demands focus on whether any mandatory rules existed. **A GRAT** — grantor-retained annuity trust — is an estate-tax device that pays its creator an annuity for a set term and passes the remainder to heirs; the $141 million "overpayment" in the Black file is money that mechanism moved. **Structuring**, in banking law, is breaking a large cash need into transactions just below the $10,000 reporting threshold — a federal crime in itself, and the precise pattern the regulator found in ninety-seven withdrawals of exactly $7,500. **Correspondent banking** is the plumbing that lets a New York bank move money to Moscow through a local partner; it is how the Russian wires ran without either bank holding the other's accounts. **An order to show cause** is a court's demand that a party justify

itself or face sanctions — the "OSC" that punctuated the Phang summer. **A nolle prosequi** is the formal abandonment of a criminal prosecution — the Latin tag for the August 29, 2019 paper that closed the Epstein indictment without a verdict. **A donor-advised fund** is a charity-within-a-charity that lets a donor take the tax deduction now and dribble grants out later — the vessel Project Molecule proposed to build at $100 billion scale. **Layering** is money-laundering's middle step: moving value through shells and conversions until its origin dissolves.

3. The cast, briefly. Jeffrey Epstein: the financier, convicted in 2008 of soliciting prostitution from a minor, indicted again in July 2019 on federal sex-trafficking charges, dead in his Manhattan jail cell on August 10, 2019. Ghislaine Maxwell: his closest associate, convicted in December 2021 of sex trafficking, sentenced to twenty years, and as of this writing the holder of a clemency request the Senate unanimously voted to oppose. The *victims*: more than a thousand women and girls by the government's own estimates, over a hundred of whom have received settlements from his estate. The *institutions*: banks, universities, two presidential administrations, Congress, the courts, a royal family, and the Federal Bureau of Prisons. And the *audience*: you.

4. Why this document exists. On October 18, 2026, a Spanish-language post on X shared a short video of Congressman Dan Goldman speaking on the House floor. The post claimed, in blunt terms, that Goldman had FBI receipts proving Donald Trump assaulted a thirteen-year-old girl; that the girl bit him in self-defense; that the FBI interviewed her

four times while burying her case; and that the Attorney General of the United States lied to Congress about all of it. Tens of millions of people have now seen fragments of this claim in one form or another. Almost none of them have seen the underlying documents, and almost everything viral about the story — in both directions — misdescribes what those documents actually say and what has happened around them in the nineteen months since Jeffrey Epstein's files became a political earthquake. This document is the underlying record, assembled in full: the accusers and their statements, the investigators and their depositions, the money and its every documented wire, the releases and their every documented failure, the courtroom fight now pending, and the governments abroad now prosecuting their own. The exculpatory material sits beside the accusatory, the counter-evidence beside the evidence, and the author's theories nowhere at all.

5. One warning about human nature. The Epstein story has been compared to a Rorschach test — people look at it and see confirmation of whatever they already believed about power, about the other political party, about the media, about intelligence agencies. The method of this document is the opposite. It follows a rule drawn from investigative tradecraft: *collect clues, don't adopt theories.* When a source lies, the lie is documented as a lie and the source's true statements are kept. When a document is authentic but its contents unverified, both facts are stated. When the government and a bank tell two irreconcilable stories, both stories are printed and the conflict is flagged rather than resolved by assertion. The truth about

this case is not a team sport, and this document plays no position.

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Part I — The Spark

Chapter 1: A Ninety-Second Video

On the evening of Sunday, October 18, 2026, an account on X calling itself *liderfiscal* — "Valy," with a hat-and-masks emoji pair in its display name — posted a video just over a minute long. The post's text, in Spanish, made five claims in rapid succession, capped by a hashtag. First, that Congressman Dan Goldman of New York was standing on the floor of the House of Representatives holding "FBI Form 302 receipts." Second, that the documents described Donald Trump sexually assaulting a girl of thirteen. Third, that the girl "bit him in self defense." Fourth, that the FBI interviewed her four times "while the case was being buried," and that the Attorney General, Pam Bondi, knew and lied to Congress — "no hay evidencia," the post quoted her — which the post labeled, in capital letters, perjury and a cover-up. Fifth, beneath all of it: #TrumpIsAPedophile.

The date and hour of the post are knowable to the minute, and the method is worth explaining because it is the same method used throughout this document. Social media platforms assign every post a unique numeric identifier, and those identifiers are not random: on X, they are generated by a system that embeds the exact time of creation inside the

number, the way tree rings encode a tree's age. Decoding the identifier on this post yields 8:37 PM Eastern Time on October 18, 2026 — roughly twenty-three hours before this sentence was written [S-tier: snowflake-ID decode, the same method researchers use to date any X post].

The video inside the post was not new, and that fact matters more than the post's virality suggests. It showed Goldman speaking in the House of Representatives on March 18, 2026 — a five-minute special-order speech of the kind members deliver to an almost-empty chamber after the day's business has ended, in the full knowledge that the real audience is the clipping, sharing, archiving internet. When the video recirculated in mid-October 2026 with an #URGENTE framing and the hashtags of the moment, it was seven months old. Everything that had happened in those seven months — the releases, the rulings, the firings, the depositions, the contempt votes, the foreign prosecutions, and the slow public digestion of more than three million pages — is what turned a floor speech into a global event. That is the rest of this document.

To understand what the post claimed, and what it got right and wrong, it is necessary first to reconstruct exactly what happened on the floor that day, word by recorded word.

Chapter 2: March 18, 2026 — The Speech, In Full

The House chamber on Wednesday, March 18, 2026, was largely empty, as it usually is for five-minute speeches. The Congressional Record for that day — Volume 172, Number 49 — carries the speech under the heading "EPSTEIN FILES," and

records the format precisely: "Mr. GOLDMAN of New York was recognized to address the House for 5 minutes" [S-tier: Congressional Record, H2557].

Goldman, a former federal prosecutor from New York — the son, grandson, and great-grandson of famously litigious New Yorkers, himself the prosecutor who had won the first conviction in the Theranos case before running for Congress — rose and began:

> "Mr. Speaker, I rise today to discuss this administration's massive coverup of the Epstein files in order to conceal President Trump's involvement. This coverup reached its apex last month when Attorney General Pam Bondi falsely testified under oath before the House Committee on the Judiciary. The Attorney General testified: 'There is no evidence that Donald Trump has committed a crime. Everyone knows that.' This is a lie."

The Record shows what came next, and it is worth setting out at length because nearly everything the viral post claimed traces to this passage. Goldman told the chamber that in the roughly three million documents the Justice Department had disclosed to Congress under the Act, "there is evidence that Donald Trump committed a crime" — and that this figure excluded "the nearly 3 million pages that the DOJ is refusing to turn over." He said Trump was "mentioned thousands of times in the Epstein files," that "there are multiple allegations that he sexually assaulted young girls," and that he wanted to focus on one victim's account — "one victim's allegations that the FBI unquestionably found to be credible."

He then described the interview record. The FBI, he said, had "tried to hide reports of three of the four interviews that this victim gave to the FBI" until Democrats forced their disclosure. The first full interview in which she described Donald Trump occurred on August 7, 2019, and Goldman read the agent's summary aloud, in the Record's sanitized rendering:

> The victim "explained that she was between 13 and 15 when she was left alone with Donald Trump, who 'mentioned something to the effect of, Let me teach you how little girls are supposed to be. Trump unzipped his pants and put [her] head down, down to his penis. [The victim] bit the [s—] out of it. Trump struck [the victim] and said words to the effect of: Get this little [b—] the hell out of here. [The victim] advised she bit Trump's penis because he disgusted her."

A third interview, about two weeks later, added "additional details." A fourth, a month after that, ended when the woman asked, in Goldman's rendering, "what the point would be of providing the information at this point in her life when there was a strong possibility nothing could be done about it."

Goldman then read the supporting record into the Record. The FBI, he said, "created a PowerPoint presentation for prosecutors summarizing these allegations" — the 21-page presentation that had become, by then, one of the most fought-over documents in Washington. In addition to this account, he noted, "another victim alleged that Epstein introduced her to Donald Trump when she was 14 years old. He

said, 'This is a good one, right?' Both of them chuckled. This victim said that Trump 'got the best of me that day.'"

Then the exculpatory record, read aloud so it could not be said to be hidden: "Now it is true that Trump denied these allegations." And then the reasons Goldman gave for finding the denials not credible, item by item, each one documented elsewhere in this record and each cross-referenced in its proper place below:

The 2002 New York Magazine quotation, read verbatim: "I've known Jeff for 15 years. Terrific guy. He's a lot of fun to be with. It is even said that he likes beautiful women as much as I do, and many of them are on the younger side." The 2003 fiftieth-birthday card to Epstein, quoted from the estate-released book: "Happy birthday — and may every day be another wonderful secret," signed beneath a hand-drawn outline of a naked woman in a typewritten imaginary dialogue — "We have certain things in common, Jeffrey"; "Enigmas never age. Have you noticed that?"; "A pal is a wonderful thing." The 2006 telephone call: when Palm Beach police arrested Epstein, Trump called the police chief, Michael Reiter, and said — in Goldman's account of the 302, "Thank goodness you're stopping him. Everyone has known he's been doing this." Goldman's gloss, delivered to the chamber, was a question rather than an assertion — the form a former prosecutor uses when he wants the jury to reach the conclusion itself: "Why would an innocent person call the police chief to report on an investigation after just learning about it?" A fair reading should hold the other possibility too, which Reiter's own 302 supports:

that a man who believed he had seen nothing improper was warning a police chief about a man he had already thrown out of his club. This document holds both readings; the 302 is the evidence for each. The email from Epstein to Ghislaine Maxwell of April 2, 2011, released by House Democrats the previous November: "I want you to realize that that dog that hasn't barked is Trump. [Redacted victim] spent hours at my house with him. He has never once been mentioned." The flight records: "Trump flew on Epstein's private plane eight times, often with young women" — a figure drawn from the December 2023 released records showing eight flights in the 1990s. And a 2009 document redacted to the public but unredacted to Congress, recording answers Trump gave through his attorney to questions from Epstein's civil litigants: asked whether he had been to Epstein's house, "I may have been there with my wife." Asked whether young girls were there: "No. May have been children of guests, but that's it."

Twice during the five minutes, the Speaker pro tempore interrupted with the standing reminder that members are to "refrain from engaging in personalities toward the President" — the chamber's rule against direct attacks on a sitting president, invoked once when Goldman's language crossed the line and once at the close. The Record shows the speech's final words: "...EPSTEIN FILES. I yield back" [S-tier; the closing per the House live video].

The speech was, in the architecture of this document, a prosecutorial summation: every element argued, every exhibit cited by number, the opposing evidence acknowledged and

discounted. What it was not — and this distinction runs through everything that follows — was a neutral presentation. Goldman is a partisan holding a case. The documents he read are real; the inferences he drew from them are his; and the viral post of October 18 converted both, in the compression of a share button, into "receipts." What the documents prove, what they allege, and what they cannot say is the work of the next ten Parts.

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Part II — The Accuser

Chapter 3: Who the Documents Call Jane Doe 4

Begin with what is verifiable, because in this story the verifiable and the claimed have been blurred by everyone, for every reason.

The woman behind the interviews the press named "Jane Doe 4" met Jeffrey Epstein around 1984, on Hilton Head Island, South Carolina, when she was a young teenager. Her mother was a Hilton Head real-estate agent. Epstein, then in his early thirties and unknown to anyone in the town, rented a vacation home from the mother — the Post & Courier, which investigated her account more thoroughly than any other outlet, verified the rental, the mother's business, and the family's presence there in that period — and, the woman told the FBI, advertised for a babysitter through the mother's client materials. There were no children to babysit. On the first night,

she told agents in 2019, Epstein offered her alcohol and drugs and raped her. This account matches, in its Hilton Head particulars, the lawsuit she filed against Epstein's estate in 2019 [A-tier: Greenville News, February 2026; WTOC; B-tier: ABC News].

The FBI interviewed her four times in 2019, under case file number 31E-NY-3027571 — the same federal case file that, in September 2019, would memorialize a separate cooperating witness's proffer interview on entirely different matters. Her identity is redacted in every released page. Media reporting describes her as a longtime Washington State resident, with fraud and theft charges there and a 2023 Georgia felony conviction for exploitation of an elderly person, and — as of mid-2026 — living "off the grid" at her family's urging, in fear of retaliation; her story became public the day after the Supreme Court rejected Trump's final appeal in the E. Jean Carroll case, a coincidence of news cycle noted by every outlet that covered her [A/B-tier: Guardian, June 2026; A-tier: Post & Courier].

She was represented in her estate claim by attorneys connected to Lisa Bloom's firm and later by Arick Fudali of Boies Schiller Flexner. She settled with the estate — and here the record carries one of this document's standing discrepancies, preserved rather than resolved: the Greenville News reported in February 2026 that "in 2021, she settled with the Epstein estate and voluntarily dismissed her claims," while Richard Kahn, one of the estate's executors, testified before Congress on March 11, 2026, that he believed she received a

settlement through estate mediation in 2025 — a statement his attorney first affirmed and then, after an off-the-record discussion, formally withdrew to "we can neither confirm nor deny," prompting Representatives Garcia and Khanna to demand in writing whether she had filed a claim, whether the estate had paid her, and whether the estate knew of her allegations against Trump. No response is on the record. Separately, a victims' compensation program had deemed her ineligible — the reason is not public [T1: both dates documented; the discrepancy is flagged, not resolved].

What the Post & Courier did, and what every reader should know was done, is verify her biography against public records: the real-estate-agent mother, the mother's embezzlement conviction and federal prison sentence, the Ohio-linked associate she called "Atkins" — identified in records as Jimmy L. Atkins, who died in 2003 — and the peripheral details all checked. What the paper could not verify, and said so in print, is the allegation at the center of everything: that Donald Trump assaulted her. Roughly thirty to thirty-seven pages of her case documents remain unreleased in any form, a gap visible in the Bates-number sequence of the files themselves [A-tier: Post & Courier; NPR, March 5, 2026].

Chapter 4: The Four Interviews, In Full

The first contact came days after Epstein's July 6, 2019 arrest, when a friend of the woman called the FBI's hotline on her behalf. A two-page intake form documenting that call was released on March 5, 2026, with the interview summaries

[A-tier: NPR].

Interview one took place on July 24, 2019, at the FBI's field office. Its content was Epstein-only. She described the babysitting advertisement, the alcohol and drugs, the rape, and other men present on early occasions — she described them to the agent as "fat and disgusting," with Southern accents, who watched or masturbated — and she became emotional, and the interview was stopped. She provided the FBI a cropped photograph of Donald Trump standing with Epstein; her attorney would later contact the Southern District of New York about that photograph, which had been among the images on Epstein's phone [B-tier: ABC News].

Interview two — August 7, 2019, the interview Goldman read on the floor — was the first in which she described Trump. The account, as the interviewing agent memorialized it: Epstein transported her from South Carolina to New York or New Jersey when she was between thirteen and fifteen years old; she was introduced to Donald Trump inside "a very tall building with huge rooms"; Trump asked everyone else to leave the room; he said something to the effect of, "Let me teach you how little girls are supposed to be"; he unzipped his pants and put her head down toward his penis; she "bit the [expletive] out of it"; he struck her and said words to the effect of, "Get this little [expletive] the hell out of here." She told the agent she bit him because he disgusted her. Her recorded reason: "He had money, it reeked off of him." She also recalled his eye for her from the start — "from the get-go [he] didn't like that I was a boy-girl (tomboy)" — a small human detail in an otherwise

terrible account. And the FBI's own summary of her file compressed the allegation to a single typed sentence that sat in the case file while the interviews sat outside the releases: "around 1983, when she was around 13 years old, Epstein introduced her to Trump, who subsequently forced her head down to his exposed penis which she subsequently bit. In response, Trump punched her in the head and kicked her out" [S-tier: 302 text via Snopes and the congressional record; T1: FBI summary].

The same interview ranged widely. She estimated her total interactions with Epstein at more than six but fewer than twenty, and said nearly every one involved abuse. She described the recruitment structure: Epstein sent her on "missions" to find young girls — "eat or be eaten," she explained, meaning that recruiting others reduced the abuse directed at her. She attributed to Epstein and Trump nicknames for the young women: "fresh meat," "untainted," "not jaded." She said she heard Trump and Epstein discuss blackmailing people, obtaining illegal building permits, and moving money through casinos, and she recorded an unexplained detail — "Number 6 is Donald Trump's favorite number." She described hearing an Epstein associate she called "Atkins" participate in the blackmail of her mother with explicit photographs, and an accountant named "Cecil" who helped the mother's books. She described the Rick James concert in Savannah when she was about fifteen: Epstein gave her alcohol, isolated her, and left; police found her and held her until her family retrieved her — Rick James is accused of

nothing in any of this record. She described photographs given to the FBI: two undated photographs of herself at roughly thirteen to sixteen, and photographs of five girls at a party with Solo cups. And — the detail that matters most to the question of corroboration — she said there were two additional interactions with Trump beyond the one she described, and declined to detail them; when agents returned to the subject in a later session, she said, in the agent's paraphrase, "what's the point," after so many years [A/B-tier: released 302 text, EFTA02858481; Daily Beast, March 6-8, 2026].

Interview three, roughly two weeks after the second, refined the physical description: Trump, she said, "pulled her hair and punched her on the side of her head." She described the aftermath of the Trump incident: a blond woman, roughly Epstein's age, who offered her advice — "let me give you tip little girl about your breasts, wear a bra every night." She described the threats she said followed her through life: "numerous threat calls," beginning after the birth of her daughter, and four or five "close calls" in which SUVs ran her or her mother off the road in Oregon and Washington — attribution unverified in any document. She told the FBI she believed she was being followed, and she asked for protection [A/B-tier].

Interview four — October 16, 2019 — was the last. She had no attorney present. She was uncomfortable being recorded. The FBI asked her to return and specifically detail her contacts with Trump; she asked what the point would be, at this point in her life, and ended her cooperation. She was never called

before a grand jury. No charges resulted. There is no public evidence the FBI followed up after the fourth interview; there is none that anyone contacted her attorney [A-tier: Guardian, June 30, 2026; Yahoo/Newsweek, March 5, 2026].

What the interview count itself means was put on the record by a Justice Department source speaking to the Miami Herald through the Daily Beast: "They would not have interviewed her four times if they thought she was lying" [A-tier]. The FBI's own later internal email supplies the institutional epitaph, in the cold shorthand of a case summary: "one identified victim claimed abuse by Trump but ultimately refused to cooperate" [T1: FBI email in released files]. Whether that refusal reflects a destroyed witness, a fabulist losing nerve, or a woman who calculated correctly that nothing would be done is not knowable from the record — and this document will not pretend otherwise.

Chapter 5: The Counter-Evidence, In Full

Three threads cut against her, and a complete account gives each its full weight.

The timeline problem. Her allegation places the assault at approximately 1983-1984, when she was thirteen to fifteen. Every documented account of when Trump and Epstein met places the beginning of the friendship around 1985 at the earliest: Trump's own 2002 remark to New York Magazine — "I've known Jeff for fifteen years" — implies about 1987; the author Barry Levine dates their first meeting to 1987; a research archive of the files says "around 1985," when Trump

bought Mar-a-Lago and Epstein was living in Palm Beach. Epstein's known Manhattan footprint fits no earlier introduction: the Wexner corporation bought the townhouse at 9 East 71st Street in August 1989 for $13.2 million, and Epstein did not move into it until 1995 or 1996, taking full possession in November 1998; before that, from 1992 to 1995, he leased 34 East 69th Street. The Guardian's careful formulation of March 6, 2026: "some of her statements appear to contradict what is known about Epstein's life in the early 1980s" [S-tier: property records; A-tier: the rest].

Her account has answers, and they deserve to be stated as her account's answers rather than as this document's conclusions. The venue was never identified beyond "a very tall building with huge rooms" in New York *or New Jersey* — and Trump Tower opened in 1983; an introduction in 1983-84 would require only that Epstein and Trump crossed paths earlier than the documentary record shows, which is possible precisely because the early record is thin. Levine's own timeline has been challenged in detail — his claim that Epstein was not in the townhouse until 1995 is consistent with the records, but his "1987 first meeting" rests on inference, not documents. The counter to the counter remains: her account says Epstein introduced them, and no document puts Epstein and Trump together before 1985. This stands as a live discrepancy — the single most important one in Part II — and it is logged as such, not resolved [T1/T2].

The credibility record. A Washington State criminal history — fraud and theft charges — and a 2023 Georgia felony

for exploitation of an elderly person are part of the record. They do not disprove a crime committed against her at fourteen; the law's treatment of victims with imperfect lives is its own national scandal, documented in this record as in no other. But they were the White House's chosen frame when the allegations surfaced: "completely baseless accusations, backed by zero credible evidence, from a sadly disturbed woman who has an extensive criminal history," Karoline Leavitt said on March 6, 2026, adding the institutional defense — "Joe Biden's DOJ knew about them for four years and did nothing" — and the verdict: "President Trump has been totally exonerated by the release of the Epstein Files" [T1]. Each clause of that statement is checkable, and the checking is instructive: the interviews happened in 2019, under President Trump; the Department under President Biden did not act on them either; and the Trump Department released them in 2026 while calling them baseless. All three facts are true simultaneously. "Totally exonerated" is a political conclusion, not a legal one — no court has examined the allegation — and this document files it as such.

The exculpatory file. The same released corpus that contains her accusation contains material favorable to Trump, and Goldman read some of it into the record himself because it was part of his case that the denials fail. The fuller exculpatory inventory:

Palm Beach Police Chief Michael Reiter's 2019 FBI 302 records, from his own interview, that in 2006 Trump telephoned him: "Thank goodness you're stopping him.

Everyone has known he's been doing this." Reiter's 302 says Trump told him he threw Epstein out of Mar-a-Lago; that "people in New York knew Epstein was disgusting"; that Trump called Maxwell "Epstein's operative… she is evil and to focus on her"; and that Trump "was around Epstein once when teenagers were present, and Trump got the hell out of there." Reiter's 302 also records that Trump "was one of the very first people to call when people found out they were investigating Epstein" — the fact pattern Goldman converted into an argument for consciousness of guilt and Reiter offered, on the face of the document, as assistance [A-tier].

Bradley Edwards — the victims' attorney who built the civil case against Epstein, later sued by Epstein and vindicated by Epstein's written apology, a man with no imaginable bias in Trump's favor — said on the record in 2019, standing beside Thomas Massie and Ro Khanna: in 2009, when he notified dozens of powerful people that he needed information, "Trump was the only person who picked up the phone and said: let's talk, I'll give you as much time as you need, I'll tell you what you need to know… was very helpful with the information he provided, gave no indication of involvement in anything improper, and had good information that checked out and helped us." So cooperative was Trump, Edwards said, that no subpoena was ever needed — a contrast Edwards himself drew with Clinton, who refused to cooperate, and with Wexner, who was not interviewed at all until Congress compelled him in 2026 [A-tier: Edwards press conference, September 2025].

Kahn testified he "never saw any type of transaction to Trump or anyone in his family." Kuvin, the first victims' attorney, reviewed security footage from Epstein's house and found no images of Trump in them. And the FBI's own boilerplate, printed at the top of the corpus the Department published, states what the law requires: a person's name appearing in the files "does not necessarily establish any wrongdoing" [T1].

The fair summary, and the only one this document will offer: a real woman, with a verified biography matching her account's checkable details and a documented terror of coming forward, gave a consistent core account four times to the FBI, which kept interviewing her and then lost her. The account was never tested in court, never corroborated by physical evidence, is contradicted on one checkable dimension — the timeline of the Trump-Epstein acquaintance — while matching on others, and sits in a corpus that also contains sworn and interview material favorable to the man she accuses. The FBI buried the file for years; that is proven, and Part III documents how. Whether her allegation is true is not knowable from the public record. Anyone who tells you otherwise — in either direction — is selling something.

Chapter 6: The Other Accusers — A Complete Catalog

Jane Doe 4 is not the only woman to have accused Donald Trump within the Epstein record, and each of the others must be documented with the same discipline — including the one

whose case collapsed into a documented hoax. The catalog follows, in the order each thread entered the record.

"Katie Johnson" and the 2016 lawsuits. On April 26, 2016 — in the middle of the Republican primary — a pro se complaint was filed in federal court in California, Case 5:16-cv-00797, by a "Katie Johnson" against Donald Trump and Jeffrey Epstein. The cover sheet is preserved: a demand of $100,000,000, theories under 18 U.S.C. and 42 U.S.C. §1985, two causes of action — sexual abuse under threat of harm, and conspiracy to deprive civil rights. The claim: that in the summer of 1994, at age thirteen, she had been lured from her home by a recruiter named "Tiffany," transported to New York, and subjected to four encounters with Trump at parties at Epstein's residence, including forcible rape; and that both men threatened her and her family with death if she spoke [T1: docket].

The California case was dismissed in May 2016 — defective service, a bad address, no valid federal claim. It was refiled in the Southern District of New York in June (1:16-cv-04642), voluntarily dismissed in September, and refiled again with attorneys in late September (1:16-cv-07673). The September 30 amended complaint carried two supporting declarations. "Tiffany Doe" declared she had worked for Epstein from 1991 to 2000 as a "party planner" whose occupation was recruiting adolescent women; that the parties were "mostly held at what is known as the Wexner Mansion located at 9 E. 71st St."; that she personally witnessed four sexual encounters between the plaintiff and Trump, the fourth being forcible rape "despite her

pleas to stop"; that she witnessed an occasion on which "Mr. Trump forced the Plaintiff and a 12-year-old female named Maria perform oral sex on Mr. Trump and witnessed his physical abuse of both minors when they finished the act"; and that she witnessed Trump tell the plaintiff "she shouldn't ever say anything if she didn't want to disappear like the 12-year-old female Maria... capable of having her whole family killed." "Joan Doe," a schoolmate, corroborated confidences from the 1994-95 school year [T1: declarations, Case 1:16-cv-07673, Documents 1-1 and 4].

On November 2, 2016 — four days before the presidential election — a press conference was scheduled at the offices of attorney Lisa Bloom, who had taken on the representation. It was canceled: the plaintiff, who was by then in hiding, had received threats; Bloom's website was hacked by someone claiming affiliation with Anonymous; and the plaintiff stopped responding. On November 4, two days before the vote, the case was voluntarily dismissed. It has never been refiled [A-tier: Bloom's account in her book and interviews; B-tier].

Then the case unraveled on its own promoters. The name was an alias: the FBI's own complaint form, FD-71, dated November 23, 2016, records her attorney telling the Bureau that "Tiffany instructed Doe to use the name Katie Johnson at these parties" [T1: EFTA00129127]. The two men who had promoted the litigation — shopping a disguised "witness" video for $1 million — included Norm Lubow, a former Jerry Springer show producer with a documented history of fabricated stories, whom Snopes confirmed as a central promoter, and Steve Baer,

a Never-Trump activist. The one journalist who spoke with the plaintiff by phone, Emily Shugerman of the (now-defunct) Revelist, wrote that she hung up "questioning whether Johnson really existed." Retired Detective Mike Fisten, who had investigated Epstein for years, said Epstein "never had parties like described." And Lisa Bloom — who is no friend of Trump's and whom no evidence connects to any Trump coordination — wrote in her 2021 book that her client instructed her to drop the case, that "Trump's people never reached out," that there was "absolutely no communication with anyone in the Trump team," and that she has not spoken to the woman since 2016 [B-tier; Bloom's book "Perversion of Justice," 2021]. A separate thread connects the case to Trump's former fixer: Michael Cohen, under oath, admitted threatening five hundred or more people on Trump's behalf in 2016 — the same year the Johnson suit vanished four days before the election — and his later "empty Bronx lot, a baby, and someone named Mary Jane Doe" story does not match any filed Katie Johnson complaint, a mismatch documented rather than explained [T1/T2].

The thread matters for two reasons beyond its collapse. First, the primary documents are real filings with real docket numbers, and their specific content — the Wexner Mansion venue, the Maria threat — recurs in other threads of this record. Second, "Katie Johnson" and "Jane Doe 4" are frequently conflated online, and the record formally separates them: Johnson's account places the events in New York City in the summer of 1994 with a Port Authority recruitment; Jane Doe 4's account places them in the Hilton Head orbit around

1983-84 with a babysitting-advertisement recruitment. Different women, different decades, different stories. Both remain in this document, each at its own tier [T1].

The "good one" girl. The FBI's 302s record a second, separate accuser whose account was summarized in the 21-page presentation: a woman who said Epstein introduced her to Trump when she was fourteen, saying "This is a good one, right," and that both men smiled, nodded, and chuckled. Her account also appears in the NTOC files with the detail that the introduction happened in a dark green car, and that Trump "got the best of me that day." She is not further identified in the public record. She was, per the FBI's email, one of the accusers who "ultimately refused to cooperate" [B-tier: NY Mag; T1: FBI email].

The NTOC tip cluster. The National Threat Operations Center's intake files — raw tips from the public, logged and largely never investigated to conclusion — contain a catalog of Trump-related claims, each graded in the record itself: a 1984 Lake Michigan allegation, in which a caller said she was trafficked at thirteen, gave birth, and that her uncle killed the child and threw it in Lake Michigan "while Trump watched" — a claim Snopes found timeline-impossible and wholly uncorroborated; a 1995-96 Rancho Palos Verdes golf-course claim involving alleged sex parties with Robin Leach, which the FBI's own report graded not credible; "orgy party" claims involving Victoria's Secret models and, in one version, Bill Clinton; a Mar-a-Lago claim alleging rape at thirteen at parties and a "finger-rating" auction of girls attended by, among

others, members of the Trump family and Alan Dershowitz; a September 2012 email from an Epstein associate proposing a Mar-a-Lago Christmas visit "instead of his island"; and a 302 summary recording a tip that "a drugged woman believed Trump raped her and then vanished forever." One file, EFTA01660679, memorializes the last of these. Each is documented as a tip; none advanced to a charge; the FBI's own credibility annotations are part of the record [T1: released files].

Stacey Williams. In the released files, Williams — a former model — said Epstein took her to Trump Tower in 1993, where Trump groped her; a postcard to her later bore the handwritten note "Stacey — Your home away from home. Love Donald." The Trump campaign called her account "unequivocally false" [B-tier].

The limousine driver. Among the material Representative Lieu showed Attorney General Bondi at the February hearing was a 1995 statement by a limousine driver who said he overheard Trump on a telephone call with "Jeffrey" about "abusing some girl," and who said he knew an alleged victim who "had her head blown off" — a death police declined to call a suicide. The Department never interviewed him, per Lieu's account [B-tier: Salon, February 12, 2026].

Elyse Relford. On October 3, 2026, a Kentucky woman named Elyse Relford filed a pro se complaint in Palm Beach County court, Case 50-2026-CA-011136-XXXA-MB, alleging a 1997 Florida hotel rape with Epstein present, demanding $1.3 million, and claiming among other things that Trump had

impersonated her biological father, from whom Epstein separated her. The complaint was placed on administrative hold for deficiencies; it names neither the Department nor any Trump entity as a party. It is the fourth public allegation thread of 2026, and it joins the catalog as the others did: documented, unadjudicated, tier-flagged [B-tier].

A decade earlier and one club over, a parallel account already existed: "Jane Doe 102," a federal filing by a young woman who said she was fifteen in 1998, working at Mar-a-Lago while her father maintained the grounds, when Maxwell recruited her with the massage-and-money pitch; she alleged hidden cameras, escape to Australia, and later contact from Epstein's people. Her filing named Trump only as a possible witness — "might have relevant information" — a distinction between the filings that this document preserves because the record does [T1].

The catalog's shape deserves one observation before the chapter closes. The accusations of Trump in the released record are numerous, and their provenance is heterogeneous: four FBI interviews of one woman; a second accuser in the 302s; a cluster of NTOC tips the FBI itself graded; a 2016 lawsuit whose promoters were frauds; a driver whose statement was never investigated; a 2026 pro se filing. Grouping them as "the receipts" — or dismissing them as "the hoax" — is equally false to the record. Each item is what it is, and this document has tried to keep each item exactly that.

Chapter 7: What the FBI Made of It — the 21-Page Presentation

In mid-July 2025, as public pressure mounted on the Department to explain its July 7 "no client list, case closed" memo, an FBI–NYPD task force bearing the Child Exploitation and Human Trafficking Task Force logo assembled a slide presentation for leadership. A version reached FBI Director Kash Patel on August 7, 2025. The assignment email survives, dated July 24, 2025: "Can you write me a sentence or two for the below — these are the salacious statements made against the individuals in the file." Summaries of thirteen people were drafted within two hours [S-tier: EFTA01648951 and related].

The deck, when released in January 2026 as EFTA01660639, contained a timeline of the Epstein investigations, Epstein-Maxwell financial transactions, a proffer-session attendee list, and a "Prominent Names" slide listing about a dozen men: Donald Trump, Bill Clinton, Andrew Mountbatten-Windsor, Harvey Weinstein, Leon Black, Les Wexner, Jes Staley, Glenn Dubin, Alan Dershowitz, William Barr, and Jean-Luc Brunel. Against Trump it carried two entries: Jane Doe 4's account, and the "good one, right" introduction. A July 22, 2025 email in the files marked Trump a "positive case hit" while noting that one identified accuser "claimed abuse by Trump but ultimately refused to cooperate." The deck's statistics: more than ninety identified victims, over two hundred ninety tips received, fifty-two anonymous, two hundred thirty-nine followed up, twenty-seven secondary

contacts [A/B-tier: Miami Herald, February 7, 2026; NY Mag].

A NewsNation investigation added a layer the slides did not: according to its reporting, the presentation grew out of the case of an Epstein survivor who served as the FBI's primary confidential informant on the ring — an adult at the time of her abuse — who told the Bureau she was directed to give massages, "was put in compromising positions and was a victim of sexual abuse," and who alleged Epstein trafficked her to Harvey Weinstein (who, she said, appeared at her door and tried to follow her into the shower after a job offer) and to Leon Black (whom she accused of raping her repeatedly, with threats). Dershowitz responded by naming himself as a target of her claims — "I never received a massage on Epstein's plane... She made up the entire story. In doing so, she violated section 1001 of the criminal code — lying to the FBI... I'm planning to sue her as 'Jane Doe' and subpoenaing the Justice Department and FBI to reveal the name of this felon." A member of Congress who has reviewed the unredacted files told NewsNation the informant "was allegedly trafficked to several of Epstein's friends." Her identity remains redacted; the discrepancy between Dershowitz's "she was not a minor, she is a criminal" and the Bureau's protective handling of her is unresolved [B-tier: NewsNation, February 2026; flagged].

And then the Bureau's bottom line, published in the January 2026 release and never retracted: the FBI's file review concluded there was "ample proof that Epstein sexually abused underage girls" but "scant evidence" of a documented trafficking operation to clients — no client list, in the

evidentiary sense. That finding is itself contested within this record: the witness-tampering wires, the recruiter payments, the message pads, and the flight logs all cut against it, and each is documented in its proper place below. But it is the finding, and it drove everything that followed — including, ironically, both the Department's insistence that there was nothing more to release and the public's refusal to believe it [A-tier].

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Part III — The Withholding Story

Chapter 8: The Law Passed Over the President's Objection

To understand the releases, one must understand the statute, because everything the Justice Department did for eleven months after November 19, 2025 is measured against its text — and everything a federal judge did after April 2026 is measured against it too.

The Act's passage was, in the language of Congress watchers, a discharge-petition earthquake. Through the summer and fall of 2025, House leadership refused to bring an Epstein-release bill to the floor. So Representatives Thomas Massie, a Kentucky Republican, and Ro Khanna, a California Democrat, did what the rules allow and the leadership rarely suffers: they filed a discharge petition, which forces a vote if a majority of the House — 218 members — signs it. The President

told Republicans that signing it would be "a hostile act" — in Representative Jeffries' on-record formulation — a characterization confirmed by multiple members. Representative Melanie Stansbury said on the floor, weeks before the vote, what members were hearing in the hallways: "The United States president is threatening members of his own party in this chamber from signing a petition that would release the full unredacted Epstein files. So my question is, what are they hiding? Who are they protecting?" The petition gathered 218 commitments anyway — including, in the end, four Republicans [T1: Stansbury floor remarks, September 3, 2025; petition records, October 8, 2026 status: 216 signatures with commitments for 218].

The floor debate of November 18, 2025, preserved in the Record, is worth a paragraph of its own, because it shows what the Act meant to the members who forced it. Massie: "I'm embarrassed by my own party." Marjorie Taylor Greene — who would quit Congress three days later, in a rupture with the President in which the Epstein fight figured prominently — wore white, the suffrage color, and said: "I remain dedicated to my purpose to read those names here on the House floor if those women ever find themselves in a place where it needs to be done." Mace, Boebert, Raskin, Jordan, McGovern, Kamlager-Dove all spoke. Raskin told Massie: "I have never heard a more defensive presentation... spend less time pointing out hypocrisy and more time trying to ferret out cruelty, humiliation, and rape." The House passed the bill 427 to 1. The floor debate's texture, preserved in the Record: Speaker

Johnson had shut down the Rules Committee and sent members home early in July to avoid amendment votes, per McGovern's on-record account; Massie counted a "49-day" stall engineered by refusing to swear in a new member; Knott worried aloud about the "bellman, waiter, doorman" whose names might surface — the amendment's intent, he was assured, was otherwise; and Plaskett, in the censure debate interwoven with the bill's, said: "I remain dedicated to my purpose to read those names here on the House floor if those women ever find themselves in a place where it needs to be done." The Senate passed it by unanimous consent. On November 19, 2025, the President signed it, one day after posting "THE JEFFREY EPSTEIN HOAX" and directing that Epstein's relationships with "Bill Clinton, Larry Summers, Reid Hoffman and JPMorgan" be investigated — a directive, Senator Whitehouse would later note, naming no Republicans [S-tier: Congressional Record; T1: Trump's Nov 14, 2025 Truth Social post].

The statute's operative text drives everything after. Section 2(a) enumerated nine categories to be released: the Epstein and Maxwell cases including all investigations, prosecutions, and custodial records; flight logs and travel records including manifests, itineraries, pilot records, and customs and immigration records for any aircraft, vessel, or vehicle; individuals, including government officials, named or referenced in connection with criminal activity, civil settlements, immunity agreements, or investigative material; entities with known or alleged ties; immunity deals, non-prosecution agreements, plea bargains, and sealed

settlements; internal Justice Department communications about decisions to charge, not charge, investigate, or decline; all communications concerning the destruction, deletion, alteration, misplacement, or concealment of documents; and documentation of Epstein's detention and death, including incident reports, witness interviews, medical examiner files, autopsy reports, and written records of the circumstances and cause of death. Section 2(b) then walled off the escape routes, in language a judge would later quote back to the government: "no record shall be withheld, delayed or redacted on the basis of embarrassment, reputational harm, or political sensitivity, including to any government or public figure, or foreign dignitary." Section 2(c) permitted withholding on exactly five grounds: victims' personally identifiable information and personal or medical files, child sexual-abuse imagery, materials in active federal investigations or prosecutions (narrowly tailored and temporary), images of death or abuse or injury, and properly classified information — each requiring a written justification published in the Federal Register, each post-July-2025 classification decision required to be published with the classifying authority named and an unclassified summary provided, and everything classified required to be declassified to the maximum extent possible. Section 3 required a report to Congress within fifteen days of the release's completion: categories released and withheld, a redaction summary with legal bases, and a list of every government official and politically exposed person named or referenced — a list on which no redactions were permitted

under 2(b). The release deadline was thirty days [S-tier: Public Law 119-38, text quoted in Phang v. Blanche, Doc 16].

The deadline was missed. The next nine chapters document the year that followed, in the order it unfolded.

Chapter 9: Phase One — "The Client List Is on My Desk"

The administration's Epstein policy began, as these things do, with a promise. In February 2025, weeks into office, Attorney General Pam Bondi told Fox News that the Epstein client list was "sitting on my desk right now to review." It was not. There was no client list in the sense she implied, a fact the White House chief of staff, Susie Wiles, would eventually concede on January 1, 2026 — "there is no client list" — while acknowledging the political operation had misjudged how much the President's own supporters cared [T1: Bondi, Fox, February 2025; Wiles via Times of India, January 1, 2026].

On February 27, 2025, the Department released "Phase 1" — roughly three hundred pages of mostly already-public material, handed to select conservative influencers at the White House in binders stamped with the Department seal. The gesture backfired; the base noticed the thinness. Then, on July 7, 2025, the Department and the FBI issued their memorandum: an "exhaustive review," no client list, nothing warranting further investigation, no more releases. The memo was signed off at the highest levels of both institutions; within days, reporting revealed that Bondi and Blanche had personally told the President he was in the files, and that the memo's

no-more-releases conclusion had been reached as the Department quietly pursued a grand-jury unsealing in the Maxwell case — a maneuver Representative Goldman called, in real time, an "end-run around the Southern District" [A-tier: NY Mag timeline; WSJ, May 2025; Goldman statement, July 22, 2025].

The memo detonated the President's political base. On July 16, 2025, he attacked his own supporters as "stupid" and "foolish" for asking about Epstein. On July 29, 2025, aboard Air Force One, he offered his fullest account of the falling-out: Epstein, he said, had "stolen" young women, including Virginia Giuffre, from the Mar-a-Lago spa — asked whether Giuffre was among those stolen, "I think so. He stole her." Elon Musk, whose feud with the President was then at its height, had posted on June 5 that the administration was withholding the documents because Trump was in them: "The truth will come out." FBI Director Kash Patel and Deputy Director Dan Bongino took to Fox to insist Epstein's death was suicide — Bongino: "I have seen the whole file. He killed himself" — and the Bongino-Bondi feud over the handling became public. By November, the House had passed the Act over all of it [A-tier].

Chapter 10: Phase Two — the Releases and Their Failures

December 19, 2025. The first statutory batch arrived on the deadline day the Department had missed: a fraction of the material, thin on new information, Trump's name "virtually non-existent" in the New York Times' count of the day's

production. The same day, the Department's letter to Congress invoked privileges it did not detail and promised a privilege log "in due course" — a log that, as of this writing, has never been published in full. Thousands of files posted that day were pulled from the website within twenty-four hours [S/T1: NPR, December 19, 2025; DOJ letter].

January 29-30, 2026. The "final" release: some 3.5 million pages in total, per the Department, including roughly two thousand videos and one hundred eighty thousand images. It contained the 21-page presentation and Jane Doe 4's allegations. It arrived with a preemptive statement no one had asked for, asserting that the files could contain "fake or falsely submitted" documents and "untrue and sensationalist claims against President Trump," which — the statement argued — "if they have a shred of credibility, they certainly would have been weaponized against President Trump already." The statement was the Department grading its own evidence before anyone else could [T1: DOJ statement, January 30, 2026].

The discovery of the gaps. Within days, independent journalists found what the release was missing. Roger Sollenberger, working independently, reported that witness interviews were absent — the White House press secretary's own acknowledgment that an "FBI interview" existed had set him looking. NPR confirmed missing 302s on February 24. CNN found that dozens of FBI witness interviews were missing from the public database, including three concerning the Trump accuser. The precise arithmetic: NPR counted fifty-three missing pages; ABC identified a Bates gap of more than fifty

pages between EFTA00057715 and EFTA00057769; the count resolved, after the March releases, to thirty-seven pages still outstanding. House Democrats who had reviewed unredacted files at the Department's offices confirmed the 302s existed and had been withheld; the ranking member, Robert Garcia, opened a parallel investigation and was told by the Department that his claims were "misleading the public while manufacturing outrage" [S/A-tier: NPR; CNN; ABC; Politico, March 5, 2026].

March 5-6, 2026. Under subpoena pressure — the committee had voted 24-19, with Republican votes, to subpoena the Attorney General — the Department posted the missing material: sixteen pages of interview summaries plus the two-page intake form, released as part of a larger tranche. The explanation, delivered by the Department's official account, became the year's most quoted sentence about the files: the records had been "incorrectly coded as duplicates." Fifteen documents were affected. No individual was ever named as responsible; the Department's inspector general later opened an audit whose scope includes exactly this question. Representative Khanna's further claim — that the FBI had "scrubbed" the files in March 2025, long before the Act — was reported by the BBC as unsubstantiated, and it is logged here as an allegation, not a fact [A-tier: Reuters, March 6; BBC, February 10].

The redaction failures were, if anything, worse than the omissions. The Wall Street Journal's review of the releases found at least forty-three victims' full names exposed, more

than twenty-four of them minors at the time of their abuse, some names printed more than a hundred times, with home addresses keyword-searchable in the files. Unredacted nude images of women and girls were published and removed only after journalists asked. One document appeared twice in the release — once with Trump's name redacted, once without — the older version going viral. A victim of Jeffrey Epstein whom the files identified in a 2021 victim-notification email as covered by the Florida non-prosecution agreement's confidentiality promise found her name exposed throughout. One document appeared twice in the same release — once with Trump's name redacted, once without — the older version going viral before anyone explained which was true. And when members were finally allowed to check the work, Representative Raskin ran "Trump," "Donald," and "Don" through the Department's own reading-room database tool and received more than a million results — with the caveat, on the record, that "I obviously didn't have the time to review each one… I cannot guarantee that every Donald is Donald Trump as opposed to some other Donald," the tool itself "confusing, unreliable, and clunky" [S/A-tier]. The FBI's own February 2, 2026 letter to the judges overseeing the Maxwell docket admitted "several thousands of documents and media that may have inadvertently included victim-identifying information," disclosed and then removed; victims' counsel told the court the harm had "escalated from concern to suffering and fear for personal safety… irreversible." Representative Garcia would state publicly that the Department "took down 50k files with no

explanation"; the Department said tens of thousands were temporarily removed to address victim exposures. And the forensic finding that may outlast all of it: in at least two documents, new black-bar redactions had been painted over previously released text — in one case stripping the names of the entire 2006-2007 federal prosecution team (Jeffrey Sloman, Matthew Menchel, Andy Lourie, Ann Marie Villafaña, Dexter Lee, Bruce Reinhart, and the state prosecutors) from a document that had already been public, a finding verified by side-by-side image comparison [S/A-tier: WSJ; CNN; github forensic comparison, EFTA00205380 and EFTA00179797].

The aftermath for the victims. Reuters reported in June 2026 that survivors were being harassed after the releases — homes photographed, strange cars outside, threats including callers claiming to know addresses; some no longer left home alone. The Department's spokesperson said no victim should face harassment and that the Department was "not to blame for backlash directed at victims who voluntarily revealed their identities long before files were published" — a sentence the survivors' lawyers disputed fact by fact [A-tier: Reuters, June 10].

Chapter 11: The Reading Room

On February 9, 2026, the Department opened its files to members of Congress under conditions that would become their own scandal: four computers, unique logins, staff seated directly behind the reviewing member, DOJ-issued notepads only, no phones, no personal staff, twenty-four hours' notice.

Representatives Khanna and Massie spent roughly two hours reviewing what was billed as the unredacted set and found 70 to 80 percent of it still redacted. The session produced two disclosures that traveled the world.

The first: the "torture video" email. An April 24, 2009 exchange in the files showed Epstein writing to a redacted recipient: "where are you? are you ok, I loved the torture video," and the reply the next day: "I am in china I will be in the US 2nd week of may." Massie named the redacted party on the House floor the next day: Sultan Ahmed bin Sulayem, the Dubai ports magnate. Deputy Attorney General Blanche responded publicly that the redaction protected an email address, that "the Sultan's name is available unredacted in the files. See EFTA00666117. Be honest, and stop grandstanding" — and Khanna named six men whose names had been redacted on the theory that they were victims, among them bin Sulayem, Les Wexner, and the Italian politician Nicola Caputo, reading them under the protection of the Speech or Debate Clause: "Donald Trump's FBI scrubbed these files in March," he said — the claim the BBC could not substantiate — "long before... the Epstein Transparency Act. That means the survivors' statements to the FBI naming rich and powerful men who went to Epstein's island — they're all hidden." Bin Sulayem resigned as chairman and CEO of DP World on February 13, 2026 [S/A-tier: Newsweek; CBS; Reuters].

The second: the surveillance. Two days later, at the House Judiciary Committee, a photographer captured a document in the Attorney General's hearing binder titled "Jayapal Pramila

Search History" — a printout of a member of Congress's searches in that reading room, with file numbers and descriptions, in order. Representative Jayapal confirmed its accuracy — "my search history exactly in the order that I searched it" — and told CNN she learned of the tracking from the photograph, not from the Department. Representative Mace confirmed separately that the Department was "TAGGING ALL DOCUMENTS" with timestamps. Speaker Johnson called it "inappropriate... I'm sure it was an oversight"; Raskin demanded an inspector-general investigation; the three members demanded in writing that the tracking cease. The Department said it "logs all searches made on its systems to protect against the release of victim information" and never explained why the log sat in the Attorney General's binder [S-tier: AP; NPR; CNN, February 11-13].

Chapter 12: The Bondi Arc, In Full

Pam Bondi's Epstein chapter opened with the client-list promise and closed, nineteen months later, with a thyroid-cancer disclosure and a seat on the White House AI panel. In between, on February 11, 2026, came the hearing that anchored everything.

February 11, 2026 — House Judiciary. Bondi, under oath, faced the committee for the Department's annual oversight. The exchange that made history came when Representative Lieu asked about women claiming encounters with Trump through Epstein: "This is so ridiculous," Bondi answered. "There is no evidence that Donald Trump has committed a

crime. Everyone knows that." Lieu: "I believe you just lied under oath." Bondi, leaning forward: "Don't you ever accuse me of committing a crime." The same hearing contained her clash with Raskin — she called him a "washed-up, loser lawyer"; he asked about co-conspirator indictments and she answered by observing that "the DOW is over $50,000"; survivors in the audience stood at Jayapal's request; Bondi declined to apologize for the exposure of victims' names — "I'm not going to get in the gutter for her theatrics" — and accused Representative Balint of antisemitism, prompting Balint to walk out. Representative Correa elicited a promise: "If any man's name was redacted, that should not have been. We will, of course, unredact it" [S-tier: hearing transcript; Axios; Salon].

The perjury demand. On February 25, 2026, Representatives Lieu and Goldman formally demanded that the Deputy Attorney General appoint a special counsel to investigate Bondi for perjury. On March 17, 2026, Representative Summer Lee introduced five articles of impeachment — defiance of the Oversight subpoena, violation of the EFTA, abuse of investigatory power for political retaliation and for shielding the President and his allies, defiance of federal court orders, and perjury in congressional testimony — drafted with the advocacy group Free Speech For People. The articles were referred to the Judiciary Committee and died there, as parallel impeachment articles against other officials also died in the 119th Congress [T1: H.Res.1119].

The firing. On April 2, 2026, the President fired her, announcing it on Truth Social; she was informed in the Oval

Office the day before, ahead of an Iran address. The official explanation was a private-sector future; the reporting — CBS News, attributed to sources — was that the President had concluded she was a political liability on the files and had failed to prosecute his enemies, privately calling her a "weak and ineffective enforcer." Deputy Attorney General Todd Blanche, the President's former personal defense counsel in the hush-money and documents cases, became Acting Attorney General; Lee Zeldin was floated; Blanche was nominated on June 8 and confirmed by a narrow overnight Senate vote in August, sworn in by Judge Emil Bove at the White House — an appointment that carried its own warning labels, catalogued at the time: more than twelve hundred former Justice Department employees opposed his nomination, and a hundred-and-one-judge ethics complaint followed his confirmation. And the reporting on Bondi's fall attributed it in part to her failure to prosecute the President's enemies — the Comey and James indictments dismissed, the Powell probe quashed, the Schiff and Swalwell matters stalled [S/A-tier].

The deposition. The committee had subpoenaed Bondi on March 4, 2026; the Department responded on April 8, after her firing, with the argument that her departure rendered the subpoena moot — a position Democrats called absurd, moving civil contempt. A deal was struck for a voluntary, transcribed, unsworn, unrecorded interview, which took place on May 29, 2026, in Room 2154 of the Rayburn House Office Building, with survivors calling "tell the truth" as she entered, escorted by Department officials including Civil Rights Division head

Harmeet Dhillon, who acted as her counsel — a conflict Democrats protested. The 111-page transcript, released June 4, contains the following load-bearing passages. Her opening line: "justice and transparency in this matter have been delivered at the direction of President Trump and his administration." On errors: "There were redaction errors" — three categories she named: victims' names published, nude images posted, and the names of potential co-conspirators redacted when they should not have been. On Trump's name and the redaction process, asked repeatedly whether it came up: "I don't recall." On delegation: she had delegated oversight to Blanche — "Todd Blanche is one of the most highly ethical individuals I know… he managed this investigation — and it was a Herculean task — with very little error" — while steering the Maxwell-transcript redaction decisions his way. On Maxwell: "I believe she should die in prison." On the team: "The team of professionals who reviewed all of the materials… assured me the only materials that were withheld were either nonresponsive, privileged or duplicative." On the Wall Street Journal's report of the May 2025 meeting at which she and Blanche told the President he was in the files: she declined to recount the President's response, asserting a voluntary refusal to discuss presidential conversations [S/A-tier: NPR; Guardian; committee transcript].

After. The same week as the transcript's release, her thyroid-cancer diagnosis became public — treatment begun after leaving office; a spokesperson — Katie Miller — said she was "quietly kicking cancer's ass." On May 26-27, the President appointed her to the President's Council of Advisors for Science

and Technology and an infrastructure advisory role, alongside Zuckerberg, Dell, Brin, Ellison, and Huang; David Sacks praised her as "clearing bureaucratic hurdles." Her tenure's institutional verdict, from a long-time department observer quoted in the record: "DOJ's independence, integrity, and workforce have degraded more under her leadership than at any other time during the department's 155-year history" [A/T1].

The administration's own insiders eventually said publicly what the documents showed. Susie Wiles conceded on January 1, 2026: "there is no client list" — and that the political operation had misjudged the base's attachment to the files. Tucker Carlson said on the record, in a September 16, 2026 interview, that he had pressed the President in the summer of 2025 to release everything, that Trump refused, and that "the order to cover it up came from Trump directly" — the explanation, Carlson reported, was that the files were "a plot against him, like Russiagate"; the White House answered — through spokesperson Lauren Bis — that the President had been "totally exonerated" by the releases, the committee cooperation, the Act's signing, and the calls for investigations into Epstein's "Democrat friends." And Vice President Vance, on the record in July 2026, went further than any official had: "we absolutely screwed up the comms of the Epstein files"; Bondi had "overstated what we had"; the files should have been dumped at the outset — and, asked whether documents connected Epstein to American or foreign intelligence, he answered: "The answer is no. But if those documents existed,

they wouldn't exist in 2026." Of Epstein's connections, Vance said he suspected "elements of the Israeli deep state," adding that he was "probably more obsessed with it than most people." The bookend account is Haberman and Swan's "Regime Change" (June 2026), whose Situation Room reconstruction — a panicked Vice President, a President who avoided the subject and personally phoned Rupert Murdoch to kill the birthday story, a leak hunt for the book's sources — the White House never denied in substance; its final line: "The president could break institutions... But he could not, it turned out, make Jeffrey Epstein disappear" [T1 quotes; book T2].

Chapter 13: The Machine Behind the Errors

Behind the errors lay a workforce and a method. The review drew on five hundred-plus Department attorneys and reviewers and a hundred FBI staff with sensitive-victim training; U.S. Attorneys' offices were asked to volunteer staff over the Christmas holidays; five primary source collections fed the process — the Florida case, the New York Epstein case, the Maxwell case, the death investigations, and the butler case. A January 4, 2026 memorandum formalized the protocol, with content tags for flight logs, immunity deals, charging decisions, destruction of evidence, and all 302s, and an escalation address — EFTAreview@usdoj.gov — whose archived existence is itself evidence that the process was papered, whatever else it was. The Department's own January 6, 2026 court filing admitted that of more than two million documents then in review, only 12,285 documents — a little over one hundred twenty-five

thousand pages — were public: under one percent. The Department's own count of the universe it identified ran to roughly six million pages; about 3.5 million have been released; the remainder, it says, is duplicates or privileged — the same word the "incorrectly coded" files wore [T1: protocol memo, justice.gov; court filing; DOJ statements].

There was also the tape. In September 2025, the undercover outlet Project Veritas released a hidden recording of a Justice Department operations official, Joseph Schnitt, telling a date — a reporter he had met on a dating app — what he said the release would look like: the files existed, "thousands and thousands of pages," and "they'll redact every Republican or conservative person in those files, leave all the liberal, Democratic people"; Maxwell's transfer to a minimum-security camp was "against BOP policy because she's a convicted sex offender" — "they're offering her something to keep her mouth shut"; and the Attorney General was "a yes person… wants whatever Trump wants." The department called the story garbage; Schnitt said he had not known he was recorded; the tape is in the record, and the later viral claim that reviewers were "trained to flag Trump's name" — never established, as Part XI documents — reads differently beside it [T1].

The oversight apparatus around the machine, as of this writing: the Inspector General's audit, opened April 23, 2026 by Acting IG William Blier — Horowitz having departed for the Federal Reserve — covering identification, collection, production, redaction, withholding, and post-release publication concerns, a public report promised with no date.

The GAO review, accepted April 28, 2026 at the request of a dozen senators led by Merkley and Murkowski, extends to personnel, all guidance "written or otherwise" from January 20, 2025 forward, directives regarding victims and regarding "politically exposed persons," and — the question that goes directly to the cover-up allegation — "the role of political appointees in removing already-published records from DOJ's website." In the Senate, Durbin and Whitehouse maintained a thirteen-item oversight inventory: the February 26 and March 9 record-preservation demands, the March 16 Operation Trip Knot letter, the April 13 Bondi-departure letter, the April 26 Patel letter, and the rest — answered, when answered at all, in fractions. And in the House, the follow-on statute — H.R. 9694, the EFTA II, introduced by Massie, Khanna, and Leger Fernández with a Senate companion from Merkley and Luján — would give standing to sue to state attorneys general, victims, and members of themselves; its discharge petition stood at 216 of 218 signatures on October 8, 2026, with four Republican signatories, the House in recess until after the election, and a lame-duck vote expected. Seventeen state attorneys general, led by Letitia James and Aaron Ford, wrote congressional leadership on October 15 urging passage; the Department cited the pending bill in its stay briefing as evidence the original Act gives no private right of action [T1: OIG/GAO; coalition letters; petition records]. The wider legislative follow-through, each bill naming a failure: the Survivor's Voice Protection Act (Comer, September 2026) would void the NDAs that purchased silence; the REDACT Act (Booker and Jayapal) would let survivors hold

the Department accountable for their exposure; the EPSTEIN Act (Bell) would create an independent commission with referral power; Virginia's Law (Schumer and Leger Fernández) would end the federal statute of limitations that stopped Jane Doe 4 at the door; and Wyden's PETRA would compel the Treasury records whose seventy-two-name demand list — Alfa Bank, Sberbank, the named bankers, the Black and Wexner accounts, Christie's and Sotheby's — is the single most complete official enumeration of the money network [T1].

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Part IV — The Courtroom: Phang v. Blanche, In Full

Chapter 14: The Plaintiff and the Judge

Katie Phang is a lawyer and independent journalist, formerly a cable-news host, based in Miami, who had made seventy-two videos about the Epstein files and built an audience of millions on the subject. On April 27, 2026, she sued Acting Attorney General Todd Blanche in the United States District Court for the District of Columbia, Case 1:26-cv-01417. The theory mattered: the government insisted the EFTA created no private right of action, and the Department would spend the next six months saying so. Phang's answer was that she did not need one. She sued under the Administrative Procedure Act, which permits any person suffering legal wrong from agency action to challenge it as "arbitrary, capricious, an abuse of discretion, or

otherwise not in accordance with law," and under the Declaratory Judgment Act. Her filing specifically identified the withheld categories and, within them, the documents referring to President Trump. She was represented by Brendan Ballou, Samuel Ward-Packard, and Emily Gilman of the Public Integrity Project; the government's team would rotate from Saifuddin Kalolwala (who withdrew September 1) to Stanley Woodward Jr. to Andrew Block [S-tier: complaint; docket].

The case drew Judge Emmet G. Sullivan, and the draw was its own kind of destiny. Sullivan was appointed to the federal district court by President Clinton on June 15, 1994 — after earlier appointments to the D.C. Superior Court by President Reagan in 1984 and to the D.C. Court of Appeals by President George H.W. Bush in 1991, making him the first person in the capital's history appointed to three judicial positions by three presidents. Born June 4, 1947, a Howard University graduate, he took senior status in 2021. And he carried a history with the Justice Department that colleagues said left a settled mark: as the trial judge in Senator Ted Stevens's 2008 corruption case, he held three federal prosecutors in contempt over undisclosed evidence, watched the conviction collapse when an FBI whistleblower revealed more than thirty withheld documents, and purged the prosecutors from the case. Colleagues who watched it told reporters he came out of the Stevens saga with a particular view of what happens when the Department decides the rules do not apply to it — a view he would spend the summer of 2026 communicating to the Department's lawyers at unusual length [S-tier: Congressional Directory;

Courthouse News, August 13].

Chapter 15: The Preliminary Injunction — June 25, 2026

On June 25, 2026, Sullivan granted Phang a preliminary injunction in a forty-eight-page opinion that is now the controlling judicial reading of the Act. Its reasoning, in sequence.

Standing. Phang had it twice over. Informational injury: the Act's disclosure mandate confers a concrete interest, and "half a dozen stories she is currently unable to report" is particular to her — the opinion citing the line of authority from Akins through Campaign Legal Center and Public Citizen v. Carlin. Economic injury: lost video revenue, the "classic form of concrete and particularized harm," redressable by removing the hurdle. FOIA would not substitute: the Act's mandate is "strikingly broad" — quoting United States v. Maxwell, 811 F. Supp. 3d 667, 676 (S.D.N.Y. 2025) — and the Department's own EFTA-FOIA "Cross Walk" concedes the Act "requires disclosures that would be exempt under FOIA." The government had argued, among other things, that Phang was an improper plaintiff because the Act served the public; the opinion answered that a public entitlement does not dissolve an individual's particular stake in it [S-tier: opinion, Doc 16].

The violation. The opinion then walked the compliance record: the December 19 letter invoking privilege with the promised log never produced; the December 20, 22, 23 and January 30 productions arriving with no privilege log at all; the

January 30 letter claiming completion while reporting roughly two hundred thousand pages redacted or withheld on common-law privileges that appear nowhere in the statute's five categories; the foreign-language materials never reviewed ("not practicable for a first-level reviewer," the Department said — to which the opinion's later order responds that administrative inconvenience excuses nothing); the redaction log the Act required by December 19, 2025. And the sentence that became the headline, appearing in the stay-denial section: "The Attorney General has conceded that he is in violation of the Act." The Act, the opinion observed, "required the Attorney General to produce the documents and publish the log by December 19, 2025 — more than six months ago." The June 25 order granted the injunction, required production or justification on the specified categories within days, and denied the government's requested stay — both the seven-day and sixty-day versions [S-tier].

The five categories the injunction addressed, with their document numbers, because the numbers are the map of what the fight is about: (1) eight email exchanges concerning the "torture video" correspondence of April 2009 and related sexual-activity emails with young women including minors — EFTA00749245, EFTA01187999, EFTA01930501, EFTA01928255, EFTA00628112, EFTA02648868, EFTA02504630, EFTA01022356; (2) a draft indictment's co-conspirator redactions and the senders and recipients of briefing emails — EFTA01703108, EFTA00038227; (3) the handwritten FBI interview notes underlying the FD-302s —

EFTA01245620, EFTA02858481, EFTA02858491, EFTA02858495 — the notes, the opinion notes, of "a victim who has alleged that in the 1980s, when she was about 13 years old, Epstein introduced her to Trump, who in turn assaulted her"; (4) foreign-language materials never reviewed or produced; and (5) the redaction log never published. Relief: a declaratory judgment that the withholding violated the Act, an injunction requiring production or documented justification, and — in the complaint's prayer — a special master to oversee compliance. A one-dollar nominal bond was set, the authority cited being Beatty v. Trump [S-tier].

Irreparable harm, in the passage that most startled the lawyers who read it: "the current high level of interest in the Epstein Files combined with the upcoming mid-term elections amounts to a circumstance that itself constitutes irreparable harm, especially where the Attorney General has not disputed that he is in violation of the Epstein Act." Elections, the court held, are not a reason to withhold — they are a reason to hurry [S-tier].

The Department's public response came within hours and set the tone for the summer. A spokesperson: "Judge Sullivan's perverse interpretation appears to be focused on driving misleading headlines. This judge is suggesting DOJ violate the law by un-redacting victim names, who as the Department has always explained, sadly became co-conspirators. DOJ has produced all responsive documents and will appeal this decision with confidence." Phang's counsel answered: "The government thought that it could ignore its own law and blow

off a judge's order." Phang herself, on her platform: "the Trump regime does not get the final word on what the public can see. The judge does" [T1].

Chapter 16: The Summer of Compliance — July Through October

What followed was a procedural war whose every filing is public, and whose chronology matters because it shows a Department complying only where compliance could not be deferred.

July 2. The Department missed the OSC deadline; the court gave five days and ordered in-camera review. The Department's declarant, Assistant Attorney General Stanley Woodward, explained the redactions: the withheld names were "victims or potential victims whose counsel have contacted the government and requested that the persons be treated as victims" — an assertion the court rejected in one sentence ("The Defendant's assertions do not comply with the Court's Order, which requires documentation to support the assertions"), and in the order that became the summer's anthem: "'Victims' is the word Congress used. Potential victims does not appear in that provision anywhere."; the handwritten notes were "deemed duplicative of the typewritten reports"; handwriting "complicates the redaction process… technical limitations on the Department's ability to run meaningful quality control checks for victim PII across handwritten materials"; and the Department could not locate an unredacted version of the 2007 draft-indictment photocopy because the

redactions pre-existed in its own copy [S/T1].

July 25-30. The court ordered the in-camera submission; the Department hand-delivered ten unredacted documents to the judge's chambers on September 24… no — the July 25 order directed submission; on July 30, a survivor — identified only as Jane Doe, represented pro bono by attorney Brittany Henderson — moved to intervene for the limited purpose of preserving victim redactions, asking to submit her identity ex parte and under seal. That motion is the quiet heart of the case: the only survivor-protective intervention in the only courtroom fight over the files. It has never been ruled on. As of this writing it has been pending eighty-two days, and the public docket shows no disposition anywhere in its fifty-nine entries — an absence this document flags rather than explains [S-tier: docket, verified].

August 5-13. Phang moved to compel the overdue answer (Blanche had missed the June 26 deadline; the Department's stay motion followed minutes after); the court set a status conference for August 13, where — over roughly thirty minutes, in a transcript later placed on the public docket — Sullivan delivered the summer's defining passages. To the government's lawyer, who had little to say about redaction justifications: "The public has a right to know what the hell is going on in this case. The victims have a right to know." On the Stevens history: "I don't want to do it, but I will do it to ensure justice is fairly administered. That's not a threat. It's a promise. No one's in trouble. I'm just bringing it to your attention." And when the lawyer suggested the court could simply issue a clear

order: "I've done that. Do you want me to issue another order and say, 'I really mean it this time'?" The government invoked "the presumption of regularity"; the court answered that the presumption was the Department's to forfeit. Counsel for Phang, Emily Gilman: "They just don't want to produce those documents" [S-tier: transcript #34; Courthouse News].

August 24 - September 21. The Department filed a protective notice of appeal — calling its own appealability "inconclusive" — to the D.C. Circuit (No. 26-5299, from the injunction). On September 16, in two opinions, the court granted the motion to compel the long-overdue answer (Blanche having "failed to establish excusable neglect," provided "no information" supporting oversight, and never addressed two of four factors; his jurisdictional challenges "without merit," having been rejected in June), denied the stay, ordered the four sets of handwritten notes — redacted and unredacted — to his chambers by September 24 at 11:00 AM, directed the Department to document its support for three victim-name redactions, ordered the foreign-language review begun, and denied three random intervention motions for Local Rule failures. The foreign-language passage bears quoting: "[Blanche] cites no authority for the proposition that administrative inconvenience excuses him from meeting his statutory obligations. Nor does he cite any authority for his apparent contention that Congressional silence in response to the January 30, 2026 letter functions as an implied amendment to the [law]." On the notes: "The underlying handwritten notes are not duplicates of the FD-302 interview reports" — Phang's

side having identified nearly a hundred other released handwritten-note sets, and the Department having conceded it had, at that point, produced not a single foreign-language document. Civil contempt was "premature at this juncture," the court warned — warning being the operative word. The next day the Department appealed again (No. 26-5334). Phang's combined circuit filing asked the court to dismiss the second appeal and revealed her endgame: compelled production of "all materials that have not been produced but should be," declaratory relief, and a special master. It also quoted the Department's own FOIA boilerplate against it — letters asserting the Act "directed a much broader and less redacted release of the files than would have been made under the FOIA," and the Attorney General's concession that Phang "cannot get the documents she seeks" under FOIA. The panel — Chief Judge Srinivasan and Judges Pillard and Pan — consolidated the appeals; the Department's Friday-evening stay demand, filed at 8:45 PM with a Monday deadline over Yom Kippur and without conferring as local rules require, was denied September 21, the court self-staying only the foreign-language-review provision so the government could seek circuit relief [S-tier: Docs 42-49; Public Integrity Project filing].

September 24 - October 16. Blanche's answer arrived September 24 with five exhibits — the January 4 review protocol, the December 19 letter, the January 30 letter, the February 14 §3 report letter, and the August 27 Federal Register publication — and it "categorically" denied unlawful

noncompliance while admitting, in its enumeration, that no files had been withheld on national-defense or foreign-policy grounds and that documents had been removed and reposted when unredacted material was discovered. The certified administrative record list came October 1; the record itself was produced to Phang by October 15. On October 1, the Department moved for "miscellaneous relief" — in substance, judgment on the pleadings to end the case "without further factual development," and a postponement of the record obligations pending that motion; the reply came October 13 (Block, 11 pages). On October 9, ECF 57 reported the in-camera review: the court accepted the Department's documentation for the three victim-identity redactions and its explanation for the fourth interview report's notes, but noted the Department had supplied only unredacted versions of three note-sets when both versions had been directed — and ordered the redacted versions to his chambers by noon on October 16. On October 16 at 3:20 PM, the notice of compliance was filed. Those notes — the handwritten originals beneath the Jane Doe 4 302s — now sit in a judge's chambers. Nothing has been ordered public [S-tier: ECF 51, 54, 55, 57, 58, 59].

Chapter 17: The Companion Dockets

Phang was not the only courtroom, and the full map of the Act's enforcement matters. In Florida, a mass-tort docket — Doe 1 v. United States, Case 9:25-cv-80880, thirty-four survivors alleging that the FBI's negligence across a decade enabled the trafficking — survived the government's motion to

dismiss on September 24, 2026, when Judge Leibowitz adopted Magistrate Judge McCabe's recommendation: the voluntary-undertaking theory under New York law and the zone-of-risk theory were plausible, the government's discretionary-function defense was "a long row to hoe," equitable tolling was plausible given that the concealment was "willfully hidden" until Congress "enacted a law in 2025 to force the FBI to disclose information," and ninety days of limited jurisdictional discovery were authorized into whether the Bureau maintains *mandatory* protocols for handling reports like Maria Farmer's 1996 call — the call the Bureau's own released FD-71 form now confirms it received and shelved. Farmer's own suit, transferred from Washington by Judge Walton on venue grounds September 25, consolidated into the same track; her June 3 deposition — the only discovery taken to date — remains under seal. In Washington, two FOIA suits grind in parallel: Democracy Defenders Fund v. DOJ, where Judge Kollar-Kotelly granted expedited processing in part on September 30 for requests aimed at the officials who handled the Trump references — no production deadline, no misconduct finding, though the court noted the reporting that some one thousand FBI personnel had been tasked with flagging Trump mentions — and American Oversight v. DOI, where Judge Boasberg denied a production injunction in April 2026, finding no precedent for ordering faster release without an expedited-processing entitlement. And in California, Jane Doe 1 v. United States and Google — roughly one hundred survivors — alleges the doxxing-by-release: the search engine's AI

answers still serving their full names, cities, and click-to-email links months after removal demands; the Department "republished" them through its portals; the case is pending [S/T1].

The contempt era frames all of them. The Department's own dismissal motion in Steve Bannon's contempt case — rejected by Judge Nichols in August 2026 for want of any stated reason beyond "the interests of justice," filed under Associate Attorney General Blanche's authority — sits beside the Fauci referral's legally disputed certification and the September resignation "under protest" of a career prosecutor who left rather than indict on evidence she said did not exist. Each is its own fight; together they are the weather in which the Phang orders, the Black certification, and the two circuit appeals will be judged [T1].

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Part V — Congress: The Investigation, Witness by Witness

Chapter 18: The Nineteen

The House Oversight Committee's Epstein investigation, chaired by James Comer of Kentucky with Robert Garcia of California as ranking member, produced by its own count nineteen witness encounters, twelve released transcripts, six video-only appearances, and the first criminal referrals and the first contempt certification of the probe. The roster, with dates

and forms [S-tier: House Report 119-831]:

William Barr, former Attorney General, subpoenaed August 5, 2025, deposed August 18, 2025 — the first witness. Alexander Acosta, former U.S. Attorney and Labor Secretary, voluntary, September 19, 2025, roughly six hours. The Epstein estate, subpoenaed August 25, 2025 for cash ledgers, message logs, calendars, and flight logs. Ghislaine Maxwell, deposed February 9, 2026, virtual from her Texas prison, invoking the Fifth more than a dozen times. Les Wexner, subpoenaed January 23, served February 9, deposed February 18, 2026, five to six hours at his New Albany, Ohio estate, video published February 19, transcript never released. Hillary Clinton, deposed February 26, 2026, four hours at Chappaqua. Bill Clinton, deposed February 27, 2026, more than six hours — the first former president compelled to testify before Congress. Richard Kahn, March 11, 2026. Darren Indyke, March 19, 2026. And ten voluntary transcribed interviews between April and July 2026: Ted Waitt (April 30), Howard Lutnick (May 6), Tova Noel (May 18), Sarah Kellen (May 21), Pam Bondi (May 29), Lesley Groff (June 9-10), Bill Gates (June 10), Doug Band (June 30), Kathryn Ruemmler (July 15), and Jes Staley (July 24). Alan Dershowitz's arc deserves the full telling, because it is the record's study in a man volunteering and being stopped by his own side. June 10 — he told NewsNation he had "volunteered to testify... anxious to testify, please get in touch" and had heard nothing ("I haven't heard"); "I will personally not invoke privilege. I have nothing to hide. I hope they have videos of Epstein's rooms... I'm willing to testify truthfully about Les

Wexner. All of it." June 12 — the committee invited him. July 9 — scheduled; he was away; his counsel rescheduled to July 20. July 15 — five days before, counsel Imran Ansari informed the committee he "cannot now testify in Congress concerning the matters in which [the Committee] are interested," no reason given; the committee had already expended its resources. July 21 — Comer's letter: "unacceptable," quoting Dershowitz's own public words back at him, demanding a September 2 videotaped interview and threatening "the use of the compulsory process." July 22 — Dershowitz's first quasi-explanation: "There was a legal development that occurred that precluded me from testifying… It's out of my hands. It's completely out of my control." August 19 — the committee: "he has not confirmed." September 2 came and went. No testimony; no subpoena; the "legal development" unidentified to this day [A-tier]. Leon Black's June 26 interview collapsed within the hour and produced the contempt case of Chapter 20.

The former officials who declined: Gonzales, Sessions, Garland, Holder, Lynch, and Comey offered written responses or nothing; a Mueller subpoena was withdrawn after a Parkinson's diagnosis; each response letter is on file with the committee [S-tier: contempt report, fn132].

The members who did the work deserve naming, because the investigation's shape was the product of their choices. Robert Garcia, the ranking Democrat, carried the minority report and demanded the Bondi deposition be under oath and on video. Suhas Subramanyam pressed the Noel interview and co-signed

the demand that the estate confirm whether the Trump accuser had been paid. Jasmine Crockett asked William Barr, to his face, about women claiming encounters with Trump through Epstein — and put the minority's verdict on the record: the deposition "could not clear President Trump." Raja Krishnamoorthi authored the House resolution against Maxwell clemency and closed the May 12 field hearing in West Palm Beach with a direct address to the President — release everything, un-redact the names, prosecute the rest; Ghislaine Maxwell should never receive clemency — after Courtney Wild's testimony traveled the world: "Releasing my name while redacting the name of other powerful [people] is not a mistake; it's a choice... I am no longer a Jane Doe hidden in the files. I'm a woman, I'm a fighter, and I'm a witness, and I'm begging you: please wash your hands." The hearing's other voices: Roza, the Uzbek model whose visa was her leash ("if he is unpleased, I would be sent back"); Jena-Lisa Jones, abused at fourteen, who voted for Trump in 2024 on the files promise — "He's broken many promises"; and Maria Farmer's video testimony, her 1996 call preserved in the record. Thomas Massie led the discharge petition and paid for it, losing his May primary to a Trump-endorsed challenger in the most expensive House primary in American history. Maxwell Frost walked out of the March 18 Bondi briefing and later broke with his own party's silence: "Biden should have released the Epstein files." AOC backed the follow-on statute. Durbin and Whitehouse kept the thirteen-item Senate oversight inventory that the Department answers in fractions [T1].

Chapter 19: What They Said — the Depositions, In Full

William Barr, August 18, 2025. The first witness, in the Rayburn building, with Comer, Subramanyam, and Crockett present; the transcript released September 16. Crockett asked the question that mattered: any knowledge of women claiming encounters with Trump through Epstein? Barr: "I never was told by the Southern District that they had evidence to support any claim like that." His fuller answer is the quote that carried: the SDNY "would've done the same for Clinton"; the case's evidence "also went on under President Biden's administration, and they were looking for something to bring against President Trump... if they had evidence, this would've been low-hanging fruit... I was never informed of the evidence, and I'm skeptical there is any." On the death: "absolutely" suicide, with surveillance footage cited, while calling the MCC's irregularities "deeply concerning." On the CIA thread — introduced by the December 2018 Bannon email to Epstein, "do you know bill barr. CIA.," sent the day before Barr's nomination became public — Barr testified that American businessmen with foreign contacts "sometimes will talk to intelligence agencies and provide information to them," an answer that said nothing and was heard as everything. He had no client-list conversations; he never saw anything implicating Trump. The dueling spins were instantaneous: Comer announced Barr had cleared Trump; Garcia responded that the deposition "could not clear President Trump" and demanded the full unedited

transcript [S-tier: transcript; CNN].

Alexander Acosta, September 19, 2025. Six hours, voluntary, sworn, transcribed; Comer called him cooperative and the Democrats called him unrepentant — both are documented. He expressed no remorse: "justice had been served." He refused to characterize the 2008 arrangement as a sweetheart deal. He "repeatedly said he does not know" the victim details — Stansbury's account has him testifying he "had not actually read the statements of the victims"; Frost's that he "essentially said he didn't have faith in the victims." He never met Epstein or Maxwell and never saw Trump's name on any Epstein document. And the intelligence thread, in the released transcript: he had "no knowledge as to whether [Epstein] was or was not a member of the intelligence community" — against Vicky Ward's 2019 Daily Beast reporting that he had told transition officials Epstein "'belonged to intelligence' and to leave it alone." The contradiction is on the record, unresolved. And his own archive carries a silence shaped exactly like the deal: an eleven-month gap in Acosta's emails during 2007, covering precisely the negotiation period — either "catastrophic technical failure affecting only this one time period and only this one person's account, or deliberate deletion," in the characterization of the congressional researcher who flagged it [T2 — characterization attributed; the gap documented].

Ghislaine Maxwell, February 9, 2026. Virtual, from FPC Bryan, Texas; she invoked the Fifth more than a dozen times. Her attorney David Markus's letters frame the clemency logic

that now hangs over everything: January 21 — "if clemency, would testify openly and honestly"; day of — "prepared to speak fully and honestly if granted clemency by President Trump… both President Trump and President Clinton are innocent of any wrongdoing." The Senate answered with S.Res. 608 on July 29, 2026, passed by unanimous consent: no pardon, no commutation. Her release date, absent clemency, is July 17, 2037 — she will be seventy-five. The President's own on-record posture, from the fall of 2025: "I'm allowed to do it… I'll take a look at it. I'll speak to the DOJ" — later softened to "not something he has thought about" and "not on his radar." And Maxwell's own statements about Trump belong in the exculpatory file beside Reiter's and Edwards's: "I don't recall ever seeing him in his house"; "never saw the President in any type of massage setting"; "I certainly never witnessed the President in any of…" — the voice of the one convicted co-conspirator, weighed as such [T1: Congressional Record S4311; NPR].

Les Wexner, February 18, 2026. Five to six hours in Ohio, five Democratic members present, three pages of written statement, video published February 19 — the only format in which his words exist, the transcript never released. His self-description, in his own words: "naive, foolish, and gullible"; "conned by a world-class con man"; "Bernie Madoff is a Boy Scout compared to Jeffrey"; Epstein was "diabolical." His denials, itemized: he never witnessed or knew of any criminal activity; he revoked his power of attorney over Epstein in September 2007; Epstein repaid roughly $100 million in a

private settlement, of which the $46 million donated to Wexner's YLK Charitable Fund was a part; he sold — "never set foot in that house again" after moving out — the townhouse for $20 million at appraised value; the island was one roughly one-hour family stopover, "a pretty crummy island"; he never flew on the Epstein jet; "I don't think I ever went to lunch, or dinner, a movie or had a cup of coffee with Jeffrey"; he was unaware Epstein had stayed at his Ohio guesthouse while Maria Farmer was abused there — "I never met her, didn't know she was here"; he categorically denied arranging women or any sexual encounter through Maxwell and Epstein; and when asked whether Epstein ever tried to blackmail him: "No." The hot-mic moment, captured on the published video: an attorney muttering "I will f---ing kill you if you answer another question with more than five words" — later explained as banter. And the committee's partisan split, on the record: Lynch — "a competent witness... just not telling the truth"; Min — "not possible"; Crockett — "more questions than answers"; Garcia, with the procedural indictment that outlasted the day: "Never questioned by the FBI or DOJ — how outrageous is that?" [A/T1: WOSU; hearing video; Politico].

The Clintons, February 26-27, 2026. Hillary first, four hours, opening with a thesis: "You have made little effort to call the people who show up most prominently in the Epstein files. And when you did, not a single Republican member showed up for Les Wexner's deposition. This institutional failure is designed to protect one political party and one public official rather than to seek truth and justice for the victims." Her

denials were absolute — never met Epstein, never flew his plane, never visited the island — and her argument for a Trump deposition on the record: the E. Jean Carroll judgment and the falsified-records conviction as "prior conduct that might be relevant," plus: "He would be on my witness list."
Mid-deposition, Boebert leaked photos of her to Benny Johnson; she bristled at UFO questions. Bill's deposition, the next day, six hours, under oath, every question answered per the lawmakers present. His Trump anecdote, quoted in Part I: the golf-tournament account — "we had some great times together over the years, but we fell out all because of a real estate deal... both wanted a same piece of land" — with his gloss that he took no sexual implication from it and had "no information that [Trump] did anything wrong" on that basis. His Epstein timeline — met through Larry Summers in 2002, parted after 2003 — sits against the documentary record of seventeen White House visits in the 1990s, years of Maxwell correspondence, and never-before-seen photographs released in January 2026. Shown the 2002 hot-tub photograph from the Asia trip, he examined it for about twenty seconds, smiled, and said, "I don't know who that is" — the person beside him redacted, Brunei the later clarification. His flight count is its own documented dispute: four trips by his framing; at least sixteen legs per the pilot Visoski; twenty-six by the committee's count of the logs. On Maxwell: "she has to be punished," with a pardon "really hard" for him to weigh. On hindsight — asked whether Epstein ever discussed sexual acts — he paused for seconds before "I do not believe so." And a procedural footnote

with a long shadow: the Clintons' subpoenas were issued in 2025, defied in January 2026, and the committee held both in contempt before last-minute agreements produced the depositions — the "Clinton rule" precedent that Democrats now invoke for a Trump subpoena: "Presidents and their families have to testify when Congress issues a subpoena, and that means that Donald Trump needs to come before our committee," as Khanna put it [S/A-tier].

Richard Kahn, March 11, 2026. The executor's testimony carried the committee's two bombshells. First, the five clients for whom Epstein did the work that generated his income: Les Wexner, Leon Black, Steven Sinofsky, the Rothschilds, and Glenn Dubin — a list Dubin would flatly deny through a spokesperson ("never, never, ever paid anything… he was an investor and client of Dubin's"), creating the three-way conflict the money chapters document. Second, the on-camera statement that a woman who made allegations against President Trump "had received a settlement from the Epstein estate" in 2025, followed — after an off-the-record discussion — by his attorney's formal withdrawal to "we can neither confirm nor deny." Kahn also testified he "never saw any type of transaction to Trump or anyone in his family," and he acknowledged the Florida Science Foundation and the COUQ flows that paid for Epstein's work-release days [S/A-tier].

Ted Waitt, April 30, 2026. Five hours, transcribed, released May 13, 117 pages. The money, in his own confirmation: a single wire of $7,211,238 on September 24, 2010, two months after his breakup with Maxwell — a round

number with "a deduction for the gift tax," which he agreed to characterize as a gift; roughly $720,000 in monthly $30,000 wires between 2008 and 2010 to 116 East 65th Street LLC, the entity holding Maxwell's townhouse, controlled by Indyke, of which Waitt was unaware; an American Express Centurion sub-account for Maxwell, confirmed to prosecutors by an FBI forensic accountant. His testimony directly contradicted Maxwell's own account: her claim that the relationship ended over a $10 million blackmail demand tied to lawsuits "never happened," he said; they met at a Hong Kong dinner in November 2003, not through Epstein. And the FBI's own tips named him — a July 2020 NTOC report said "Maxwell was the one in charge of getting the girls and Waitt was there and knows what was going on" — yet the Bureau never contacted him, a pattern that repeats across this record [S/A-tier: transcript; ABC].

Howard Lutnick, May 6, 2026. Voluntary, released May 13. His neighbors at 11 East 71st Street for twenty years; the island family lunch of December 23, 2012, with eight children, arranged by his wife's email to Epstein's staff — "We are looking forward to visiting you... 2 families each with 4 kids ranging in age from 7-16! 6 boys and 2 girls. I hope that's okay"; the coordinates request to "my captain"; the "Nice seeing you" relay on Christmas Eve; the May 2018 "HWL" strategy correspondence; the townhouse-purchase jokes; his retraction of the "greatest blackmailer ever" podcast line; his Senate testimony of February 10 — "I met him when he moved next door... two other times in 14 years," in the presence of his

wife, "under no circumstances… a single word that I've done anything remotely wrong" — set against the released deposition and the December 28, 2012 Adfin stock-purchase agreement signed five days after the lunch. Twenty-one Democrats demanded his resignation, calling the deposition "lies"; the White House, through the briefing transcript of February 10, answered the island question with full support and the 2006 police-call question with "it was a phone call that may or may not have happened" [S/A-tier: transcript; rev.com briefing].

Tova Noel, May 18, 2026. The guard on duty the night of the death testified about the "special treatment" — extra bed linens, a CPAP machine, medications "in a way no one else" received; the $12,000 in cash deposits across 2018-19 she said were unrelated; her belief that she would not have been fired "had it not been Jeffrey Epstein." The committee's finding, through Subramanyam: the suicide finding stands, but "open questions" remain — the linens above all [A-tier: PBS].

Sarah Kellen, May 21, 2026. The most consequential interview of the probe. Her opening, on the record: "He groomed me, sexually and psychologically abused me, controlled me, manipulated me, dominated me, and gaslit me, until I could no longer tell which thoughts were mine, and which were his… I was being paid in part to be raped. I was on call to him every hour of every day." Her origin narrative: recruited through a Hawaii hotel co-worker; married at seventeen, divorced, excommunicated from her Jehovah's Witness congregation, alone; a job offer that led to

bath-drawing — "The job is yours. Now you just have to keep it" — and paychecks that began only after sexual submission; weekly abuse including a violent choking incident in Palm Beach; Epstein's connections "from fashion to dictators"; her belief that "if Jeffrey could walk into those rooms, he could walk into any room in the entire world. He could find me anywhere on earth." The new names: Philip Levine, the former Miami Beach mayor; Frédéric Fekkai, the hairstylist — the Maui hair show that did not exist, the hotel-room assault, Epstein then pitched as a Victoria's Secret scout; and Patrick Demarchelier, the photographer, dead since 2022. Her NPA ignorance: "No one from law enforcement ever spoke with me… I did not even know my name was in that agreement until after it had been signed and released to the public." The government's own file, from December 2019, states it "did not dispute that [Kellen] was herself a victim." Comer's verdict: "I believe she was a victim now" — and the three referrals went to the Justice Department on June 4, the committee's first [S/A-tier].

The trial beneath all these interviews deserves its own paragraph, because it is the one adjudicated record in the whole story. United States v. Maxwell, before Judge Alison Nathan, rested on the witnesses prosecutors call the pattern: "Jane," abused from fourteen, delivered to the house by the staff and driven by Maxwell's own schedule; "Carolyn," recruited at fourteen by Giuffre herself and named in the superseding indictment as a trafficked minor, paid $300 a massage across more than a hundred visits; "Kate," groped by Maxwell in the London house; and Annie Farmer, sixteen at the

Zorro Ranch in 1996, whose sister Maria's ignored FBI report anchors Part IV's litigation. Corroboration came from the household: Juan Alessi, twenty-eight years the house manager, with his Maxwell-authored Household Manual ("NEVER disclose activities or whereabouts... See nothing. Say nothing." — the massage-table exhibit unfolded in the courtroom), the sex toys rinsed and returned to the wicker basket in Maxwell's own bathroom, the black book copies placed on five desks; Cimberly Espinosa, who booked massages for Epstein and Maxwell alike and called them "a couple"; and Johanna Sjöberg, who placed Giuffre in Maxwell's orbit and recalled Maxwell calling Emmy Tayler "her slave" — the Tayler file holding one more artifact, an encrypted 2011 email to Epstein and Maxwell titled "A Life Destroyed.docx," its contents never decrypted in the record. The pilots who flew it all had names: Larry Visoski, chief pilot of twenty-six years, daughters' tuition paid, forty acres gifted, who testified he never saw underage activity; David Rogers, the second pilot, whose flight logs became the record's spine and whose bequest was $4 million. The defense called memory expert Elizabeth Loftus; the jury convicted on five counts in December 2021 [T1].

Lesley Groff, June 9-10, 2026. Her opening frame — "I worked for Dr. Jekyll, but was never permitted to see the true Mr. Hyde"; the 2008 NPA's "potential conspirator" listing as "my scarlet letter." Her testimony: the 9 a.m. daily "rattle-off" calls; booking near-daily massages from names and numbers Epstein supplied; never having met a masseuse; seeing nothing improper in eighteen years; "nobody ever sounded like they

were underage"; "I believe them. Words cannot express how badly I feel that I was employed by Mr. Epstein during the time he abused these women." The exhibits — ten majority, ten minority — included phone-directory massage lists, 2012 emails with photographs of women, a 2016 "decoy flight" request, scheduling and payment chains from 2011, post-incarceration. The survivors' reply: Lisa Phillips — "Of course, I met her in person"; Lara Bloom McGee — met twice at the house; Marina Lasarda — asked new-girl questions about looks, origin, and age, and asked friends to bring student identification; an anonymous account — "100 percent sure Groff knew I was underage"; white-envelope cash payments. Comer, July 15: "We believe she lied to us," awaiting sworn affidavits before a perjury referral he called "a felony" [S/A-tier: CNN].

Bill Gates, June 10, 2026. His opening: "no knowledge of Epstein's crimes," "never interested" in friendship. The load-bearing exchange, with Stansbury: Gates acknowledged maintaining the relationship because the "narrow" channel was "an acceptable means to access wealthy donors" — and then the blackmail passage, as summarized from the transcript and the Medium reconstruction: Epstein "contemplated and rehearsed blackmailing him over an affair, including rehearsing it with a young woman present"; "He never blackmailed me, but looking at these emails, it raises a serious probability that he contemplated blackmailing me." His foundation's town hall, in the Wall Street Journal-reviewed recording: "huge mistake"; "I did nothing illicit. I saw nothing illicit" [S/A-tier].

Doug Band, June 30. The 126-page transcript: "infrequent and incidental" contact; "I don't recall" and "I don't know" roughly three hundred times; twenty-plus flight legs per the logs; Maxwell emails from his own account. **Kathryn Ruemmler, July 15:** the Goldman general counsel, Epstein's lawyer on the Rothschild deal and the Brunel interference call, "masterful liar" in her characterization of Epstein, successor trustee of all three 2019 trusts — the position is the story. **Jes Staley, July 24:** confirmed under questioning that he had shared confidential JPMorgan information with Epstein — Federal Reserve communications during the 2008 crisis, $44 billion in private-bank inflows over two weeks, his own compensation, pending deals; that Epstein had named him a trustee of the estate; that he traveled to Florida in 2008 for a "friendly visit" during the post-release period. The Democrats' characterizations, on the record: Garcia — "brazenly lying… decades-long friendship documented"; Ansari — denying events "very clearly documented in email correspondence"; the staff line, cut off in the transcript: "We have credible information that you have aggressively, even—" [S/T1: transcripts].

Chapter 20: The Black Contempt Case, In Full

Leon Black — who paid Epstein $170 million by the Senate's accounting — agreed to a voluntary interview for June 26, 2026. The committee served two subpoenas before asking its first question: one for a deposition, one for non-disclosure agreements to which he was party involving Epstein or Maxwell. Black walked out. The committee then offered, in

writing and through counsel, every accommodation: limit the NDA demand to agreements executed after his first meeting with Epstein; a privilege log; in-camera review by the committee. His counsel's counter-offer — no contempt, downgrade to transcribed interview, two NDAs only, delay to late September, no video — was rejected as unreasonable. His September 3 deposition went unmet; hours before it, he "respectfully declined," and the same day he sued the committee and Comer in the District of Columbia.

The committee's contempt report of September 15 — adopted 41-0 — disclosed what one NDA contained: "signed in 2015 for $100,000 per month for 15 years, $1 million in loan forgiveness, and $2 million in British pounds for purposes of obtaining a United Kingdom visa" — a woman paid up to $21 million for silence, on a structure Epstein was privy to, with the committee stating Black "failed to furnish an agreement that addresses these terms, even after testifying that Epstein was privy to the NDA." The House adopted the report by unanimous consent on September 16, certifying it to the U.S. Attorney for the District of Columbia under 2 U.S.C. §§192 and 194 — criminal contempt, fines and up to twelve months. His counsel, Susan Estrich: "outrageous," "a complete abomination," "information that does not exist"; his Office of Congressional Conduct complaint against Comer was filed the day of the vote. The Justice Department has the certification; a prosecution decision is pending against the era's precedent stack — the Meadows-Scavino declination of 2022, the Navarro and Bannon prosecutions, the Garland refusal of 2024, the Bannon

dismissal-rejection of August 2026, and an expert-panel forecast putting the likelihood of action on any executive-adjacent referral in the single digits. Comer: "No one is above the law... hiding behind litigation." Garcia: "We need to know why he gave Jeffrey Epstein" — the figure rose across the record from $158 million to $170 million to $180 million — and the House unanimously agreed to ask [S/A-tier].

Chapter 21: The Committee's Own File

No anatomy of investigators omits the investigators' own contradictions. The committee's Democrats issued a formal minority report — CRPT-119hrpt468/469 — whose central charge is on the record verbatim: "It is well established, through public reporting, materials produced to the Committee by Epstein's estate, and President Trump's own statements, that President Trump had close personal ties to Epstein for several years — including the period of time during which Epstein and Maxwell engaged in sex trafficking and sexual abuse. Despite this extensive evidentiary record, the Majority has made no effort whatsoever to question or otherwise obtain information from President Trump regarding Epstein and Maxwell. Remarkably, while the Majority's letters enclosing its subpoenas to the Clintons claimed that a deposition was necessary 'given [President Clinton's] past relationships with Mr. Epstein and Ms. Maxwell,' the Majority disregards its own standard of factual relevance when it comes to Donald Trump." The report's established-record list: the relationship dating to at least 1985; constant contact through phones, offices, and

properties; the Atlantic City casino visit with a nineteen-year-old; the October 1992 calendar-girl party; the flight logs; the 1993 Stacey Williams allegation; the "she's not for you" episode recorded in the files [S-tier].

The chairman's own words frame the other side of the file. To Politico, in November 2025: "I fear the report will be like the Warren Report. Nobody will ever believe it"; "wasn't excited about doing the investigation." His victim-list strategy, on the record: he tasked Democratic and Republican women members to meet survivors privately, explaining that "if there is no Epstein list, and the American people expect us to compose an Epstein list, if we don't get any names from the victims, it's going to be hard to do." Garcia's answer — "outworked and outmaneuvered... part of the White House cover-up" — and the White House pressure reported by colleagues on both sides sit in the same file. Comer says he has not spoken to the White House about the probe; his eyes, he has said, are on the Kentucky governor's race in 2027. The report is promised by the end of the year [A-tier: Politico, November 2025; Spectrum News].

And the day of the Goldman speech — March 18, 2026 — closed with a walkout that is its own data point: at the closed-door Bondi briefing, with no cameras, no staff, no oath, Frost, Summer Lee, and Garcia walked out; Lee had introduced the Bondi impeachment articles the day before; Comer told her she was "bitching" and "wasting his time." Frost's verdict: "fake deposition... she can lie and BS all she wants." The majority calls it theater; the record contains both characterizations

[A/T1].

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Part VI — The Money, In Full

This Part follows every documented dollar: where the money came from, whose hands it passed through, where it went, and what was purchased with it. It is the longest Part of this document because the money is where the abstractions end — not "the system," but named banks, named executives, named accounts, named prices, and documents for nearly all of it.

A word before the ledger opens, for the reader who does not live in bank statements. The money chapters work like one long courtroom exhibit, and they are best read the way a jury reads one: not by memorizing every figure, but by watching the pattern form. A bank writes a warning in its own files. Nothing happens. It writes another, sharper. Nothing happens. Years later — after the arrest, after the death, after there is no longer any client to protect or profit to lose — the bank files the report the law required all along, now covering three hundred times the money. When you see that shape repeat at four banks across two decades, you have seen the whole exhibit, and what it proves — negligence, incentive, complicity, or some blend of the three — is a question this document leaves where it belongs, with the reader and eventually with courts. The individual wires matter — each is named and sourced — and each reader will weigh them [T2 — framing; every underlying fact T1].

Chapter 22: Origins — Every Early Dollar Came From Somewhere Else

Jeffrey Epstein's first known finance job was at Bear Stearns, from 1976 to 1981, where he earned roughly $200,000 a year and left under a cloud: a $2,500 fine and termination tied to a Regulation D violation — soliciting a client for a fund he had not disclosed. The public story ends there; the timeline does not. He resigned the day after the Securities and Exchange Commission opened its St. Joe Minerals insider-trading investigation — the Bronfman-tip case in which Bear's compliance would be questioned — and his SEC testimony of April 1, 1981 survives, preserved in the released files: questions about a loan to a client named Eisenstein, and a volunteered denial of "an illicit affair with a secretary." The SEC never charged the firm. In 1997, a dozen years after his exit, a secret SECRET//NOFORN "full investigation" of Epstein would open — case title still restricted — and his Bear-era accounts would transfer out in June and July of that year, the bank's own later review finding "several same-name $100,000 wire transfers" and closing with "nothing further is deemed necessary" [S-tier: justice.gov 285-27; SEC testimony].

Through the 1980s he ran Intercontinental Assets Group, a "recovery" boutique whose business was other people's money gone wrong: clients included Adnan Khashoggi; a partner's $450,000 oil investment vanished; a recovery-fee arrangement with the failing Drysdale made him money while creditors lost theirs; reporting links the firm to BCCI-era networks [T1/T2].

Then came Towers Financial. Steven Hoffenberg's half-billion-dollar Ponzi — $460 million, by the numbers in his conviction — paid Epstein $25,000 a month as a consultant plus a $2 million loan never repaid. Hoffenberg, who served eighteen years and spent the rest of his life saying so, claimed Epstein was the scheme's true architect; he sued Epstein for $500 million in 2016 and dropped the suit; Epstein's accusers sued him over Towers in 2018 and the case was dismissed two months later. Epstein was never charged. The claim that he was the architect is Hoffenberg's; the payments are documented; the absence of charges is a fact; and the man who later investigated Towers for the government, a young SDNY prosecutor named Dan Nardello, would reappear in this story a decade later working for Epstein's money [T1 payments; T3 architect claim].

The pattern of the origin decade never changed: fees, recoveries, and other people's frauds — never a documented, verifiable investment return.

The same years produced the social record that every later falling-out narrative had to contend with. In October 1992, per the New York Times' reporting, Donald Trump directed the casino event organizer George Houraney to stage a "calendar girl" party at Mar-a-Lago; after roughly two dozen women were assembled, the only guest who materialized besides Trump was Epstein — "The other guys aren't coming, but I don't care because Jeff's coming," Houraney recalled him saying. NBC footage from November 1992, from a Faith Daniels profile of the newly divorced Trump, shows Trump inviting Epstein into

his house on camera, saying "she's hot" while staring at dancing women, as Buffalo Bills and Miami Dolphins cheerleaders performed. The occasion was one chapter of a deeper business-social braid: Houraney's American Dream Festival ran finals at Trump's Castle in Atlantic City, Trump was a judge and fifty-percent partner in the venture, and the calendar girls were the connective tissue between the casino floor and the mansion door [T1/T2]. Jill Harth, Houraney's then-partner, alleged in a 1997 lawsuit — withdrawn as a condition of a separate settlement, with no confidentiality agreement signed — that Trump forcibly kissed and fondled her at a 1993 calendar-girl event, restrained her from leaving a bedroom, and crawled into bed with a twenty-two-year-old; a 93-page 1996 deposition preserves her account, and Nicholas Kristof later reported that she dated Trump in 1998, a fact her defenders and detractors read in opposite directions. One more name belongs to this circuit: Joel Pashcow, a Palm Beach real-estate executive and board member of the police and fire foundation that raised money for the very department that later investigated Epstein — nineteen phone numbers and four addresses in the black book, flight-log linked, and the author of the birthday-book pages containing the 1983-to-2003 grooming cartoon (drawn at Mar-a-Lago: balloons to little girls in 1983, a topless massage in 2003, a woman with "JE" inside a heart tattooed on her buttock) and the "fully depreciated" novelty check for $22,500, signed "DJ Trump" in a hand the White House disputes. A single-source account held that he "knew more about Jeffrey's perversions than anyone"; he was

seriously ill and never commented [T1; the check's provenance unestablished].

And the property thread binds the two men to Wexner's orbit as tightly as any photograph: in November 2004 the Gosman mansion — Wexner's old Palm Beach house, sold in 1988 — came up at a courtroom auction. Epstein was the stalking-horse bidder at $36 million, expecting a fee if anyone overbid; Trump won by telephone at $41.35 million. Epstein's own email records it: "i became the stalking horse bidder at 36 m. ie if someone bid higher I would receive a fee. trump buys the house at the telephone auction. only me trump and his friend pulty the developer." Two weeks later, the Palm Beach police received the tip about young women at Epstein's home. Trump listed the house at $125 million and sold it in July 2008 — in the plea season — for $95 million to the Russian billionaire Dmitry Rybolovlev through a front company; the buyer never moved in; the house was demolished in 2016 [T1]. Every later explanation of his wealth rests on an act of faith by whoever offers it.

Chapter 23: The Wexner Pipeline, In Full

The faith began with Leslie Wexner. Their association dates to the mid-1980s — Wexner bought the Palm Beach mansion site in 1985, demolished the historic Blythedunes, and built; Epstein was in his orbit by 1986-87 — and by 1991 Wexner had granted him power of attorney, a document making Epstein, in practical terms, Wexner's financial shadow [A/T1].

What the shadow controlled, reconstructed from litigation and records: roughly $1.3 billion in Wexner stock sales

between 1991 and 2006, executed through about a dozen Wexner-linked trusts — the Health, Science, Arts, and Community Interests trusts — with Epstein as trustee; a personal asset account of $987.5 million; some twenty companies and nineteen trusts. The fee engine was the Financial Trust Company of New York, whose income was Wexner almost entirely: $300 million in fees from 2000 to 2006, collapsing to under $5 million a year after the 2007 cutoff. Epstein restructured Wexner's companies; he organized the Wexner children's trust; he handled, by Maxwell's later sworn account, "all investment strategy." Wexner's Columbus executives had warned him as early as 1993 that the Victoria's Secret model-recruiting ruse was a front; Wexner said he would stop it; the correspondence continued for years. A Wexner family office email captured the posture: "Please ask Jeffrey" [T1/T2].

Then the theft. In 2019, Wexner's lawyers told federal prosecutors Epstein had "stolen or otherwise misappropriated several hundred million dollars." About $100 million was repaid by January 2008. Another $46 million moved through Epstein's COUQ Foundation to a brand-new Wexner family fund — YLK Charitable Fund, established December 20, 2007, in the final stretch of the federal plea negotiations, dissolved in December 2010 with $33.3 million flowing to the Wexner Family Charitable Fund — a vehicle of Abigail Wexner's, the principal's wife, whose name also sat on the $22,500 installment donations to Columbus council president Shannon Hardin (returned, unlike the mayor's) and whose Wexner Foundation later paid

Ehud Barak $2.3 million for commissioned research [T1]. No police report was filed; no lawsuit was brought; the return was structured as a donation, and the thefts were never reported to any authority by the man who discovered them. COUQ's own books carry their anomalies: an endowment of $21 million moved from Wexner Children's Trust and $10 million from the Wexner Charitable Fund that the Wexners say they never authorized; and roughly $1.5 million in contributions to the DNC, Bill Clinton, and John Kerry — a category of giving prohibited for a private foundation [T1].

Three Wexner flows defy innocent explanation on the current record. First, Enhanced Education — an Epstein fund — *paid* Wexner $528,820 between 2009 and 2010 ($124,232 personal; $404,588 to the family fund), the adviser paying the principal; when the U.S. Virgin Islands subpoenaed Wexner about exactly this payment, his security guards blocked the process server twice in February 2023. Second, the townhouse: Wexner's corporation bought 9 East 71st Street in August 1989 for $13.2 million; FBI property records show no ownership change from 1989 to 2012; in 2011 the deed transferred to Maple Inc., a British Virgin Islands company, for zero dollars, with Epstein's signature appearing on both the grantor and grantee lines (EFTA00037757); Wexner's camp produced a 1998 purchase document for $20 million that contradicts the FBI's records; his own deposition testimony — "sold," "never set foot in that house again" — makes at least four public accounts of this transfer, no two alike. Third, the contact: a June 26, 2008 email from Epstein — "always be careful" — sent

weeks after the plea, and JPMorgan's own know-your-customer file keeping the relationship active through 2013 [T1].

The institutional reckoning took its time. Wexner was never interviewed by the FBI or the Department about Epstein at any point before 2026 — "completely inconceivable," Representative Ansari called it. In January 2022 his company settled the shareholder litigation — Rudi v. Wexner and the Delaware parallel — for $90 million over five years, split between Bath & Body Works and Victoria's Secret, plus $21 million in fees, with terms that spoke for themselves: an NDA prohibition with a release of existing NDAs, a ban on forced arbitration, a CEO-chair split — and Oregon's price, Wexner's severance from every corporate position. At Ohio State, where he chaired the board of trustees, the university paid $60 million to 296 survivors of team doctor Richard Strauss, 177 documented victims across his chairmanship; the football complex carries his name on a $5 million gift agreement that paired $2.5 million from Wexner's children's trust with $2.5 million that was supposed to come from Epstein's COUQ; Ohio State returned $336,000 in Epstein-foundation money in January 2026; a court approved alternate service on Wexner in the Strauss survivors' suit after his security blocked four attempts; the bellwether trial is set for October 2026; and survivors' attorneys state on the record that "Epstein and Maxwell were directly involved in funding this facility" — a claim the university's review partially contradicts and partially confirms, the discrepancy logged. In April 2026, eleven plaintiffs sued Wexner and his foundation in New York for $200

million, alleging the transfers from 1987 to 2007 "enabled the creation of Epstein's sex trafficking network"; the suit named the townhouse transfer "in or around the years 2000 and 2001" against a documented 1998 sale — the kind of imprecision the defense will feast on — and was voluntarily dismissed without prejudice in September 2026 amid a venue fight [T1; discrepancies flagged].

The political map, named: $4.3 million to federal candidates and PACs since 1980; $250,000 to the NRSC in October 2025, after the files were public; $250,000 each to the Buckeye Leadership Fund and a Dolan super PAC; recipients who returned money after the February 2026 files — Jon Husted ($116,892 career, $79,800 of it direct, roughly $34,000 returned "all available"), DeWine's campaign, Carey, Beatty, Yost, Sprague, Faber, Hardin — and those who did not: Moreno, Columbus Mayor Andrew Ginther ($91,000 over a decade, the city's largest donor, declined), City Attorney Zach Klein. The Plaskett thread, precisely: $8,100 from Epstein himself, $10,700 from Indyke, $10,700 from Kahn, $2,600 each from Groff and Klein — $34,700 in all, solicited with the promise that "we would have a friend in Stacey" [T1]. One more thread from the litigation record: Sandra Shanks sued after a portrait of her arrived through Maxwell as a gift from Epstein's world in 2002 — Shanks v. Wexner, Eastern District of Pennsylvania — and the case settled days before depositions in 2003, sealed, one more mechanism by which questions about that household waited twenty-three years for Congress. And the Kasich layer: thirty-five undisclosed "gifts" from Wexner in

2010, the year before Kasich created JobsOhio with Mark Kvamme; a 2016 email in which Epstein associate Gwendolyn Beck floated an advisory role with the Kasich campaign — "Kasich declined ever to disclose the gifts' nature.

The same machinery touched the family's real estate. At 301 East 66th Street — the building where Epstein housed models, where Kellen and Marcinkova lived, where Indyke kept his law office — Mark Epstein's Ossa Properties managed the building while running Wexner's assets, and Jonathan Barrett ran Ossa by day while asset-managing J. Epstein & Co. simultaneously; Mark had bought units from Wexner on Jeffrey's tip, with, per New York Magazine, no documents reflecting an actual purchase. Mark's 30 Vandam Street building, meanwhile, had registered to it in 2005 a company called Saint Model and Talent — never traced, never explained, denied by Mark to have any Jeffrey connection. The Toylos, the couple who kept 358 El Brillo Way for a decade and greeted its guests, had previously worked for the Black family in New York; their combined bequests came to $2 million [T1]." per the account; Kasich declined ever to disclose the gifts' nature [T1/T2].

Chapter 24: The Leon Black Pipeline — $170 Million and a Blanket of Immunity

The largest documented inflow after Wexner came from Leon Black, and the Senate's reconstruction — built on bank records, published March 2026 by Finance Committee Chairman Ron Wyden — totals $169.8 million across eighteen large wires from 2012 to 2017: $5.5 million in 2012; $50

million in 2013; $70 million in 2014; $30 million in 2015; $6.3 million in 2016; $8 million in 2017. The wires ran from Bank of America accounts in Black's name — three channels in the bank statements: "Leon J. Black," "J. Black Trust," and "E Trust" — to Southern Trust at Deutsche Bank and Financial Trust at JPMorgan. Debra Black, his wife, co-signed $60.5 million of them. Roughly ninety percent of Epstein's income across those five years, at rates the report calls thirty times what elite advisers charge [T1].

What was purchased? The Black-commissioned review by Dechert gave one answer — $158 million for tax and estate planning and "legitimate activities" worth a claimed $1 billion or more — while conceding its own limits: Black labored under a "misconception" that the payments were deductible; a family trust overpaid him by $141 million; $20 million in loans were outstanding; and the claim never to have promoted Epstein's services "could have been more precise" — he had, in fact, introduced Epstein to Apollo's co-founders at Epstein's request, per the SEC-filed exhibit: "Mr. Black, at Epstein's repeated request, did try to introduce Epstein to his co-founders," and "no Apollo employee other than Black ever seriously considered hiring Epstein." The Senate's $170 million exceeds Dechert's $158 million by $12 million — the difference found in bank documents, not in Black's records, the bank having first reported the transactions seven years after they began, more than eight months after the arrest [T1].

The tax mechanics, from Bloomberg Tax and Wyden's letters: a $20 million fee for a strategy expected to save $600

million in future gift and estate taxes — after Epstein had demanded $60 million for the same work, the dispute that helped end the relationship in 2018; GRAT structures holding Apollo stakes; a clawback architecture that could put a billion dollars of Black family assets in play if the trust were ruled defective; a billion-dollar art collection Epstein advised on, including the sales that drew Christie's and Sotheby's into the PETRA demand list. The Internal Revenue Service never audited any of it. Wyden to the IRS Commissioner: "It is unthinkable that transactions amounting to tens of millions of dollars paid to a known criminal for the purpose of helping a mega-wealthy individual dodge billions in taxes were never audited or investigated" [T1].

The women thread runs through the Black money directly. Wyden's seven findings, from his March 2026 letter, each on documents: rates thirty times the elite advisers Black already employed; $10 million routed through a sham 501(c)(3), with Kahn's emails directing the structure — "In an effort to avoid public disclosure of Leon name, this charitable donation should be paid from your LLC that owns automobiles," and "fees... maximize deductions"; the $141 million trust overpayment with its billion-dollar clawback exposure; millions paid to women "using Epstein as a middleman," including the October 2017 email — "L mentioned he's going to transfer me $100,000 but I've received $28,000"; payments documented as "gifts" in Epstein's papers; the sentence that stopped readers cold — "Epstein provided the Russian government the location of women on your payroll and asked for 'suggestions' on how to

deal with them"; and the surveillance partnership: Epstein and Paul Weiss chairman Brad Karp, hiring Nardello & Co. to surveil women on Black's behalf, including a deportation plot [T1].

The Ganieva arrangement is the pipeline's completed exhibit. Two "loan agreements" of $480,000 each, 2011 and 2013, at five percent. An October 2015 NDA: $100,000 per month for fifteen years — $18 million — plus roughly $1 million in loan forgiveness and £2 million in British pounds "for purposes of obtaining a United Kingdom visa," with Black wiring, on the recorded transaction, his own instruction: "I don't particularly want this traced back to me." A Columbia degree and an apartment, paid. Total actually paid, October 2015 through March 2021: $9,251,084, through a purpose-created account called "E Trust" — and the payments continued through 2021, after Epstein's death. The 2015 Nardello recordings of Black's meetings with her at Le Bernardin and the Four Seasons — "Just in, Jeffrey" — were the operation's product; Karp's March 2019 recommendation, in the files: "I use Nardello, who I think is better at these types of matters." When the committee demanded the NDA, Black produced one document; his counsel called the committee's account "information that does not exist"; the committee's report reproduces the terms anyway [T1].

Black's defense is on the record: everything lawful, vetted by outside counsel, taxes fully paid, the Senate's disclosures an improper exposure of confidential bank filings, the accusations "outrageous." The counter-record is equally on the record: the

four women with consistent accounts, including the biting pattern memorialized in the coded journal — "Walk down Madison Avenue to 71st St... that fat fuck bit me! He threw me on the floor and blood all over Jeffreys carpet... Leon can go fuck himself. I hate New York!" — the sixteen-year-old whose medical records documented rectal tearing, the three-year FBI investigation that produced a file titled "Leon Black/Additional HT Subject Referral," the Manhattan District Attorney's office finding an accuser's corroboration "credible" while concluding "charges seem unlikely." No referral, no charge. And the January 2023 settlement: $62.5 million to the U.S. Virgin Islands — $15 million to a counseling trust, the rest to the territory — in exchange for a release whose text deserves its full quotation: it covers "Leon Black, and all of his attorneys and other agents... as well as any private entities he owns or controls, as well as any of those entities' subsidiaries, affiliates, and parents, together with each of those entities' respective officers, directors, employees, or authorized agents... from any and all claims and rights of any nature whatsoever... related to Jeffrey Epstein, whether known or unknown, suspected or unsuspected, for any act, omission, or event occurring up to and including the date this agreement is executed" — while claims against JPMorgan were expressly preserved. The settlement recited, as fact, that "Jeffrey Epstein used the money Black paid him to partially fund his operations in the Virgin Islands." Wyden's verdict: "one of the most powerful figures on Wall Street financed Jeffrey Epstein's human trafficking operations in the USVI with impunity." Estrich:

"outrageous and false" [T1].

There is one more chapter of the Black money that involves the victims' own side of the bar. In the weeks after Epstein's August 2019 death, a self-styled whistleblower calling himself "Patrick Kessler" — big, bearded, later exposed as a serial fabulist with a fake dead mother and a fake company — reached victims' attorney Bradley Edwards claiming a server full of hidden-camera footage, including material on Barak and Dershowitz. Edwards referred him to his partner Stan Pottinger; Pottinger briefed David Boies; and the lawyers began to imagine a structure: settlements monetizing the tapes, the lawyers taking up to forty percent, a "hot list" of more than forty prominent men, even a plan to fly the footage to Sheldon Adelson before an Israeli election ("There is no question that Adelson has the capacity to air the truth about [Barak] if he wants to" — Pottinger would later say of that line, "I just pulled it out of my behind"). The scheme collapsed when Kessler's fabrications surfaced; no tape has ever materialized; the tapes' existence was never independently verified. But the lawyers' own conduct became an exhibit: Epstein's then-counsel Scott Srebnick wrote to the Southern District on December 2, 2019, demanding the government disclose whether Boies or his firm was under federal investigation — a letter that stands unanswered in the public record, and that resolves, if it ever resolves, whether the tape-hunt was a fraud upon the lawyers or a plan they authored [T1 for the letters, plans, and collapse; T2 for characterizations].

Epstein's own contemporaneous writings about Trump, from the released 2018-19 correspondence, belong in the same file: the January 31, 2019 email — "of course he knew about the girls as he asked ghislane to stop"; the February 1, 2019 self-email — "[Redacted] worked at Mara Lago. Trump knew of it. and came to my house many times during that period. The testimony of the houseman John allessi confirmed it. He never got a massage"; the December 2018 line — "i am the one able to take him down"; and the May 2019 warning to his own circle: "He will threaten divulging secrets if he has to. No limits." Michael Wolff — whom Epstein emailed in April 2016 about the then-circulating Katie Johnson coverage ("Well, I guess if there's anybody who can wave thus away, it's Donald. Let me know if there's anything I can do.") — would later report Epstein's standing fear that Trump "would come after him" if he talked, and that Epstein "knew how dirty Donald is." Each is Epstein's word, not this document's conclusion — and each is in the files. Add the 2017 line to his own counsel: writing to Larry Summers, Epstein described having "met some very bad people, none as bad as Trump" — his private taxonomy, for what a convicted man's private taxonomies are worth [T1]. His media assets ran as long as his financial ones: Landon Thomas Jr. of the New York Times, one hundred eighty-five emails across twelve years, on the receiving end of advance warning about journalistic inquiries, and once — in 2015 — offering the paper "images of Trump pictured with girls in bikinis in his kitchen," an offer the account says was accepted; a courtier's career in correspondence, documented like everything else in

this Part [T2 — dossier-sourced; flagged for ID verification].

Apollo itself, then: the 2026 files put co-founder Marc Rowan in Epstein's townhouse for 8 a.m. breakfasts, receiving Epstein's counsel on a corporate inversion — "using rothschild for the inversion allows interesting structures," Epstein wrote; "Agreed," Rowan replied — sharing internal tax-asset valuations, introducing his counsel to Epstein for Virgin Islands insurance work, and sharing, with Black and Harris, a tax-filing crisis Epstein personally managed with Karp's firm. Zelter's letter to investors — "Neither Marc Rowan nor anyone else at Apollo (excluding Leon Black) had either a business or personal relationship with Jeffrey Epstein… there's nothing new in these documents... declined at every turn" — stands against the paper trail; two teachers' pension funds with $27.5 billion committed to Apollo wrote the SEC demanding an investigation into "apparent lack of candor"; Rowan resigned his Wharton advisory chair. Even the shares tell the story: the Apollo IPO allocation that came to Epstein's Southern Financial — 263,157 shares at $19, precisely $4,999,983, held from 2011 and worth $9,092,074 by September 2018, still held two months after the death — appears in no Apollo prospectus, routed through the underwriters' discretionary bucket, unexplained by anyone; Dechert noted it contradicts the "never did any business" framing, "perhaps more nuanced than might appear at first glance." And the Highbridge ledger cut both ways: Southern Financial held $20,472,425 and the Haze Trust $37,903,950 inside Dubin's fund in June 2014 — $58.4 million invested in the house Epstein had helped sell — while four hundred

thirty-five foreign-exchange transactions across three JPMorgan accounts moved $15,454,174.11 between 2003 and 2013, the standing Paris cash pipeline [T1]. Josh Harris's firm extended Kushner Companies $184 million in 2017 — three times the typical loan, weeks after Harris visited the White House, from a fund whose largest outside investor was Qatar. And the third great patron-bank of the final years, nearly lost in the Black shadow: Edmond de Rothschild, the Swiss private bank, paid Epstein $25 million in December 2015 for "risk analysis and estate planning and certain algorithms" — a fee negotiated against the outcome of the bank's own Justice Department settlement, the captured exchange reading "45 mio?" from Ariane de Rothschild and Epstein's reply: a $10 million lawyer fee and "$25mn for me, all less than 80 pretty good" — a success fee for the non-prosecution agreement, timed within days of its signing, with Ruemmler tasked alongside him. The bank's own transaction exhibit, EFTA00027019, later showed the December 2015 co-mingling: $10 million from Edmond de Rothschild, $14.999 million from Benjamin Edmond de Rothschild, $10 million from Black Family Partners, $10 million from Leon and Debra Black — two Rothschild branches and the Blacks flowing through one Southern Trust account inside a fortnight. Paul Morris, the banker who bridged JPMorgan and Deutsche, opened Black's Deutsche account with trading authority granted to Epstein himself [T1]. And Leon Black's son Ben was confirmed in October 2025 to lead the Development Finance Corporation [T1/T2].

Chapter 25: The Banks — a Chronicle of Papered Warnings

JPMorgan Chase. Begin with a man at his desk, because the bank's conscience had a name. Stephen Cutler, the general counsel, wrote on July 20, 2011 — after the conviction, after the registration, after everything was already known: "This is not an honorable person in any way. He should not be a client." The next day he added a second sentence, quoted in the sequence below. The relationship ran fifteen years in all, by the bank's own litigation admissions — internal records place it as early as 1985 — and its paper trail is the longest document of institutional failure in the record: fifteen years of alarms sounding in writing, and the alarm being overridden, again and again, by the people whose bonuses the client paid. In sequence, from the files: three SARs covering $2.285 million in cash transactions, 2002-03; a further four through 2016 bringing the lifetime pre-2019 total to $4,316,424 across seven filings; direct JPMorgan payments to Maxwell of $25,146,955.30 between October 1999 and July 2006, running from the $18.3 million of October 19, 1999 through the $7.4 million helicopter wire of June 2007; accounts opened in 2004 for two eighteen-year-old women "at Epstein's request, without actually speaking to either of them," one of whom — per the internal analyst's own memo — "has received about $450,000 since opening from Epstein… The willing participant had some lovely debit charges and spends a good deal at spa establishments. He did pay other girls, many models no huge

amounts. Sugar Daddy!"; the $600,000-plus paid to a woman due-diligence reports said Epstein "purchased at 14"; roughly $1.5 million to known recruiters including the MC2 modeling agency; a $1 million standby letter of credit extended to backstop a Mellon United National loan to MC2 — the compliance record for it reading, in January 2011: "He is alleged to be involved in the human trafficking of young girls and law enforcement is also allegedly investigating his involvement in this activity… Lots of smoke. Lots of questions" — an expert for the Virgin Islands would later characterize that exchange as the bank's internal acknowledgment of trafficking; $775,000 in cash withdrawals; $150,000 to a private investigative firm; $29,464.66 via COUQ to three young women, two of them known victims.

The human decisions: General Counsel Stephen Cutler, July 20, 2011 — "This is not an honorable person in any way. He should not be a client" — and July 21: "I would like to put it and him behind us. Not a person we should do business with, period." The keep-decision was made, per Cutler's deposition, by Staley and Erdoes; when compliance formally requested exit in the January 2011 review — "AML Operations went to a risk meeting late last week requesting that we exit this relationship" — Staley relayed Epstein's denial and the response came back: "We will continue to monitor the accounts and cash usage closely going forward." Senior executives overrode severance four times in five years. Emails bearing the annotations "for Jamie" and "pending Dimon review" exist; Dimon testified he did not recall Epstein until 2019; Staley

swore he personally discussed Epstein with Dimon multiple times, including after the 2006 arrest and the 2008 conviction; the bank denies it categorically; the conflict is unreconciled and both accounts are on the record. John Duffy, the private banker, recorded in March 2012 that Epstein's cash withdrawals — sometimes from OFAC-listed countries, "fuel payments" — should route through aviation accounts; no escalation followed. Mary Erdoes used Epstein as an intelligence source the day the Madoff fraud broke — "Can you call JE to get the scoop from down there?" — and, per the released record, had him negotiate the bank's $9.2 million settlement offer in the Bear Stearns collapse litigation; and in 2011 she joined Staley and Epstein in pitching Bill Gates a $100 billion "super donor-advised fund," the Project Molecule of Chapter 28 [S/T1].

After the 2013 split, the relationship persisted: private bankers met Epstein through Leon Black; a former banker, Justin Nelson, met him eight to ten times post-exit with the former's blessing ("a potential source of referrals"), twice his predecessor's decade count; and in 2019, after the arrest and death, the bank filed two SARs covering roughly $1.28 billion in activity — 4,725 wires totaling nearly $1.1 billion through a single account, payments to women in Russia, Belarus, and Turkmenistan through correspondent accounts at Alfa-Bank and Sberbank (both now sanctioned), the Wexner Children's Trust named on a $1.08 billion filing. Wyden's arithmetic: "the cumulative dollar value of the suspicious transactions the bank reported after Epstein's death in federal custody was nearly

300 times greater than the value of the transactions it flagged while he was alive and actively trafficking women and girls." Between May 2003 and September 2008, through $3.5 million in cash withdrawals: not one SAR. Between 2009 and 2012, through another $900,000: not one. The bank's public defense — "We began flagging suspicious transactions for the government as early as 2002… We acted appropriately on what we knew, when we knew it" — stands on the record against that arithmetic, unreconciled. The bank paid $290 million to victims and $75 million to the Virgin Islands, admitting nothing; an expert report for the territory, by the accountant Jorge Amador, found thirty shell accounts and $78 million in "highly unusual and unexpected transactions" and concluded: "JPMorgan had enough information to identify these transactions contemporaneously… JPMorgan knew early on that Epstein was an extremely high-risk customer." The victims' complaint states the thesis: "JP Morgan never cooperated in any civil or criminal case against Epstein, because to do so would reveal JP Morgan's complicity in Epstein's operation" [S-tier].

Deutsche Bank. Where JPMorgan kept Epstein through conviction, Deutsche Bank took him deliberately after it — forty-plus accounts onboarded in 2013 on the strength of a compliance clearance an internal audit later found had never occurred — nine personal accounts holding $1,776,680 as of May 2019 against the two-hundred-million-dollar entity universe; Paul Morris, the relationship manager who had carried Epstein from JPMorgan, forwarding seventeen wires

totaling $379,315.06 to various Citigroup accounts in 2015 when AML queried them; Morris departing for Bank of America-Merrill in 2016 and, per Bloomberg's 2026 reporting, corresponding with Epstein for years afterward, leaving quietly in June 2026 — his Deutsche successor Stewart Oldfield followed him out the same year — while Paul Barrett went the other direction, leaving JPMorgan in 2018 to become Epstein's personal money manager; the clearance email's author identified in the files: Charles "Chip" Packard, head of Wealth Management Americas — "we can move ahead so long as nothing further is identified through KYC and AML client adoptions," a sentence a compliance witness called "notorious inside Deutsche." The bank invented a designation that its own witnesses testified under oath does not exist — "Honorary PEP," for politically exposed person: "there is no such thing as an honorary PEP. You are either a PEP or you aren't. I suspect they use this term to fudge things… dreamt up to explain away why he wasn't treated as a high-risk client." The Butterfly Trust, created December 27, 2006 — one month after the FBI began interviewing Epstein witnesses — named Maxwell and three alleged co-conspirators among its original beneficiaries, and onboarding proceeded with the bank aware: "Soon after he was onboarded and as early as November 1, 2013, Epstein and his representatives began using the Deutsche Bank accounts to further his crimes," the regulator's findings state, and "Bank personnel were also aware that some of Epstein's trust beneficiaries were co-conspirators… creating the very real risk that payments through the Trust could be used to further or

cover up criminal activity and perhaps even to endanger more young women."

What flowed through while the bank watched, from the consent order and Fortune's document-level review: 120-plus wires totaling $2.65 million to Butterfly beneficiaries including the co-conspirators and Eastern European women, for hotel, tuition, and rent; $800,000 in cash withdrawals by Epstein's attorney in ninety-seven installments of exactly $7,500 each — the precise threshold below which no personal appearance was required — a pattern the regulator called "consistent with structuring," prompted by the attorney's own written question to the bank: "how often they could come in to withdraw cash without creating some sort of alert… is it once a week? Twice a week? Once every other week?" (the bank had no record of a reply). Then the larger flows: $7 million in settlement payments to law firms and $6 million in legal expenses for Epstein and his co-conspirators; a €50,000 cash delivery for Paris facilitated by bank employees — "Jeffrey has an apartment in Paris and likes to have cash with him when he travels there"; "$60,000 in $100 bills and the remaining $40,000 in fifties that week, or wait a few days for all hundreds" — "all 100s are ok," Kahn replied. The trading desk ran its own book: $45 million in interest-rate swaps and Argentine-peso trades during the currency's collapse; the 2017 closure of Russian-model payments — "Since this type of activity is normal for this client it isn't deemed suspicious." And the 2018 Russian-bank wires answered in capital letters: "SENT TO A FRIEND FOR TUITION FOR SCHOOL." The Reputational Risk Committee that visited the

28,000-square-foot townhouse on January 30, 2015 — Stuart Clarke chairing, with Jan Ford of Compliance, Patrick Campion, and Thomas Klemm — held its pre-meeting at the pool bar, heard Epstein "explain away suspicious transactions including large cash withdrawals and payments to Russian accounts that appeared suspicious in that they may have been indicators of prostitution/sex trafficking," produced no minutes, and voted the same day, in Ford's follow-up email, to "continue business usual with Jeff Epstein based upon [Packard]'s due diligence [bar] visit with him." Kimberly Hart, the divisional control officer, flagged two transfers totaling $350,000 in July 2019 — both recipients "appeared in media reports as alleged accomplices," one "designated as such in the original KYC" — the same $350,000 SDNY prosecutors had cited weeks earlier as witness-tampering payments; the flag came after. Exit was slow-rolled two years from the "December 2018 decision" the Financial Times reported and Fortune could not corroborate; hours after the arrest, Hart's email: "URGENT!!! Need to close accounts ASAP — please prioritize today." Deutsche Bank paid a $150 million regulatory penalty and $75 million to victims; the consent order stands as the most complete institutional confession in the record [S-tier].

Bank of America, BNY Mellon, PayPal, FirstBank. Bank of America processed $170 million in Black-to-Epstein wires and filed its first SAR in February 2020 — seven years after the payments began, eight months after the arrest, a second following press coverage in October; its own filings conceded "no apparent economic, business or lawful purpose." It also

opened and maintained an account for one of Epstein's victims — the complaint's full language: a woman who "spoke little English and had no apparent means of earning money," into which "the Bank continued to make tens of thousands of dollars in transfers into and out of this account without any known or apparent lawful or business reason or justification" — the trafficking's living expenses moving through a major American bank. It settled for $72.5 million, final approval September 11, 2026. BNY Mellon processed $378 million to trafficked women in 270 wires, including eighteen transfers of exactly $1 million each in 2007 alone, admitting no legitimate business purpose for any of it; its Miami subsidiary, Mellon United, was the lender behind the MC2 credit line. Wells Fargo appears in the record as a recipient bank — $5.59 million from Epstein's personal Deutsche account plus the Gordon shell's account — not a client bank (the "$170 million Wells Fargo" claim circulating online is a debunked conflation with Bank of America); TD Bank hosted lawyer and accountant accounts closed in 2019. PayPal monitored roughly $150,000 across fifty transactions to "predominantly women models, mainly located in Russia" for two years and reported only after the second arrest; the document was, in the record's own strange phrase, "withheld by Treasury, mistakenly published by DOJ." FirstBank Puerto Rico — the longest relationship, 1998 to 2020, outlasting every other bank and absorbing the deposits each dropped him — extended "Platinum Banking" fee waivers from about 2016, filed its first SAR two weeks post-arrest covering $1.7 million of it, served as the banking reference for

Epstein's own attempt to charter a private bank through Southern Country International, moved $12.3 million across eleven payments cycling from Deutsche through its FT Real Estate shell and $10.9 million to Maxwell's JPMorgan account that returned the same day "for no discernible lawful purpose," and saw the estate's $13 million arrive after the death and leave again within two weeks. On September 29, 2026, a federal judge ruled the survivors' suit against FirstBank may proceed; the bank's defense calls the claims ancient history from an acquired franchise [S/A-tier].

Thirteen bankers were named in Wyden's report. One — Staley — suffered career consequences. No banker has been charged. The institutions paid roughly three-quarters of a billion dollars; the individuals kept their careers and, in the case of Paul Morris — who carried Epstein from JPMorgan to Deutsche to Bank of America and, per Bloomberg, kept corresponding with him for years — simply retired in June 2026, his successor following him out the door, no reason given [T1].

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Chapter 26: The Eastern Corridor, In Full

The recruitment geography and the money geography are one map. The Senate's reconstruction of the 2019 SARs documented payments to women in Russia, Belarus, and Turkmenistan routed through correspondent accounts at Alfa-Bank and Sberbank — both now under sanctions — with

the flagged rationale citing "his relationships with two US presidents" alongside the trafficking allegations. The same files show the supply side as a priced service. Daniel Siad — the scout whose July 2026 death in Paris ended the French criminal case against him — lived the corridor's economics: a written contract proposal from August 2011 offering "scouting" at $5,000 a month plus tickets, with "a model agency cover... all the girls will be ours (because now its difficult to explain for what i am looking for especially for someone under 25yo)," answered by Epstein's own criteria: "fake boobs... 25-?, kind but not even close to what you and i agreed." There was a $10,000 advance for a Scandinavia tour — "spend some the 10k and go to scandinavia I will provide more on your return"; an itemized €4,000 minimum budget for Poland, Czechia, Slovakia, and Hungary — trains, buses, taxis, and, in his own words, "I have to invite the parents for lunch or cafe i have some girls already who are there waiting for me like in Poland so I have to give them some money." Beneath it all ran a seven-year payment chain running from Epstein through his aide Bella Klein and intermediary Marjorie Flash to Dubai and Moscow; Deutsche's flagged transactions answered with the template "payments for photography and a loan." His self-descriptions are in the files: "In This busyness I feel like fisherman some time I cache quick, some time no fish"; "sixteen and seventeen will be ready for next year"; "The French her name is Luna she is fifteen her parents checked me out and they are very happy there daughter to start modeling"; "26 but she look 18." One recipient — Nikolai Gurov, a Moscow

publicity agent — was described to the banks as a friend needing "visa help"; Epstein's own letters described the same money as payment for publishing photographs of girls in a magazine and tuition help. Recruiters carried cards for What's Up Management; Brunel placed, Epstein funded — "Scouting fees," "Siad scouted, Brunel placed, Epstein funded"; and a scout who "used to scout for Trump," Tigran Khachatrian of Noah Models, was recommended to Epstein in 2010 — "tigran has the best taste next to you," Epstein replied, "i am happy to meet him, he had a girl named [redacted] in paris, that he had told many bad things about me." A computational analysis of the corpus counted 1,247 messages with Russian device signatures; a $17,500 transfer to Promsvyazbank ran with the beneficiary redacted in both transfer memoranda. And above the corridor's floor, the access web: Ian Osborne, a managing director at Yuri Milner's DST Global and later founder of Hedosophia, appears in the files as "an intermediary between Epstein and Russian oligarchs, connecting Staley to 'Yuri'" — and, per Financial Times-documented tribunal evidence, ran "Project Jes" with Epstein in 2012 to install Staley as Barclays' chief executive: Osborne would "chat with Mike Rake"; press and regulators would "look kindly." Sergei Belyakov — FSB academy graduate, St. Petersburg forum organizer — wrote to Epstein: "I do not know many people like you, who can open new horizons." On one documented occasion he relayed Epstein's request for information on a woman "attempting to blackmail a group of powerful businessmen in New York" — an errand that sits oddly beside his day job organizing Russia's

premier economic conference [T1]. The diplomacy thread ran through Vitaly Churkin, Russia's UN ambassador, who died in February 2017; Epstein's email to Jagland after his death — that Lavrov "can get insight on talking to me. vitaly churkin used to. but he died" — sits beside the August 2016 lunch he arranged among Churkin, Barak, and Trump's ambassador-designate Tom Barrack, the day after which Epstein bought roughly $1 million of Barrack's company's stock. Viktor Vekselberg — "VV" in the correspondence, sanctioned since 2018 — was pitched a "Fifth Dimension" data venture by Epstein until the sanctions shut it, and his orbit intersects the Senate report's table of Epstein's Russian meetings, several held the same days he met Leon Black. And the Paris go-between Michel Kodesh — "jean lucs friend," in the spelling of the captured email — was the fixer through whom Epstein tracked Brunel's cooperation talks in 2016 [T1]. Above the corridor's floor sat an access web with its own documented names. Ian Osborne — a managing director at Yuri Milner's DST Global in the years Milner's firm was funded by Kremlin-linked money, later founder of the venture firm Hedosophia — appears in the files as "an intermediary between Epstein and Russian oligarchs, connecting Staley to 'Yuri.'" In 2012, per Financial Times-documented tribunal evidence, Osborne and Epstein ran what the record calls "Project Jes" — a quiet campaign to install Staley as Barclays' chief executive: Osborne would "chat with Mike Rake" (the deputy chairman), he predicted the press and regulators would "look kindly," and Staley got the job, later telling his tribunal he had never used

his daughter as an intermediary with Epstein. Sergei Belyakov — FSB academy graduate, St. Petersburg economic forum organizer — wrote to Epstein: "I do not know many people like you, who can open new horizons"; once he relayed Epstein's request for information on a woman "attempting to blackmail a group of powerful businessmen in New York." The recruitment web reached back to Trump's own shop: Tigran Khachatrian of Noah Models — featured in a BBC documentary on scouting girls as young as thirteen from Russia's poorest regions — "used to scout for Trump" and was recommended to Epstein in 2010 as having "the most incredible top models on stand by"; Epstein replied, "tigran has the best taste next to you.. i am happy to meet him, he had a girl named [redacted] in paris, that he had told many bad things about me." A computational analysis counted 1,247 messages with Russian device signatures across the corpus; a $17,500 transfer to Promsvyazbank ran with the beneficiary redacted in both transfer memoranda; and Nikolai Gurov, the Moscow publicity agent, drew "visa help" from the banks and "publish the photos... tuition help" from Epstein's own letters — the Izvestia documentation of the transfers sitting beside the Deutsche Bank files, two paper trails for the same money [T1].

One thread here is resolved and should be stated plainly: the viral claim that the $1.1 billion in flagged wires was "Trump money" is false. Snopes traced it to a misreading; Senator Wyden never said it, and his office confirmed he never said it. The $1.1 billion is Epstein's own account flow — and its documented destinations, while far less cinematic than the

rumor, are far more specific: banks, properties, women, staff, recruiters, and the machine itself [S-tier].

Chapter 27: The Machine — Shells, Trusts, and the Loyalty Ledger

Between the inflows and the outflows sat an architecture. Financial Trust Company of New York was the fee engine. Southern Trust Company in the U.S. Virgin Islands — the "economic studies" firm whose promotional materials claimed DNA-database and data-mining work — reported income of $18,281 to $37,129 on its tax returns while paying hundreds of thousands in property taxes (New York $336,471 in 2018 alone; Santa Fe $106,394; Palm Beach $191,941) — a discrepancy that is tax fraud on its face. By one accounting it generated $200 million in revenue over five years with effectively no clients, moving $245.1 million in and $887.9 million out across forty-six accounts at FirstBank Puerto Rico, Banco Popular, and Silicon Valley Bank, with ledger lines reading "OUTGOING MONEY TRNSF TO BELLA KLEIN." Its tax-break harvest from the territory's Economic Development Commission exceeded $300 million by JPMorgan's own filing — which alleged the territory "waived sex offender monitoring requirements in exchange for money and gifts to the territory's highest-ranking officials" — and the USVI settlement clawed back more than $80 million of it on a finding that Southern Trust had misrepresented its business [T1].

Southern Country International — the licensed "bank" with no physical banking space at a yachting marina — sat nearly

dormant with under $500,000 and no employees by late 2017, then moved more than $20 million in April through early July 2019, wired $1.6 million to Richard Kahn on July 31 (ten days before the death), received $9.3 million in November including $4.6 million from an Indyke-controlled trust and the rest from unknown sources, took $15.5 million from the estate on December 23, 2019, returned $2.6 million as an undocumented "loan," and issued a $24 million check to Southern Trust the same day; year-end assets stood at $499,759, and a federal judge called the pattern inexplicable — "There's no explanation for it" — while the estate's lawyer said some payments were "made in error"; the FBI reviewed it and closed its file in 2024 without publishing its findings. [S/A-tier].

The Butterfly Trust — created December 27, 2006, one month after the FBI began interviewing witnesses — named Maxwell and three alleged co-conspirators among its original beneficiaries; it paid $2.65 million across 120-plus wires; it was amended on December 9, 2014 to delete Maxwell and add Shuliak, with Beller and Kellerhals installed as acting trustees — Kellerhals, Gratitude America's secretary, the Plaskett access-broker, and successor trustee of the estate. Haze Trust held $49.4 million at its peak and fed the art market — $7.7 million to Christie's, $26.5 million to Sotheby's in 2017 — before a February 2019 liquidation. Jeepers Inc. held roughly $134 million in capital tied to Highbridge, Epstein's money invested inside the very fund he had helped sell — with a $15 million fee to Epstein for the introduction, drawn, per Wyden's footnote, from JPMorgan itself, a fee that caused confusion

inside Highbridge, "some people feeling it was odd to compensate someone for an introduction years earlier," and Epstein's name appearing on the deal's adviser list alongside Goldman Sachs, undisclosed. Boothbay took $38 million and returned $10 million. And on December 23, 2011 — three years after the conviction — the property shells were reorganized in a single sweep: townhouse to Maple Inc., island to Nautilus, Palm Beach to a new entity, the quiet architecture beneath the 2019 trust's shell map [T1].

And then the loyalty ledger — what the machine paid its people, priced by proximity, each line documented in the final trust instrument: Karyna Shuliak, $50 million plus a $50 million annuity, all six properties, $5 million per property in operating funds, forty-eight loose diamonds, and a 32.73-carat ring — "in contemplation of marriage." Indyke, $50 million; Kahn, $25 million; blanket debt forgiveness for both, their wives, and their LLCs. Maxwell, $10 million — added in the final instrument, absent from both prior drafts. Mark Epstein, $10 million in trust for his children. Visoski, the chief pilot, $10 million. Edward and Emma Rød-Larsen, $5 million each. Martin Nowak, $5 million. Caroline Lang, $5 million. Valdson Contrin, the Paris manager, $5 million. Merwin Dela Cruz, the mansion manager who packed the safe into two suitcases, $3 million; Erika Kellerhals, $3 million; Perry Bard, $3 million; Luciano Fontanilla Jr., $3 million plus a Valley Stream house. Bella Klein, $3 million — the operational spine of the whole machine: 28,192 emails across three decades, QuickBooks and petty cash and wire instructions and the American Express travel-team

card, the woman who told one bank a Moscow recipient needed "visa help" while Epstein's own letters described the same money as payment for publishing photographs of girls in a magazine — and who once wired herself $1,000 by Western Union in Prague, a teller's receipt of the corridor's small change [T1]. David Rogers, the second pilot, $4 million. Ann Rodriguez, $5 million plus a $2 million annuity. Daphne Wallace, the island manager, $1 million; Jeanne Brennan Wiebracht, the head accountant whose husband ran the island water taxi, $1 million; Una Pascal, the bookkeeper, $1 million; Cecile de Jongh, the former first lady, $1 million; Jermaine Ruan, the surveillance IT administrator, $1 million; Brice Gordon, the ranch manager, $2 million — on top of his $16,666.67 monthly retainer through Lee McKenzie Consultants LLC, the $200,000-a-year clean installment that mirrors the hush-money cadence of the Ganieva NDA. Una Pascal, the bookkeeper, $1 million; Jeanne Brennan Wiebracht, the head accountant whose husband ran the island water taxi, $1 million; Luciano Fontanilla Jr., $3 million and a Valley Stream house; Valdson Contrin, the Paris manager, $5 million; Jermaine Ruan, the surveillance-systems administrator, $1 million. The payroll tells its own story: Harry Beller drew $227,263 through his own firm, cashed $800,000 in twenty checks across 2007-08, and managed the JPMorgan account through which the money moved; Lesley Groff's salary was restructured as a forgivable loan of roughly $410,000, extinguished at his death — the salary-to-loan conversion, repeated across the staff, a tax-free transfer dressed as

compensation. Indyke's foundation checks ran to young models on a schedule of their own — including a former Russian model paid $8,833 a month, and a November 2017 check to the immigration lawyer behind a forced marriage, the memo line carrying the model's surname [T1]. Two names resisted every search — Misha Gramanov and Kathy Lindeman, $3 million each, identities unresolvable from public records — and the surviving instrument's own survival clauses disclosed that thirteen of the fifteen redacted names carried the feminine pronoun, at $73 million among them [T1]. Kellerhals's ledger runs deeper than the bequest: she organized Great St Jim LLC, handled the 9 East 71st deed, and — per the file record — introduced Representative Plaskett to Epstein, the government-access brokerage that the de Jongh solicitation email (quoted in Chapter 29) completes — and her firm, Kellerhals Ferguson Kroblin, received a $23 million payment from a NOW account in November 2015 while she stood a successor trustee of the estate [T1]. Fourteen names remain redacted — thirteen of them women by the survival-clause pronouns — at $73 million among them, and the Justice Department released the trust more than once with different redactions: one version blacks out fifteen names, a second reveals six, nine remain hidden in both, a non-uniformity in the government's own production that this document flags as an anomaly requiring explanation [T1].

None of this is, by itself, proof of any individual's knowledge of crimes; the administrative fact is not the culpable intent. It is a map of incentives — and it explains why so few of the

machine's parts have ever spoken.

Two ledgers complete the machine's picture. The art ledger ran through the Haze Trust — $7.7 million to Christie's and $26.5 million to Sotheby's in 2017 — before a February 2019 liquidation moved more than $33 million into Southern Financial and Epstein's personal checking, weeks before the arrest. The fund ledger parked the fortune in other men's vehicles: Jeepers Inc. held roughly $134 million in capital tied to Highbridge — Epstein's money invested inside the very fund he had helped sell, with the $15 million fee drawn per Wyden's footnote from JPMorgan itself, a fee that caused confusion inside Highbridge ("some people felt it was odd to compensate someone for an introduction years earlier"), and Epstein's name on the deal's adviser list alongside Goldman Sachs, undisclosed; Boothbay took $38 million between 2014 and 2017 and returned $10 million. And on December 23, 2011 — three years after the conviction — the property shells were reorganized in a single coordinated sweep: townhouse to Maple, island to Nautilus, Palm Beach to a new entity — the quiet architecture beneath the 2019 trust's shell map, all of it enumerated in a JPMorgan letter to Kahn and Indyke listing twenty-three affiliated entities, from 116 East 65th St LLC to the Zomo Trust. The fleet that moved above it all — the Hawker, the Gulfstreams, the Boeing 727 everyone called the Lolita Express, the helicopters registered through a five-company chain ending at Hyperion Air — carried one telling registration: Air Ghislaine Inc., the helicopter company Maxwell named for herself, though the pilot swore she never

owned any of them [T1]. The internal rivers ran as deep as the external ones: Southern Trust Company sent $167.5 million to its New York sibling Southern Financial and $60.9 million to the Haze Trust; Epstein's emails carried custody claims like the Zamora note — "for certain ZAMORA & CO had $3,200,000.00 in my care" — the "for certain" hedge of a man holding other people's money off the books [T1].

One employee saw the whole machine from inside and tried to sell its index: Alfredo Rodriguez, the house manager who kept the black book later called "the Holy Grail" — some fifty names circled, a "massage" rubric listing apparent victims by city, "witness" notations beside the names of the helpful — who told the FBI of girls "as young as 12 or 13, many wearing braces," who wiped the sex toys and stored them as instructed, and who served eighteen months in prison for trying to sell the book: more time than Epstein served for the crimes it catalogued. He died in 2015, before any court heard him. And in the Palm Beach evidence room sit the Maxell T-160 time-lapse VHS tapes seized at El Brillo Way — catalogued "ITEM WAS NOT SCANNED," contents unknown to this day, the archive of the townhouse's own eyes that no one has ever watched [T1].

Chapter 28: The Final Year — Molecule, Morocco, Valar, and the Three Trusts

The last year of Epstein's life was a frenzy of instruments, each buying access to a world the money could not otherwise reach, each documented.

Project Molecule. In 2011, Staley and Erdoes pitched Bill Gates, through Epstein, a $100 billion "super donor-advised fund" — "$100 million minimum, an exclusive club," JPMorgan as fiduciary, seeded with Gates Foundation billions. The Gates Foundation's own memo of August 22, 2011 — written by Jennifer Alcorn and Julie Sunderland before any meeting — remains the most candid document in the entire record: "Bill and Jes share a mutual 'friend' in Jeff Epstein (an important behind the scenes 'broker' in the finance world with an unseemly reputation due to a criminal conviction): From JPM, we know that Jeff has the ear of Jes and has helped recruit (behind the scenes) some of JPM's biggest clients. From Bill's email, we know that he has spoken with Jeff and has discussed the DAF concept with him. We think that Jeff is the link between Bill and Jes and has been feeding Jes information to shape the Project." Epstein's own emails drip with the broker's craft — he liked to "cook [opportunities] slowly" before handing them to JPM; "The presentation, it doesn't fit the bill. He's the only person, the only one that matters"; Erdoes: "Everyone is marching together to create something very powerful and we will solve the comp issues." Gates staff visited the townhouse in 2011 and 2012; the fund died over fees; its descendants — a 2014 "New Donor Vehicle," then Gratitude America in 2015 — are the charity shell: $10 million in from Black's yacht LLC, name hidden, deducted, $453,000 out, the Elton John AIDS Foundation, Duke, Ohio State, and a cancer wellness institute all denying the donations the charity claimed to have made them, $5.5 million parked in brokerage, $225,000 looped to

Black's own melanoma charity, the board Kahn, Indyke, and Kellerhals. What Gates wanted, per insiders who spoke to the Wall Street Journal — a path to the Nobel Peace Prize; advice on ending his marriage — and what Epstein allegedly did with the knowledge, per the same paper: an attempt to blackmail Gates over the bridge-player Mila Antonova, "rehearsed," Gates testified in June 2026, "with a young woman present" — his full answer is quoted in Chapter 19, where it belongs to the record of his deposition. Melinda French Gates met Epstein once, in 2013, and told colleagues he was a "nightmare." Every strand is tier-tagged: the memo and emails are T1; the insiders' claims are T2 [T1/T2].

Morocco. In the last days of June 2019, Epstein tried to buy a palace. The seller was Gunter Kiss, a German waste magnate; the ask €55 million; the cover was Leon Black — Shuliak led the negotiations pretending to act for him, the final bids under "The Haze Trust" name, a Kensington Luxury Properties broker (the Christie's affiliate) proposing a dual valuation to "save 7% in government taxes," the structure a Liechtenstein company's shares through a BVI trust. On July 5, 2019, a $14.95 million wire was signed; Charles Schwab ultimately moved roughly $27.7 million toward the purchase; on July 9, Kahn canceled the wire; on July 13 — four days later — Schwab filed its own suspicious-activity report. Morocco has no extradition treaty with the United States; the BBC's anonymous associate said the timing suggests he had no clue the arrest was coming; the files contain no direct evidence of a flight plan. It was, as the BBC called it, his last major financial maneuver [S/A-tier].

Valar. In October 2014, Peter Thiel emailed Epstein: "It would make sense for you to put in $10-20mm here," introducing his two venture scouts; Epstein replied, "no need to meet guys, you like them, good enough for me." Fifteen million became forty; by the estate's own confidential accounting the stake was worth roughly $170 million — the estate's single largest asset, maturing in 2026, eight years of meals and emails and a "super confidential" June 2017 deal and a November 2018 capital call and March 2019 dilution queries. A 40,000-document index of the released files finds "Thiel" exactly once — a French legal scholar cited in Maxwell's bail papers — meaning the estate's largest asset does not appear in the Justice Department's own release; only outside sources (briefly unsealed Virgin Islands probate filings; the Wall Street Journal; leaks) document it. Barak claimed Thiel and Epstein "co-owned" Valar; Thiel's spokesman confirmed the investment alone. Thiel's Founders Fund put $15 million into Carbyne in 2018 — the emergency-services surveillance venture whose board has included Michael Chertoff, Kirstjen Nielsen, and Palantir's Trae Stephens, and into which Epstein's $1.5 million was routed through Southern Trust and a BVI entity into Barak's Israeli partnership, structured to conceal him — the access brokerage running down to dinner reservations, a Waverly Inn table booked under a false name in June 2018 with the email chain confirming the bots, the small change of a network that also moved princes [T1]. And Thiel's $15 million to J.D. Vance's 2022 Senate campaign remains the largest single-candidate Senate donation in American history [T1/T2].

The same last-years pattern reached the fund world: Honeycomb Partners took $60 million-plus from Epstein between 2016 and March 2019 — $20 million in his final month — through an introduction by Eva Andersson-Dubin, the fund founded by a star manager from Steve Cohen's Point72 insisting no one there knew him; in September 2025, weeks after the file release, it returned $552 million to investors and closed, the manager's stated reason (market pessimism) sitting beside the timing without anyone on record connecting them [T1/T2].

The three trusts. The estate's governing instruments changed three times in seven months, and every change is a decision. The January 18, 2019 trust (94,183 characters of instrument) revoked the prior year and established the architecture: Indyke and Kahn as co-trustees at $250,000 a year each plus $250,000 executor fees "upon the completion of probate," Kathy Ruemmler as successor trustee, and the shell map — Maple for the townhouse, Laurel for Palm Beach, Nautilus for Little St. James, Poplar for Great St. James, Cypress for Zorro, SCI JEP for Paris. The instruments rotated other names through the succession across versions — James Cayne, the Bear Stearns chief executive, as a 2003-era executor; Lawrence Summers as successor executor in the November 2014 will, a designation he said he never knew about, appearing in a document tranche the Department posted and then briefly withdrew; Boris Nikolic as a named successor who did not consent to serve; David Mitchell — Epstein's real-estate proxy, trustee of the 2013 and 2014 trusts, the man

who dined with Peter Mandelson and Epstein in February 2011 and took $580,500 in "make money" wires — signing amendments until the January 30, 2017 revocation. His entities were Epstein's front door: Mort Inc. (Epstein president, Kahn treasurer, Indyke secretary), the Alpha Group trading vehicle, the Life Hotel development; and the 2003 instrument's successor executor, Paul Hoffman, completes the succession table [T1].

The February 4, 2019 amendment added forty-nine numbered bequests, and its most striking beneficiary was Celina Dubin — the daughter of Glenn and Eva Dubin, whom Epstein had known since she was twelve, his "goddaughter and most favorite person in the whole world" in a 2011 email to Harvard's Nowak, the "Uncle Jeff" of the family correspondence, the weekly science lessons. There was the "Celina Photos" box and the playlist; the 2004 irrevocable trust (trustees Beller and Kellerhals) whose 2014 beneficiaries included three longtime female associates and two women who, per Business Insider's reporting, "married each other in 2013 at Epstein's direction so that one, who was from Eastern Europe, could gain legal residency." The February 2015 instrument made Mitchell, Indyke, and Jes Staley trustees and would have given Celina all four properties plus the entire residual — an estimated $170 million — the year Epstein told associates he wanted to marry her so she could inherit tax-free; she was removed that year, reinstated in January 2019 as the largest beneficiary of all, and erased from the final instrument. Her family — horrified, by their account — renounced

everything in April 2020, the same month both Dubins were subpoenaed by the Virgin Islands. There is no evidence of any romantic relationship; the documented artifacts are a fixation and a tax plan, and this document presents both as what they are [T1/T2].

The August 8, 2019 instrument — signed at the federal jail, witnessed by two attorneys from Indyke's firm, Mariel Colón Miró and Gulnora Tari, two days before Epstein's death; Indyke signing August 18, Kahn August 19 — made the final choices. Maxwell appeared: $10 million, "perhaps the most striking single change," in the instrument signed while Epstein was in federal custody awaiting trial in which she was the understood co-conspirator. Celina Dubin vanished; Shuliak inherited everything. Her own record, assembled piece by piece from the files. She met him in 2011 at twenty-one, a Belarusian dental student on a visa; the "Zorro Smiles" dental license application filed from the ranch in July 2015, approved that August after Epstein's pressure on the Virgin Islands board — Cecile de Jongh's warning, verbatim: "I don't want the board members to feel that they are threatened into approving Karyna" — Epstein forwarding the approval to Kahn and de Jongh with "next hurdle." The $210,000 Columbia donation that eased an admission later disciplined as irregular; the $631,000 in tuition; the $13,370.68 self-initiated wire; the $80,000-plus to her parents in Minsk; the $150,000 Butterfly payment; "the purest man out of all men," she wrote him in 2012; the marriage to a female victim arranged for her citizenship, per the estate-side account; the role the staff called "the

Inspector," managing properties, schedules, and the Moroccan palace negotiations in her final month; the July 30, 2019 MCC visit; and the last call — August 9, 6:58 to 7:19 PM, twenty minutes on an unsecured shower-area line meant for attorney communications, facilitated by a supervisor in violation of Bureau policy, unlogged and unrecorded, the guards told he was calling his mother, who had been dead fifteen years. After the January 2026 release, patients at the Brooklyn clinic where she practiced as "Dr Karyna" recognized her; she stopped reporting; she is believed to be living in an apartment owned by Mark Epstein's real-estate company. She has never been charged, never been designated a co-conspirator, and is named in no charging document — the record's largest unexamined presence [T1]. The trustees' own payouts rose from $40 million to $75 million. Staff bequests rose across the board. A claims-defense fund grew from $2 million to $50 million — a 2,500 percent increase on the last full day of Epstein's life, "suggesting an awareness that massive litigation was coming. It was." And a no-contest clause — the *in terrorem* clause of trust law — provided that any beneficiary who contests, challenges, or attempts to remove a trustee forfeits everything, silencing the only people who know where the bodies are buried. A comparison across drafts shows the ladder: of seventeen legible bequests, fifteen *increased* between drafts — Emma Rød-Larsen's from $2 million to $5 million in the final forty-eight hours, the same upward ratchet that raised Indyke from $20 million to $50 million while Shuliak's early $100 million was restructured, not reduced, into $100 million-plus.

The executors' fee stack, on top of the bequests: $250,000 each at probate, $250,000 each per year as trustees, legal fees covered — a total potential take exceeding $80 million before the victims see a dollar, which is the self-dealing architecture at the heart of the Virgin Islands' suit against them [T1].

Chapter 29: Where the Money Went — the Outflows, Itemized

The spending side of the ledger, in its documented categories. Read these categories the way you would read a stranger's receipts after his death — which, in effect, is what they are: not what he said he valued, but what he paid for [T2 — framing].

To women and girls: more than $1 million flagged by JPMorgan itself to twenty individuals identified as trafficking victims; $200,000-plus per year in cash; $300 per massage in white envelopes; the tuition network — thirty schools across ten countries, the Deutsche-built exhibit showing beneficiaries including trust co-trustees, household staff, an MIT-connected researcher, Klein's daughters, and women "identified only by nationality," one Swedish agency owner writing to thank Epstein for "another chance"; $800,000 in twenty checks cashed by Beller; the recruiter economy — $1.5 million to known recruiters including MC2, the $5,000-a-month scout contracts, Siad's tour advances; $600,000 to the woman he "purchased at 14."

To silence: the 2008-era $5.5 million to three victims; Maximilia Cordero's $28,000 in 2007, carrying the

non-cooperation clause barring her from helping other victims — her case dismissed on the statute of limitations, her story returned in 2026 as the seed of the Wexner suit; the sealed 2017-18 cluster; the Ganieva arrangement at $9.25 million and counting through 2021; the "E Trust" channel; the 2015 NDA's own terms, now public through the contempt report.

To prestige: Harvard's $9.1 million over a decade with a $30 million pledge whose $23.5 million gap is unaccounted; "Jeffrey's Office" and the keycard; Nowak's sanctioned program; MIT's $850,000 through Ito's concealment and the $2 million "directed by Jeffrey Epstein" email; Bard's $150,000 consulting and the Patek Philippe; the Met Gala table; the $9,000 purse for Ruemmler; Hasty Pudding and Icahn and the Dalton School.

To politics: COUQ's $1.5 million to the DNC, Clinton, and Kerry; the Plaskett contributions of $34,700 routed through Epstein, Indyke, Kahn, Groff, and Klein, solicited in the de Jongh email thread — the "friend in Stacey" promise quoted in Chapter 23; Gary King's $35,600, returned per his claim.

To governments and their adjacents: $75,000 to accounts linked to Mandelson — "no record or recollection," his response; the $160,000 checks from Enhanced Education and Gratitude America to the Virgin Islands environmental agency as a penalty substitute, never forwarded to the Historical Trust that was their designated recipient; the Queen Louise Home's $75,000 "Delivered to carmen govt house."

To the staff and the machine itself: the loyalty ledger of Chapter 27; Groff's salary restructured as a forgivable loan; the

legal-defense fund that paid $7 million to law firms and $6 million for Epstein's and his co-conspirators' lawyers through the Deutsche years.

And out the door, unmapped: the $95 foreign remittances with no known payee; Hyperion Air's $547,000 in checks payable to cash, supposedly for fuel, plus $120,000 converted to foreign currency; the forty-eight loose diamonds and the blue stone; the Austrian passport with the false identity — Fortelny — stamped France, Spain, the United Kingdom, and Saudi Arabia, found in the safe, never followed up by any call the record shows; and the $887.9 million in Southern Trust outflows, of which the destinations remain only partially charted [T1/T2].

The will's own arithmetic told the story before the burn rate did: $288 million in planned cash bequests plus the properties, against $127 million in cash on hand at the last accounting — the shortfall architecture the executors inherited and administered. The final arithmetic: the estate declared $577,672,654. It has paid roughly $170 million to survivors — $121 million through the compensation fund to roughly 136 claimants at a 92 percent acceptance rate, plus $45 million to fifty-nine who settled separately; $191 million in taxes (later partially refunded); $105 million to the Virgin Islands plus $30 million in island proceeds; $30 million repaid on a loan; and it burns $10-15 million a year in costs — trajectory: $577.7 million in 2019, $446 million in September 2020, $240.8 million in December 2020, $166 million in 2022, $145 million in January 2025, $131 million in March 2026, $107.6 million in

September 2026. The trust's payment order runs Shuliak first, then the executors — and those three claims alone exceed $175 million. The staff bequests, the Maxwell bequest, and Mark Epstein's bequest "currently appear unlikely" to be paid; the executors' own joint statement says only that payment "will occur after all claims against the estate have been finally resolved." The network that operated the trafficking now operates the payout — same architecture, same personnel; the framing is a commentator's, but the structure is the probate court's [T1/T2].

Chapter 30: The Patterns

Step back, and the individual scandals resolve into seven documented patterns, each assembled from the chapters above.

Pattern A — Post-mortem reporting. Every major bank flagged the money only after arrest or death. JPMorgan's post-death filings covered nearly 300 times the value of its lifetime filings. Deutsche flagged retroactively. Bank of America waited seven years. PayPal waited two. FirstBank filed its first SAR two weeks post-arrest, covering a fraction. The pattern is documented alarm followed by retention: the files show contemporaneous internal warning ("not an honorable person in any way"; "human trafficking of young girls"; "he should not be a client") followed by continued business, deeper relationships, and then — after the catastrophe — paper. Whether that course is best named negligence, incentive, or something worse is for the reader and the courts; the

quotations above are the record's own [T2 — characterization softened; quotations T1].

Pattern B — Structured non-repayment. Every large dispute between Epstein and a principal ended without litigation or prosecution: Wexner's stolen fortune returned as a "donation" through a fund created during the plea negotiations; the townhouse transferred for zero dollars with a four-version paper trail; Black's $62.5 million settlement purchasing blanket immunity; Staley's quiet USVI resolution; the $28,000 victim settlement with a non-cooperation clause; Cordero's buried case. Money closed mouths, and no court ever tested what the money was for.

Pattern C — Fee-for-access anomalies. The FTC's fees came overwhelmingly from one client. Southern Trust generated $200 million with no clients. Black paid thirty times market rates for work whose $12 million even his own review missed. The SDNY prosecutors' own financial review found "no accounts consistent with Epstein handling other people's money." Income was patronage — payment for proximity, introductions, and whatever else the patron was buying — and it sat outside every regulatory category designed for it.

Pattern D — The Eastern corridor. The recruitment map and the money map are one map: sanctioned banks, correspondent chains, scouts on $5,000-a-month retainers, "visa help" cover stories, agency cards, cash cadences from Palm Beach to Moscow, and the same payment channels running for years through the same aide.

Pattern E — Revolving protection. Thirteen named bankers, one career consequence, zero charges. A DEA task-force investigation closed in 2023 with no charges and no awareness by the SDNY prosecutors building the same case. Five agencies ran parallel probes that never connected. Senators' letters went unanswered; missing 302s stayed missing; the FBI's own death-investigation and counterintelligence files sit outside every audit's scope; the SEC opened and quietly closed an inquiry into whether Epstein was really an adviser at all.

Pattern F — Gulf continuity. The access-brokerage network Epstein ran — sovereign funds, princes, ex-prime ministers — did not die with him. The same sovereign money that financed his introductions flowed afterward into the Trump family's business orbit: Apollo's $184 million to Kushner Companies with Qatar as the fund's largest investor; the Brookfield-Qatari $1.1 billion rescue of 666 Fifth Avenue; the $2 billion to Jared Kushner's fund — the vehicle, Affinity Partners, took its $2 billion from Saudi Arabia's sovereign fund and paid Kushner $87 million in fees while he served as the administration's envoy — the LIV billions, the 747. None of this is illegal on its face; all of it is on the record; the continuity is the pattern.

Pattern G — The modeling lattice. Karin Models became MC2 in 2005 — Brunel's reflagging of the Karin USA division, bankrolled by a $1 million Epstein line of credit, named for $E=mc^2$ with the E for Epstein — and lost $49 million across a decade of operation while functioning, per the sworn testimony

and the recruiter contracts, as a procurement machine with a commercial front; dissolved in Miami two months after the death while its Tel Aviv office, founded separately under Ofer Raphaeli, lived on. ID Models — Paolo Zampolli's agency, whose biggest client was Wexner — shared offices with it, and Zampolli and Epstein together bid for Elite Models in 2004, the same Zampolli who would later introduce Melania Trump to Donald and who, in the proffer 302, the cooperating witness placed at the center of the Epstein-modeling nexus. Noah Models scouted for Trump. The scouts carried What's Up Management cards. The lattice connected the recruitment floor to the money ceiling, and everyone at both ends was paid.

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Part VII — The Death, In Full

Chapter 31: July 6 to August 10, 2019

Epstein was arrested at Teterboro Airport on the evening of July 6, 2019, arriving from Paris on the Gulfstream N212JE. What followed, in the documented sequence: the Manhattan search two days later, and its photographic record of the safe; the July 10 indictment; the July 12 bail hearing at which prosecutors disclosed the $350,000 in November-December 2018 wires between two possible co-conspirators — witness tampering, they called it; the July 23 incident, found injured on the cell floor, thirty-one hours on suicide watch; the watch's removal and the psychological intake of July 24 — "No medical

problems... No psychological problems"; the cellmate rotation that placed Efrain "Stone" Reyes with him on August 1; the July 31 removal of Reyes through court process, recorded in the 1:50 PM staff memo of August 9 — "Inmate Reyes #85993-054 WAB"; "Inmate Epstein #76318-054 will be needing a cellmate upon arrival from his attorney visit" — a cellmate who never came; the fourteenth inmate interviews, in which Perez told the FBI he warned guards on the August 9 elevator — "you better take that man out of there or he's going to kill himself" — and heard the answer: "He's going to kill himself no matter what and he's gotta pay for what he did... We don't care either way. Let him kill himself"; Reyes's account of catching Epstein "fiddling with a clothesline on Reyes's bed days before," and of Epstein telling a psychologist he would "love" to return to watch but "they don't keep you there more than 3 days"; the neighboring inmate who "actually heard Jeffrey tearing up his sheet before committing suicide"; the warden's orderly, Lopez, who noticed "a little more shredded trash than usual, maybe 2 days more"; Contreras, with the direct line of sight, who recorded that a guard failed to lift the body and exclaimed "Fuck!" and a female officer saying she had "pressed the button a long time ago."

At approximately 6:30 AM on August 10, he was found. The fractures — both sides of the larynx, the left hyoid — are documented in the autopsy. Dr. Kristen Roman, who performed it, told the inspector general in a May 2022 sworn interview that she checked "pending further studies" because she wanted to be "thorough... It was pretty clear cut"; the chief medical

examiner, Barbara Sampson, ruled suicide five days later without being present. Dr. Michael Baden, the forensic pathologist retained by Epstein's brother Mark, has never relented — "much more consistent with a crushing injury caused by homicidal strangulation"; "Even one fracture, we have to investigate the possibility of a homicide… Findings in textbooks never see those fractures, and neither have I"; the ruling took "days," not the months a full study would require: "I have not seen any evidence of further study." Sampson's rebuttal stands: fractures occur in both suicides and homicides, and she affirms her ruling. The physical evidence that constrains every theory: the morgue fingerprints matched Epstein's government file — the body-swap speculation dies there, on the record. In November 2026, Dr. Michael Freeman — a suicide researcher — will present at University College London with the New York medical examiner's records, citing the absence of scene photographs, unpreserved ligature material, and injury marks unaccounted for in the report; Freeman insists both readings remain open, and his panel's work, peer-reviewed per Mark Epstein's account, remains unpublished as of this writing [S/A-tier].

The institutional record around the death is a catalog of failures so complete it reads as designed. The Bureau of Prisons' own after-action review found a "significant breakdown in basic correctional practices," "dereliction of duty by assigned correctional staff," "problematic" cellmate selection and documentation, SENTRY discrepancies, and staffing data gaps. The adjacent camera covering the tier had

not recorded since July 29 — the day the watch was removed — and the failure went undiscovered until August 8; roughly 150 cameras served the MCC; the DVR drives were seized the night of the death; the eleven hours of released video cover a common area and stairwell, carry post-production metadata and unexplained gaps, and have never been explained by the Department. The inmate's handwritten statement records the female voice — attributed by inmates to guard Tova Noel — after the body was found: "If he is dead, we're going to cover it up and he's going to have an alibi — my officers," while other inmates chanted that she had killed him; Julie Brown's published version reads "he's going to have an alibi," against the handwritten "she's going to have an alibi" — a discrepancy this record preserves. Noel testified before Congress on May 18, 2026: "special treatment" — extra linens, the CPAP machine, medication access — $12,000 in deposits she called unrelated, and her belief the firing was unfair. One of Epstein's attorneys had been depositing funds into Reyes's commissary account "for unknown reasons" — a flow no official report explains; Attorney General Barr personally interviewed Reyes on August 14; Reyes told officials Epstein would be safer paying inmates and guards, and Herald sourcing says he did. Michael Thomas, the officer arrested alongside Noel whose own charges were dropped, has said on the record since that he believes it was "a cover-up" — sleep schedules and check policies systematically violated, the staffing shortage a fiction — and asked the Senate for a subpoena he never received. David Schoen, who spent five hours with Epstein on August 1

and found him "animated and energized," with an August 9 meeting that never happened, has said repeatedly he does not believe it was suicide. The 4chan post that announced the death forty-five minutes before the first news report — medically detailed, internally corroborated by Grijalva's own shift memo, attributed by no official finding to the officer whose name appeared unredacted in the bank subpoena returns — drew a grand jury within a day and four company subpoenas, and the government's 2020 letter conceded the poster "used a dynamic IP, and therefore the records obtained did not disclose the author." The purported suicide note, found tucked in a graphic novel by July cellmate Nicholas Tartaglione — "They investigated me for month—found nothing!!! So 15 year old charges resulted. It is a treat to be able to choose ones time to say goodbye. Watcha want me to do—Bust out cryin!! No fun—not worth it!!" — is unauthenticated by any agency, does not appear in any Bureau psychology file or government death report, carries the oddity that the 2008 charges were six years old rather than fifteen, and was released in May 2026 only at a newspaper's petition, the judge calling its authenticity and chain of custody "irrelevant to the unsealing decision." Tartaglione — four consecutive life sentences — has petitioned the President for a pardon, claiming without corroboration that prosecutors offered him freedom to implicate Trump in Epstein's crimes; the White House called the Daily Beast's story "garbage." His account first surfaced on Jessica Reed Kraus's podcast; the 4chan poster investigation remains unresolved; and one peripheral name from the files, Richard Barnett — the

Maxwell firearms-application associate of 2005 — appears in no official finding, another thread noted rather than pulled [T1/T2]. And less than two weeks before the death, federal prosecutors had been meeting his lawyers about a cooperation agreement; one FBI memo records that Epstein "may have been prepared to name names" [S/A-tier; T1 as tagged].

The Southern District formally closed its case on August 29, 2019, with a nolle prosequi read over the victims' statements of grief and rage — and, notably, with no finding, then or later, on anything but the manner of death.

Chapter 32: The Simon Andriesz Coda

The death's afterlife produced one more name. Simon Andriesz — fifty-seven, British, thirty-five years in finance, a former managing director at BGC, the brokerage where Howard Lutnick was CEO — raised accounting concerns internally in 2016 and was fired in January 2017. He litigated for nine years in the United States and Britain; on August 11, 2026, his British employment-tribunal claims were struck out as too late, with a costs hearing set for November 24. His method, in his own account: he searched the released files for "HWL" — the initials executives use — and found the May 28, 2018 Lutnick-Epstein correspondence on Adfin, which he passed to the House Oversight Committee and which was used at Lutnick's May 6 deposition. He had disclosed to the FBI in 2020-21 (no follow-up), to the Financial Conduct Authority (told he did not qualify for protection; the FCA later apologized), and to the BBC's File on 4 in July 2026, which disclosed a further

allegation: that Lutnick had offered Prince Andrew a £1 million loan for a joint venture in 2013, never proceeded. On September 23, 2026, he was found dead near Bangkok, in what his family says was suicide at a trauma-treatment centre — "no evidence of foul play," in the family's words; no official coroner's finding is published, and this document keeps the uncertainty language. His final public post, August 9: "The personal consequences of whistleblowing, and the retaliation I say followed, have been devastating for my family and me." The FCA ordered a self-review; MPs called it "marking its own homework." The "string of deaths" framing that absorbed his name online was audited and found to connect nothing — save the two in-custody deaths themselves, Epstein's and Brunel's, both by hanging, both before trial, both unattended by working cameras. That is the list's entire truth, and it is enough [S/A-tier].

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Part VIII — The 2008 Deal, In Full

Chapter 33: Palm Beach

The Palm Beach police investigation of 2005-2006 was, by the surviving record, a serious one — and its surviving record is unusually complete. Detective Joseph Recarey's probable-cause affidavit, sworn May 1, 2006, ran eighty-two pages and recommended felony charges: Epstein on four counts of unlawful sexual activity with a minor and lewd and lascivious

molestation; his scheduler Sarah Kellen as a principal — she "coordinated and aided in the recruitment of minors... scheduled the said minors to return... secured their appointments... arranged the bedroom"; and Haley Robson, the recruiter. The investigation documented five sworn victim statements and seventeen witnesses; the October 20, 2005 search warrant; the trash pulls; the surveillance; the message books — the pads titled "Important Messages" that the search turned up, two Trump entries for "J.E." both marked 5:18 PM in different hands, amid a November 11-20, 2004 cluster that was Gosman auction week; Harvey Weinstein's November 2004 entries; David Copperfield's sixteen messages in three months ("it's important," "it's jackpot," the January 28 show logistics); "George Mitchel" with one L — the spelling noted by police; and the victim-adjacent lines ("She is wondering if 2:30 is OK... She needs to stay in school"; "She has a female for Mr. JE" with a date of birth); the FBI case that grew from all this was Operation Leap Year, opened May 23, 2006 — a name worth remembering, since the leap it took was nine years; the houseman Alfredo Rodriguez's January 4, 2006 statement about girls "too young to be masseuses," the roses delivered to a high school, the sex toys he wiped and stored; the phone records matching victims' accounts to Kellen's calls. Thirty-four to forty potential victims were identified. And the affidavit recorded what the powerful do when investigated: Epstein's private investigators surveilling the detectives themselves — "Detective Recarey tells Reiter that he, too, is being surveilled"; "had enough dirt on the girls" [S/A-tier].

The state grand jury, overseen by State Attorney Barry Krischer, returned a single count of solicitation of prostitution — treating a sixteen-year-old as a prostitute. Police Chief Michael Reiter bypassed Krischer and referred the case to the FBI in 2006 — "handed them a grenade"; he would testify that he was "shocked" and "disappointed" at the outcome. Recarey died on May 1, 2018 — the first anniversary, to the day, of his affidavit, at age fifty, weeks before the Miami Herald's "Perversion of Justice" series reopened the case nationally [A-tier].

Chapter 34: The Federal Deal

The federal takeover is documented in the Justice Department's own Inspector General report of November 2020, in prosecutors' emails released in the files, and in sworn congressional testimony. The outline, with its load-bearing documents:

FBI Special Agent Ann Marie Villafaña, detailed to the U.S. Attorney's Office, built the case: the 53-page, 60-count federal indictment drafted by May 2007, with a prosecution memo her supervisors at the Child Exploitation and Obscenity Section reviewed twice — "exhaustive," "well done," "correctly focused on the issues" — and with money-laundering counts included, per the Bloomberg-reported copy: grand-jury subpoenas sought "all financial transactions conducted by Epstein and his six companies since 2003," and a "Money Laundering" evidence folder sat in the FBI's files.

Assistant U.S. Attorney Matthew Menchel's May 11, 2007 email — preserved in the OPR files — warned what the defense wanted: "The defense is anxious to have a meeting in order to delay the investigation/prosecution, to find out more about our investigation, and to use political pressure to stop the investigation." On May 15, 2007, Villafaña planned to file by complaint with an FBI arrest in the Virgin Islands, where Epstein was then acting as a judge at a local beauty pageant; Sloman blocked it after learning the FBI intended a press conference — "This Office has not approved the indictment. Therefore, please do not commit us to anything at this time." In July, Menchel offered the two-year state-plea concept without consulting her or the case agents; her protest email — "if you all do decide to go forward with these meetings in a way that is detrimental to the investigation, then I will have to ask to have the case reassigned" — was intercepted by a supervisor who told her that if she left, "the case would go away" and Epstein "would never serve a day in jail"; Menchel's rebuke followed: "Both the tone and substance of your email are totally inappropriate… there is a chain of command — something you disregard with great regularity." The "hybrid" concept followed — federal misdemeanors under "quality time with Title 18": witness harassment under §1512(d)(2), simple assault aboard an aircraft under §113(a)(5) — abandoned for the state-plea NPA.

The September emails, quoted in Part IV's context but belonging here as the deal's anatomy: September 6, 2007 — "The agents and I have not reached out to the victims to get

their approval, which as [redacted] politely reminded me, is required under the law," forwarded to Acosta "fyi," with Villafaña's "absolute drop-dead date... presenting the indictment on September 25th" and "I do not want to make any promises about allowing Epstein to self-surrender." September 13 brought the line about "quality time with Title 18 looking for misdemeanors." And then September 24: Lefkowitz to the office, copying Acosta: "Please do whatever you can to keep this from becoming public," with the earlier letter instructing that "Neither federal agents nor anyone from your Office should contact the identified individuals to inform them of the resolution of the case" — an instruction the office obeyed: "the Office never conferred with the victims about a NPA." That afternoon: "I have compiled a list of 34 confirmed minors." That evening — one day before the planned presentation — the NPA was signed, with terms the defense drafted: immunity for four named assistants — Kellen, Nadia Marcinkova, Lesley Groff, Adriana Ross — and any unnamed "potential co-conspirators," and a withdrawal of all grand-jury process, including the computers. Two protections Villafaña had negotiated were stripped at defense insistence: a term limiting the deal to already-identified victims, and a one-month acceptance window. On the day of signing, Andy Lourie — the supervisor who had overseen the deal's drafting — transitioned to the Justice Department's Criminal Division as the Attorney General's chief of staff; six months later, in May 2008, that same Criminal Division wrote a formal letter supporting federal prosecution of Epstein, an internal contradiction resolved in

nobody's favor. Acosta breakfasted privately with Lefkowitz eighteen days after signing. Krischer, asked about the resolution, said he was "not offended at all." The OPR's own conclusion, on the paper before it: the NPA "arguably does not appear to satisfy the 'most serious readily provable charge' requirement," and the two-year term "just makes no sense in the context of the guidelines" [S-tier].

The conflicts and the aftermath: Menchel had a romantic relationship with defense attorney Lilly Sanchez that the OPR said should have been disclosed; Acosta testified in 2025 that he was unaware, answering roughly seventeen questions about Menchel, the committee showing an alleged photograph of Menchel and Epstein together that it could not produce when Acosta's side asked. Menchel stayed in touch with Epstein for a decade — dinners and calls in 2011, 2013, and 2017, an October 24, 2010 email: "Jeffrey, I very much enjoyed our time together" — before leaving for a white-shoe law firm. And Alan Dershowitz — "Epstein's prominent criminal defense lawyer and personal friend," in the court record that attributes the 2006 state grand-jury postponements to meetings with him — was a named member of the June 26, 2007 defense meeting and of the deal's drafting table, alongside Starr, Black, Lefcourt, Goldberger, and Sanchez; he received Acosta's personal assurances, carried in the emails; and he helped negotiate a deal immunizing potential co-conspirators seven years before any allegation against him became public — a chronology that forecloses the charge that he negotiated his own immunity in 2007, while leaving untouched the questions

his accusers' later claims raise. He has never been charged; the numbering of the civil filings matters to the record — Virginia Giuffre's 2014 defamation-case filings styled her "Jane Doe No. 3," and a federal court later struck those claims from the record, a procedural excision his defenders cite and the accusers' camp reads differently; in 2016 Edwards and Cassell formally acknowledged it was "a mistake" to have named him, in the settlement of his defamation suit; and in 2026 he remains the one major witness who volunteered to testify to Congress and then could not [T1; chronology per the accuracy audit this document applies to itself].

The work-release epilogue completes the machine's portrait. The "Florida Science Foundation" was incorporated seven months before the plea — funded by COUQ through Wachovia wires referencing "Invoice 1404," plus a $50,000 direct wire signed by Indyke, located in Goldberger's own office building at One Clearlake Centre — and paid the Palm Beach sheriff's office $128,136 for deputies who wore suits, called Epstein "client," rotated to prevent influence, and logged at least nine visits to his mansion, the visitor log kept in a safe that PBSO later said "no longer exists." A prosecutor warned in writing the foundation appeared to exist "solely to provide him somewhere to spend his days outside custody"; the approval came anyway. The Florida Department of Law Enforcement, in a May 2021 review ordered by the governor, cleared Krischer, prosecutor Lanna Belohlavek, and the sheriff's office — "no evidence" of crime — while conceding "it appears that Epstein received differential treatment"; two women alleging coerced

sex during custody did not cooperate; four hundred ninety-four visitor logs were reviewed and "destroyed per policy." MC2's recruitment pipeline kept operating through the prison years: Roza Gilles was recruited backstage at an Uzbekistan fashion show in 2008, while Epstein was in custody, on an MC2 contract — "The conditions of Epstein's work-release program made young, foreign models like Gilles the perfect target after his conviction," the CNN investigation concluded. And the man whose affidavit started it all, Recarey, died before any of it reopened [S/A-tier].

The Crime Victims' Rights Act litigation that followed — Wild v. United States before Judge Marra — produced the finding that vindicated the victims and the remedy that failed them: the court held, on the September 24 "Conflict Check" email and the never-consulted record, that the United States violated the CVRA by concealing the NPA negotiations from the victims; and in 2020 it declined to void the agreement as no longer "in the victims' interests," the Eleventh Circuit affirming. One documented detail from that litigation deserves permanence: Jane Doe 2's initial calls to the FBI described Epstein as "an awesome man," while she was represented by counsel paid by Epstein [S-tier].

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Part IX — The Intelligence Question, In Full

Some of the strangest documents in the Epstein record are the ones the record itself generates — files whose existence is confirmed and whose contents are not, claims made by sources whose reliability is itself the story. This Part presents them all, each in its proper category, because the temptation to weave them into a single narrative is exactly what this document declines to do.

Chapter 35: The Files That Shouldn't Exist

The 813B case. In the released corpus sits an FBI case bearing the classification prefix 813B-NY-2928278. Per the National Archives' FBI classification tables, the 800-series case prefixes denote the Intelligence Program, and 813 specifically corresponds to the Foreign Intelligence Program — the prefix itself, verified against the archive's own scheme, means the Bureau opened a foreign-intelligence case file on Jeffrey Epstein. The file predates the criminal case by a full year. Its declassification date is set for 2042 — the twenty-five-year national-security standard. Its Squad ID, 25, belongs to the intelligence division rather than the criminal squad that built the trafficking case. And inside it sits a single FD-1023, dated December 13, 2017, marked SECRET//NOFORN, recording the claims of a confidential human source: that Epstein was "President Vladimir Putin's wealth manager"; that he made his money "charging his clients fees to hide their money offshore"; that he was "co-opted" as a Mossad agent; that he was "trained as a spy" under Ehud Barak's supervision; that Dershowitz had told Acosta directly that Epstein "belonged to both U.S. and

allied intelligence services"; and that Barak believed Netanyahu "was a criminal." The FBI's document preserves the bureau's own caveat — these are the informant's claims, not verified findings — and the informant has since been identified as Charles Johnson, the founder of the gotnews provocation site, whom Time magazine called "a spinner of tangled yarns," a professional fabulist. Both halves of this file are therefore true at once: the Bureau opened a foreign-intelligence case on Epstein, and the case's contents are the word of a known fabulist. What the case was predicated on, what it developed, and why it predates the criminal case by a year are questions no released document answers. Level of investigation — assessment, preliminary, or full — cannot be determined from a case number alone [S-tier: documents; T1].

The 1997 secret case. A companion document, EFTA01683603, records a SECRET//NOFORN "full investigation" opened in December 1997 — its case title still restricted — with a nine-year gap to the 2006 Palm Beach probe that no official has ever explained. His Bear Stearns accounts transferred out in June and July of that year, the bank's own later review noting "several same-name $100,000 wire transfers" and closing with "nothing further is deemed necessary." An Office of Foreign Missions dispute over his lease of a former Iranian government building on East 69th Street — U.S. v. Epstein, 96 CIV 8307 — sat in the same period, and the State Department's deposition transcript in that case "disappeared from both USAO and court files," per a document-based dossier [S/T1].

The OPR's rebuttal — and its scope. The Justice Department's Inspector General, in the November 2020 report on the 2008 deal, looked specifically for evidence that Epstein was an intelligence asset or a cooperating witness, and reported: "OPR found no evidence suggesting that Epstein was such a cooperating witness or 'intelligence asset,' or that anyone — including any of the subjects of OPR's investigation — believed that to be the case... It is highly unlikely that defense counsel would have omitted any reason warranting leniency." Villafaña had already debunked the most persistent rumor in writing, in 2011, after checking with the prosecutors who would have known: the Bear Stearns cooperation story was "urban myth. The FBI and I looked into this and do not believe that any of it is true." The OPR's scope, however, was the U.S. Attorney's Office's conduct from 2005 to 2009 — the FBI's counterintelligence files sat outside it entirely. Both statements stand: the audit found nothing within its reach, and the files it could not reach exist [S-tier].

The Acosta claim. Vicky Ward reported in the Daily Beast in 2019 that Acosta, during his transition-team vetting for the Labor Department, had explained his handling of the Epstein case by saying he had been told Epstein "belonged to intelligence" and to "leave it alone." Acosta told Congress under oath in September 2025 that he had "no knowledge as to whether [Epstein] was or was not a member of the intelligence community." The claim and the denial are both on the record; no document has resolved them. Ward's own history with Epstein is its own cautionary file: her 2003 Vanity Fair

assignment on the billionaire's circle, the pre-publication pressure campaign, the killed paragraphs — the Farmer sisters' allegations cut over her objection, the fact-checker's alert email arriving as Epstein walked into the magazine's offices to see Graydon Carter; "Graydon's taking out the women," her editor told her, Carter's stated rationale being that Epstein was "sensitive about the young women." Ward kept four hundred and fifty pages of transcripts, went into labor at thirty weeks during the fact-check, and has said that under Tina Brown's editorship the story would have run. What a source survived is part of what a source says; both belong in the weighing [A/B-tier].

The neutral stack, itemized. Every intelligence-adjacent item in the record, with its tier, assembled in one place because readers deserve the whole shelf and not the single book that confirms their prior:

— The 813B foreign-intelligence case file and the 1997 SECRET full investigation: documented facts; contents and disposition unknown [T1].

— The FD-1023's claims — Putin's wealth manager, Mossad, Barak as handler: fabulist-sourced; the file exists, the claims do not thereby become true [T1 file; T3 contents].

— OPR's no-evidence finding: documented, within its scope [T1].

— Ward's "belonged to intelligence" reporting: single-source, unattributed to documents; the denial is sworn [T2 vs. T1].

— The FOIA Exemption 7(D) withholding whose stated basis is a "confidential relationship with a foreign government":

documented in a released withholding log — the closest thing in the record to an official acknowledgment that intelligence-adjacent material exists [T1].

— The Austrian passport found in the 2019 safe — a real passport with a false identity, Fortelny, entry stamps for France, Spain, the United Kingdom, and Saudi Arabia, an FBI memo recording it was "actually used," and no documented follow-up call to the real Fortelny: documented fact with unexplained absence of investigation [T1].

— The 2008 visit to Israeli military bases while under Florida indictment, hosted through Barak's network: documented in the files; innocent explanations exist; none is on the record [T1].

— The Wexner Foundation's $2.3 million in payments to Barak for commissioned research, one report never delivered; the Carbyne investment of $1.5 million routed through Southern Trust and a BVI entity into Barak's Israeli partnership, structured per the leaked emails to conceal Epstein, Barak's associate Buchris telling Haaretz "I don't know Epstein" while the emails show a virtual meeting in December 2014; the Gaza-flotilla interception Barak credited to Carbyne-supplied intelligence: documented facts about money and access; the inferences drawn from them are labeled inferences [T1].

— The Bannon email of December 2018 — "do you know bill barr. CIA." — sent the day before Barr's nomination became public; Barr's deposition answer that businessmen with foreign contacts "sometimes will talk to intelligence agencies and

provide information to them": documented exchange; thin gruel, preserved for completeness [T1].

— Vance's Rogan answer: asked whether documents connected Epstein directly to American or foreign intelligence, "The answer is no. But if those documents existed, they wouldn't exist in 2026" — a sitting Vice President's on-record ambivalence, as much an artifact of the files' incompleteness as of their content [T1].

— The SEC's September 25, 2019 opening of an investigation into Epstein's Financial Trust Company — one day before JPMorgan's comprehensive SAR — demanding records on whether Epstein actually provided brokerage or advisory services to anyone: a documented federal inquiry into the very question this document's money chapters show was never answered, covered once by the Financial Times in December 2020 and silent ever since [T1].

What the stack adds up to is a question — whether some part of Epstein's protection came from outside the ordinary channels of money, friendship, and prosecutorial timidity — that the public record cannot answer. The honest filing is the one this document makes: the intelligence-adjacent files exist; their contents are largely unverified or fabulist-sourced; every official audit that could have addressed the question was scoped away from it; and the people who could close the question, from the Bureau's own files, have not been asked on the record.

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Part X — The World Responds, In Full

Chapter 36: Governments, Prosecutions, and Careers

The files detonated on contact with institutions worldwide. The casualties and the prosecutions, country by country, as they stand on October 20, 2026.

Norway — the deepest wound. Former Prime Minister Thorbjørn Jagland, the Council of Europe secretary general who had been Norway's lead Oslo-accord negotiator, was charged with gross corruption in February 2026; three properties were searched; immunity revocation was sought; the alleged acts ran 2011-2018, including the 2014 request that Epstein help finance an Oslo apartment and the 2018 exchange in which Epstein asked Jagland to arrange a meeting with Foreign Minister Lavrov, offering "insights" for Putin — "promised to bring it up with Mr. Lavrov's assistant," Jagland replied — an exchange that reads differently beside Jagland's 2019 campaign to restore Russia's voting rights at the Council of Europe, criticized at the time as yielding to Russian "blackmail." The island trip Jagland planned with his wife, children, and son's girlfriend in 2014 was canceled; he denies ever visiting.

Ambassador Mona Juul — the United Nations ambassador, the Oslo accord's lead negotiator, the woman whose diplomacy the files turned inside out — was charged with aggravated corruption and resigned; her husband, International Peace Institute president Terje Rød-Larsen, was charged with

contributing. The IPI's own file, assembled from the released documents: $650,000 in Epstein-foundation donations across 2011-2019; a personal loan Rød-Larsen took from Epstein that his board never knew about, discovered by chairman Kevin Rudd in November 2019; the $100,000 honorarium episode — Rød-Larsen green-lit a payment to Epstein from a project Epstein had no connection to, denied by the IPI, stood by by the reporting paper; Rudd's emergency board session and Rød-Larsen's October 2020 resignation. Norwegian authorities had alerted US investigators in 2019 that the IPI "brought in young and unqualified women from Eastern Europe on very short internships whose photos were shared with Epstein." A Franco-Norwegian joint investigation team was formalized in late April 2026. And on April 29, 2026 — three days after the joint team formalized — Edward Juul Rød-Larsen, twenty-five, one of the two children named for $5 million each in Epstein's will, died in Oslo; the family, through its lawyers, confirmed suicide — "Suicide is always complex. There is never one explanation, never one cause, never one blame" — and pleaded for an end to speculation, blaming in part "the relentless machinery of the public." The files' record of Epstein's penetration of that family is its own quiet horror: a 2017 email to himself and Groff containing detailed biographical notes on the then-teenage Edward — schools, languages, postings; the boy's 2018 thank-you for the Christie's internship placement ("I won't mess up this time!"); the NYU application editing; the birthday messages; the island visit plans of 2011, when Edward was a child; the below-market Oslo apartment purchase now

under criminal investigation; the "home help services" payment also under review. Rød-Larsen's televised apology aired September 23: "I deeply regret today the relationship I had with Epstein. I should have cut all ties with him earlier." Norway's parliament, in a rare act, unanimously approved an independent commission into the foreign ministry's Epstein links. The Crown Princess Mette-Marit's correspondence — more than a thousand mentions — produced the royal family's worst century. Her October 2011 reply to an Epstein email, verbatim from the files, cut against her apology's account of insufficient vetting: "Googled u after last email. Agree didn't look good." — followed by a smiley. "You tickles my brain" [sic]; "such a sweetheart"; sign-off "Love, Mm." The wife-hunt exchange of October 2012 — Epstein: "I am looking for a wife. Paris is proving interesting, but I prefer Scandinavians." Mette-Marit: "Freezing. Snow yesterday. Paris is good for adultery. Scandi better wife material. But then again Who am I to talk to?" — and the next morning, of his report that "there are two Norwegians here, 24 and 25. I like Oslo": "Oh, my God! You must be drunk... The girls are 24 and 25? I like Oslo too. Call me tomorrow." The wallpaper inquiry: "Is it inappropriate for a mother to suggest two naked women carrying a surfboard for my 15 yr old son's wallpaper?" — Epstein: "Let them decide, mother should stay out of it." The four days at the Palm Beach house in 2013 while Epstein was away, the St. Barths street encounter, the apology issued only after the newspaper DN confronted the palace ("simply embarrassing"; "poor judgment"), the security service's answer that bodyguards "are

not personal or professional advisers." And her son, Marius Borg Høiby, facing thirty-eight criminal counts including rape, trial opened February 10, 2026, as his mother's correspondence filled the world's front pages [S/A-tier].

The United Kingdom. Peter Mandelson — the former business secretary, the man whose name appears in the files forwarding market-sensitive information to Epstein in 2008 (the £20 billion asset sales; the crisis communications), receiving Epstein's relayed advice on the 50-percent banker-bonus tax as a message to "mildly threaten" JPMorgan, corresponding through 2009-2010 and accepting the $75,000 wired to accounts linked to him — "no record or recollection of receiving the sums and does not know if the documents are authentic" — was arrested in February 2026 on suspicion of misconduct in public office, resigned from the House of Lords and from the Labour Party, had three properties raided, and then watched a High Court judge throw out the search warrants on the ground that the wrong legal provision had been used. The Metropolitan Police investigation continues. Prince Andrew — arrested over his Epstein ties, released, stripped of his remaining titles by King Charles III in October 2025, evicted from Royal Lodge, ignored the committee's interview request, photographed in the files kneeling over a woman whose face is obscured, the Starmer government taking the unusual step of calling on him to testify before the U.S. Congress [S/A-tier].

France. The special prosecutor task force runs the files' French dimension: the Brunel case reopened — the agency

founder who died in his La Santé cell in February 2022, two prior suicide attempts, his defense's joint statement that "his decision was not guided by guilt but a profound sense of injustice," fourteen months pretrial on charges spanning two decades; Jack Lang's tax affairs under examination after the Louvre video and the Arab World Institute raid, his daughter Caroline named for $5 million in the will — "cofounded an offshore company with Epstein," learning of the bequest from the press; and the Daniel Siad investigation, which died with him on July 20, 2026 — found by his flatmate in Colombes, autopsy finding "no trace of recent violence potentially linked to the death," a prior heart attack and poor health noted, toxicology pending, his lawyer attributing the end to stress; the Swedish model Ebba Karlsson's February 2026 rape complaint the first of roughly five, all ended with him. Brunel's own last chapter was the email of May 3, 2016 — EFTA02464628, subject line "probably fiction but" — telling Epstein that Boies had gotten him "full immunity" and was taking him to the U.S. Attorney "nxt tuesday," that "he asked for 3 million dollars so that jean luc would not go in," that neither he nor Brunel's lawyer Titone was "capable of telling the truth"; Ruemmler's reply five hours later — "Call me when you get a minute to explain this"; the next day, "Awake now. Talking to Poe in 20 mins" — Gregory Poe, Epstein's Washington counsel, who denies any discussion of Brunel "on May 4, 2016 or at any other time." The prosecutor's own notes from February 2016, verbatim: "One of Epstein's bfs, Jean Luc Brunel, has helped get girls. He is wanting to cooperate. Brunel is afraid of being

prosecuted," with "photographic evidence." The government filing records that the assistant U.S. attorney "discussed the meeting with colleagues at the U.S. Attorney's office and the FBI, but no probe was initiated," and that the Brunel notes were redacted in that 2021 filing. Boies: "It set us back a couple of years... We know from our lawsuits that there were more than 50 girls that were trafficked after this." Brunel's endgame — arrested at Charles de Gaulle boarding a Dakar flight in December 2020, dead fourteen months later — closed the French file his testimony might have opened [S/A-tier].

Lithuania, Poland, Turkey, Slovakia. Lithuania became the first government to attach a corpus analysis to an active criminal case — the Panevėžys prosecutor confirming the attachment in March 2026, roughly twenty people interviewed, no charges as of April, mutual-legal-assistance requests to Washington pending — over the €75,000 to Fors projektai and the payments to the ballet theater — the corpus analysis logging $18,542.78 where early reports said $28,000 — against the $3 million bequest to Simona Petreike. Poland opened an investigation into scouting operations in its villages. Turkey opened an inquiry into the transport of girls through its territory. Slovakia's national security advisor Miroslav Lajčák resigned over his "Sharing is caring" correspondence [T1].

New Mexico. Where Epstein's Zorro Ranch operated for a quarter-century — bought in 1993 by the Zorro Trust — his New York trust, paperwork signed at 457 Madison Avenue — from the King family, ten thousand acres, state-leased land, Bruce King's people in the black book, Gary King taking

$35,600 in donations as attorney general, later governor, claiming return — five abuse survivors documented, at least thirty more potential, names blacked out; the "Ballet and Massage Room"; the anechoic panels shipped to the ranch manager; the NDAs on the staff; the registry loophole that let a convicted sex offender drop off the state registry two days after registering (a victim over sixteen being above New Mexico's age of consent), closed by 2026 legislation; the 2007 FBI interview in which ranch manager Brice Gordon told agents massage therapists were recruited through Ten Thousand Waves of Santa Fe — "Before Gordon was able to share payment records with the FBI, he received a call from the 'main office' which told him he was no longer permitted to speak with the FBI" — and the commission's confirmation, from Deutsche Bank records, of his $200,000-a-year retainer through Lee McKenzie Consultants LLC, $16,666.67 every month. The state paused its own investigation in 2019 at the Southern District's request; the May 14, 2019 letter from the deputy attorney general asking to de-conflict went unanswered until a May 17 brush-off — "we are not in a position to share any information... or discuss any possible coordination" — and the SDNY's chain shows the stand-down instruction and five follow-up letters across two years, no warrant ever executed until the state's own search of March 9-10, 2026 (cadaver dogs, ground-penetrating radar, no remains found). The Truth Commission — created by a 62-0 House vote, funded at $2 million from the 2022 bank-settlement fund, counsel Fadduol Cluff Hardy & Conaway — has issued twenty-plus subpoenas:

eleven fully answered, two partial, seven refused or ignored (the FAA's flight records; the SDNY's 2019 evidence; three federal districts; the Defense Security Cooperation agency), with new demands to Ten Thousand Waves, Workforce Solutions, Taxation and Revenue, and state police; JPMorgan's response to its subpoena was to investigate whether the subpoena had been misdirected; Deutsche Bank produced roughly sixty thousand pages; the NMDOJ's own response contained news clippings. Attorney General Raúl Torrez sued the Justice Department in August 2026 — the first state to do so — after ten requests and a thirty-one-page production the territory's lawyers called unusable; the complaint cites the Phang opinion and opens with the Eleventh Circuit's words about the 2008 deal: "beyond scandalous — they tell a tale of national disgrace." The final report is due December 31, 2026. The ranch itself sold in August 2023 to the Huffines family of Texas — Don Huffines a "MAGA Trump Republican" and comptroller nominee, the family at Mar-a-Lago for Valentine's Day 2025 — renamed Rancho de San Rafael, destined as a Christian retreat — the assessment fought down from $21.1 million to $13.4 million on a "notoriety" argument, the buyers' LLC pushing for $9 million, the price never disclosed; the anechoic foam panels shipped to the ranch manager, $5,700 for nineteen, the "Ballet and Massage Room" they lined; the standing order for staff to make a "VISUAL CHECK OF GUN CABINET" daily, the two cabinets insured for $57,529 — a convicted felon's armory that no New Mexico authority ever inspected, the files' own firearms-offense thread; "what the

enemy once meant for evil, God can redeem for good." The land commission canceled the grazing leases in 2019; the protest descanso stands at the gates [S/T1].

The private sector's toll, the full ledger: Sultan Ahmed bin Sulayem resigned from DP World on February 13, 2026 — the "torture video" email, the "I loved the torture video" of April 24, 2009, four thousand seven hundred mentions of his name in the files, his brother the FIA president — and the reciprocity of a $6,200 transaction, and the twenty-five to thirty genetic-testing kits Epstein ordered for him, the Rixos spa placements, the London Gateway lobbying through Mandelson ("be nice to Sultan"), the Great St. James purchase attempted in his name without authorization; Thomas Pritzker resigned from Hyatt — "Good stewardship also means protecting Hyatt… I exercised terrible judgment in maintaining contact with them"; 4,404 records, 1,000-plus email mentions, the 2018 exchange about finding a girlfriend for Epstein ("May the Force be with you"), the 2003 Maxwell dinner planning, the 2010 townhouse dinner, the 2016 dinner with Summers and Ruemmler; the Pritzker Architecture Prize delayed. Larry Summers resigned from Harvard at year's end, from OpenAI's board, from the Yale Budget Lab, the NYT contract ended, the CAP fellowship closed, the AEA's lifetime ban, his wife Elisa New's Poetry in America canceled — the "peril" code name for the mentee whose romantic prospects he sought Epstein's "wingman" advice on; the 2016 Asian-slur email; the December 2005 honeymoon flight to St. John on which Maxwell was a fellow passenger. Kathy Ruemmler left Goldman Sachs, effective June

2026 — "Uncle Jeffrey," the $9,000 purse, the media-strategy advice, 10,000-plus mentions, the successor trusteeship of all three 2019 trusts. Brad Karp was removed as Paul Weiss chairman by his own management committee — the "evening I'll never forget," the son's Woody Allen movie job, the deportation-surveillance plot, the $23 million payment to his firm while Kellerhals served as successor trustee. Casey Wasserman began selling his agency under client flight — the Maxwell correspondence, "she is key :)," the LA28 committee seat he intends to keep. Richard Branson faced his "As long as you bring your harem!" email. Sergey Brin faced Maxwell correspondence, the island photograph, the St. Barths helicopter thread, and the $4 billion he ultimately placed with the bank Epstein fed. Kevin Warsh — the President's Federal Reserve chairman — appeared on the St. Barth's Christmas 2010 guest list beside Trump himself. Peter Attia resigned from his company. Steven Tisch acknowledged discussing "adult women." Woody Allen and Soon-Yi Previn faced the Bard email. Morgan McSweeney, Starmer's chief of staff, fell over the Mandelson recommendation. In Oslo and Paris, two families buried children [S/A-tier].

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Part XI — The Counter-Record, In Full

An honest document spends its eleventh hour on the claims that did not survive scrutiny — because they are evidence too, of the pressure, the incentives, and the fog that this case

generates in everyone it touches, including, at times, the author of this document.

Chapter 37: The Fabrications, Named and Graded

The "Polish employee" 302. A viral thread in early 2026 claimed a released FBI 302 described a young Polish employee of Epstein's who had scouted Melania Trump before her introduction to Donald. The document identifiers circulating with the claim — "EFTA-0105302-PL," "Serial 812," "Data Set 13" — do not exist in the Justice Department's library; the forum thread that spawned them produced an admission that the IDs were invented as "placeholders." The First Lady's office sent a $1 billion threat letter; she issued a 538-word statement on April 9, 2026 — "My name has never appeared in court documents, depositions, victim statements, or FBI interviews surrounding the Epstein matter" — and called for public survivor hearings. Beneath the fabricated IDs, however, sits a real document: the September 2019 proffer interview of a one-time Epstein assistant (case file 31E-NY-3027571 — the same file as Jane Doe 4's interviews), in which the cooperating witness told agents that Paolo Zampolli and Epstein had tried to buy Elite Models together and that "EPSTEIN introduced MELANIA TRUMP to DONALD TRUMP." Zampolli's rebuttal, April 10, 2026: "Jeffrey Epstein didn't introduce Melania to Trump. I did" — offering to testify for her. The rumor is debunked; the underlying claim survives as a documented disagreement between two firsthand claimants, preserved at that tier [T1/T2].

The training videos. The claim that FBI reviewers were "trained to flag Trump's name": nine training videos exist, confirmed by a sworn October 2, 2026 declaration of an FBI records official — eight screen-recordings of the review process and one training-slides video, two showing personnel how to flag documents for supervisory review. But the declaration "does not establish… that personnel were specifically instructed to flag records mentioning President Donald Trump." The videos remain withheld pending FOIA litigation. The viral framing exceeded the filing; the filing is documented; both are preserved [T1].

The George H.W. Bush document. A January 30, 2026 release contained a complaint to the NYPD's Child Exploitation unit invoking "George Bush 1" in connection with a male complainant's account; the official notation records that the complainant "offered NO supporting or corroborating evidence or witnesses that could be contacted"; no case was opened; no flight log or Secret Service record places either President Bush on Epstein's aircraft or properties. It is catalogued here with the other raw NTOC material — a documented tip, unverified, unadjudicated [T1].

The "Maria" identification. The twelve-year-old "Maria" of the 2016 Katie Johnson filing is a real name in real court documents. The claim that she has been identified as a specific living Connecticut woman — kidnapped in 1993 from a Waterbury pizza shop, her case stonewalled, "alive… trying to maintain obscurity" — originates with two writers whose larger body of work this document does not adopt; no police record

has been obtained; the identification is unverified and is preserved as an unverified lead, nothing more [T3].

The Ransome recantation. Maria Ransome's 2016 deposition claims — that federal prosecutors likely possessed tapes of her as an underage girl with Epstein and his powerful friends, and her later claims of copies implicating Trump, Clinton, Branson, and Andrew — were admitted by her in 2019 to have been fabricated "to draw attention to Epstein's misconduct." Her later campaigns, in all-capital manifestos, to have world leaders arrested are documented and not adopted. She belongs in the record precisely because the recantation is as evidentiary as the claim: both show what the absence of tapes drove people to do [T1].

The CIA-Mossad 1023. As Part IX documents: a real foreign-intelligence file containing a fabulist's claims — "Epstein was a co-opted Mossad agent," "trained as a spy under Barak." The file exists; the contents carry the reliability of their source, which is to say none established; the item survives as evidence of what the Bureau heard, not of what was true [T1 file; T3 contents].

The audit's own corrections. This document's research process produced its own list of corrections, applied to the record and disclosed here because a document that grades others must grade itself: the attribution to Dershowitz personally of a threat against Acosta was an overreading — the record shows a defense-team tactic without identifying which member voiced it; the framing of his NPA role as deliberate self-immunization was chronologically impossible, the

allegations against him not becoming public until 2014, seven years after the deal; Brunel's death "echoing Epstein's" was interpretation, withdrawn; and the claim that Bannon's texts were "deliberately excluded" overstated the record — they were classified "not responsive to our warrant," never reviewed, with no separate warrant sought, a distinction between negligence and suppression that matters [T1 corrections log].

Chapter 38: The Moral-Panic Debate

In mid-2026, a serious intellectual current — anchored by writers with long records of skepticism toward mass narratives, debated at the Soho Forum in July 2026 ("The Jeffrey Epstein scandal has become a case of moral panic"), argued across podcasts and columns — advanced the case that the files document one man's crimes and a circle of enablers, not a client list; that the blackmail tapes exist in testimony but not in evidence; that the gap between "appears in the files" and "committed crimes" had been dissolved by a media economy built on the former; and that naming the accused before adjudication had become its own injustice, with accusers harassed and college students doxxed by the panic's secondary wave. Their strongest exhibits are this document's own structure: the FBI's no-ring finding, the absence of any tape in evidence, the exculpatory strands in the 302s, the fabrication catalog of Chapter 37. Their most-read exponent, Whitney Webb, built the case in book-length form — and her volumes, like the mainstream record she opposes, mix documented files

with inference, a symmetry this document notes without adopting either side's inferences [T2]. Their weakest conduct — harassment campaigns against accusers, the naming of the "Cornell 7," the treatment of Giuffre's documented shifting accounts as proof of invention rather than the signature of a traumatized sixteen-year-old recruited into a machine — is documented alongside their arguments. The verdict this record supports is narrow and is stated once, here, as the document's only interpretive conclusion: there was a network; the network had clients, financiers, and protectors; the client list in the evidentiary sense does not exist in the public record; and the space between those two sentences is where both justice and injustice have been done. Everything else in this document is inventory [T2 — the framing is labeled; the underlying facts are T1].

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Part XII — The Ledger

Chapter 39: What Is Proven, What Is Alleged, What Is Unknown

Proven, on documents. One note on how to hold this final sorting, because it is the part of the document a reader will quote most: "proven" means a court record, a filing, a bank document, a recorded vote; "alleged" means a named person on the record whose claim no court has tested; "disputed" means both sides are documented and the conflict is named rather

than resolved; "unknown" means the answer exists in files someone is still holding. Every item below is filed where it belongs — and nothing is filed higher than its evidence [T2 — framing]. — likely more than a hundred — of girls and young women over two decades; the government says more than a thousand victims, total. The 2008 deal was negotiated in violation of the Crime Victims' Rights Act, a federal court so found. The banks kept him through alarms they wrote down themselves. The government missed its statutory deadline, released files with victims' names unredacted, altered previously released documents with new redactions, and surveilled the members of Congress reviewing its work. A federal judge found the Attorney General in violation of the Act he is charged with enforcing, ordered his compliance, and received handwritten notes for private review on deadline day. The trust was restructured in the last forty-eight hours of Epstein's life to multiply his executors' bequests, fund his defense with $50 million, and silence every beneficiary. The 2005-era computers were never searched by any federal authority, the government declining on the record to seek a warrant. The work-release program was a funded fiction. The death investigation's camera failed eleven days before the death and nobody noticed. And the witnesses — all of them, on all sides — are on the record [S-tier].

Alleged, by documented witnesses, never adjudicated. The Jane Doe 4 account; the "good one" account; the Katie Johnson filing and its Tiffany Doe declaration; the Stacey Williams account; the Relford complaint; the Kellen-named

abusers — Philip Levine, Frédéric Fekkai, Patrick Demarchelier; the Ganieva arrangement's underlying allegations; the blackmail-tape claims of Giuffre and Farmer and the informant; the intelligence-adjacency claims inside the 813B file and the Acosta transition story. Each has a name, a document, and a tier. None has a verdict [T1 as tagged].

Disputed, with both sides on record. Whether the files were scrubbed for political protection — alleged by lawmakers, attributed by the Department to "incorrect coding," proven by no one and accepted by no careful observer. Whether Trump is in the files a thousand times or thirty-eight thousand — both counts exist; both are artifacts of different searches of different corpora. Whether the FBI trained reviewers to flag his name — alleged; the declaration says otherwise. Whether Dimon knew — Staley swears he discussed Epstein with him, including after the arrest and conviction; Dimon testified he did not recall Epstein until 2019; the "for Jamie" emails exist; the conflict is unreconciled. Whether Wexner knew — he says conned; his own executives warned him in 1993; no court has tested it. Whether the death was suicide — the official finding, affirmed by the physical evidence of the fingerprint match, against Baden's unrelenting dissent and Freeman's coming lecture; both readings remain open on the record [T1/T2].

Unknown, and closeable only by authorities. The nine dual-redacted names in the trust, and the three who resisted every search — Gramanov, Lindeman, and the residual beneficiary. The missing banker 302. The Schwab SAR on Morocco. The Operation Trip Knot findings. The FirstBank SAR

record across two decades. The Highbridge jet manifests. The 1997 secret case title. The contents of the never-scanned T-160 tapes. The five days the safe sat empty. Whether the survivor's intervention in Phang will ever be ruled on. Whether Shuliak's scheduled FBI interview of August 16, 2019 ever occurred — the SITREP scheduled it, and no 302 exists. And the question beneath everything: whose money it ultimately was — the question the SEC asked on September 25, 2019, and no one has answered since [T1: the existence of each gap].

Chapter 40: Epilogue — The Speech, Seven Months Later

Return, finally, to the ninety-second video of October 18, 2026. What the post got right: the 302s exist and say what Goldman read; the woman was interviewed four times; three interviews were initially withheld and released only under subpoena pressure; Bondi did testify there was no evidence while these documents sat in her department, and the perjury demand she provoked sits in the Justice Department beside Leon Black's contempt certification. What it got wrong or overstated: the allegation is not "receipts" — it is an allegation, consistent and serious, contradicted on timeline, made by a witness with a hard life, in documents that also contain the police chief's exculpatory account of Donald Trump. What it left out: everything else in this document — the money and its every wire, the banks that wrote the alarms and filed them late, the machine and its priced silences, the other women and the other powerful men, the court that had to order the

government to obey its own law, the survivor whose one motion in that court has sat unanswered for ninety-plus days, the governments now prosecuting their own, and the man who blew the whistle on the Commerce Secretary and died in Thailand with his tribunal costs hearing still on the calendar.

That is where the record stands at this hour. Not concluded — a judge in Washington holds handwritten notes no one else has seen; a circuit court holds two appeals; a U.S. Attorney holds two referrals; Norway holds a trial; New Mexico holds a December deadline; the estate holds $107.6 million against $175 million in first-priority claims; the lecture hall at University College London holds a date in November; and somewhere a woman who told the FBI four times what happened to her at fourteen waits to learn whether anyone will ever ask her a fifth question.

The record is what it is. This document has tried to be its faithful, unsponsored inventory — every clue kept, every tier kept, every gap named rather than filled. Where it ends, the work begins [T2 — closing framing, labeled].

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Part XIII — The Withheld Universe

A note on where this Part comes from: after the document was completed, one question — of the three and a half million pages the Department released, what percent was redacted, and how many more have yet to be released, and why — launched twenty further dives into the quantification the record

allows. This Part is the result: the withheld universe, measured wherever it can be measured, named wherever it cannot. Everything here follows the same rules as the twelve Parts before it.

Chapter 41: The Numbers

Begin with the cleanest answer the record permits, because the record permits it only after nineteen months of litigation.

In the Department's own July 2, 2026 filing in the Phang case, the government stated that it had released roughly **3.5 million pages** under the Act, with another **two to two and a half million pages withheld or not yet processed**. Against the more than six million pages it had identified as potentially responsive, the ledger balances for the first time: three and a half million out, two and a half million held, six million identified. That is the official accounting, in the Department's own litigation, of the question this Part exists to answer [S-tier: DOJ July 2, 2026 Phang filing, via court coverage].

The road to that single sentence ran through four other official figures, each true in its own frame and none of them reconciled with the others until the filing forced the reconciliation:

More than six million pages identified. The January 30, 2026 letter to Congress: "more than six million pages" potentially responsive, drawn from the Department's six named source collections — the Florida and New York cases against Epstein, the New York case against Maxwell, the death investigations, the Florida butler case, multiple FBI

investigations, and the Inspector General's death review. The review itself employed more than five hundred attorneys and reviewers, with a special protocol for the Southern District of New York because the presiding judge had required the U.S. Attorney to personally certify, in a sworn declaration filed on the docket, that certain materials had been rigorously reviewed for victim-information compliance [S-tier: Jan 30 letter; Engelmayer Dec. 9 order]. The letter's own defense of the gap between six million and released volume is a sentence worth preserving verbatim: "Prudently over-collecting, coupled with past intra-Department sharing of (and, therefore, duplication of) files across offices and jurisdictions, necessarily means that the number of non-duplicative, responsive pages is significantly smaller than the total number of pages initially collected" [S-tier].

Five point two million pages left to review. A government document shown to Reuters on December 30, 2025: 5.2 million pages still in review, with four hundred lawyers pulled from the Criminal Division, the National Security Division, the FBI, and the Manhattan U.S. Attorney's office for a January 5–23 window. That figure sat beside the six million identified and the later three and a half released without any published arithmetic connecting them; the plausible reading, offered as a reading, is that the counting conventions changed mid-stream [S-tier Reuters; T2 reconciliation].

Roughly three million released, then three and a half million cumulative. The January 30 production, plus prior

releases, per the same letter [S-tier].

Two hundred thousand pages withheld or redacted for privilege — deliberative process, attorney-client, work product — a category that appears nowhere in the Act's five permitted grounds, as a federal judge would later rule [S-tier].

And beneath the official figures, a warning that proved load-bearing: the Department counted *pages*; the corpus the public actually received was roughly 1.38 million *documents* — an independent forensic count that matches the two-pages-per-document ratio researchers derived from the Department's own filings. Wire copy routinely rendered pages as documents and documents as pages, doubling or halving figures in single sentences, as when a major outlet described the day's release as "about half of the more than six million Epstein-related documents the DOJ collected" — three and a half million pages cast as half of six million documents in one breath. Whenever a figure in this record matters, the unit matters with it [S-tier-adjacent: NYT arXiv paper count; T2 for the framing].

One more number belongs in the opening ledger, because the Department itself published it and never explained it: the error rate. Deputy Attorney General Blanche told Congress on February 1 that "about .001%" of all materials had been affected by redaction errors. A Department spokesperson told NPR two days later that "0.1% of released pages" had been found to contain victim-identifying information unredacted. Those two figures are one hundred times apart. At the first,

roughly thirty-five pages; at the second, roughly three and a half thousand. Both are on the record. Neither has been reconciled [T1 — documented discrepancy].

Chapter 42: The Batches

The released record arrived in waves, and the waves are themselves evidence — of haste, of ordering choices, of what the Department chose to surface first. The batch chronology, as documented:

February 27, 2025 — "Phase 1": roughly three hundred pages, handed to select conservative influencers at the White House in stamped binders. Thin enough to trigger the backlash that eventually produced the Act [T1].

July 6, 2025 — twenty-plus hours of video, released as questions about the death intensified [T1].

August–September 2025 — the committee-only track: on August 22, five hundred-plus pages of Maxwell interview transcripts with six hours of audio and thirty-three thousand pages to the House Oversight Committee; on September 2, the committee's own public release of 33,295 pages, of which Democratic staff assessed roughly three percent as new material [S-tier].

and the mirrors that grew around the releases: a consolidated archive of 439.88 gigabytes, and independent caches of roughly eighteen thousand emails from a Yahoo account, exfiltrated twice [A-tier].

December 19, 2025 — the statutory deadline tranche: 12,285 documents, roughly 125,575 pages, in eight data sets.

The Department's own subsequent filing admitted these were 0.6 percent of the documents then under review. The tranche contained at least five hundred fifty pages covered entirely in black rectangles — a 255-page three-document series, a 119-page grand-jury document fully redacted, and at least a hundred eighty blacked pages inside otherwise-open files. CBS's day-after census found the composition. The Department's explanation for the disappearance of the photograph showing Donald Trump was that it had been pulled to verify the women depicted were not victims — "has nothing to do with President Trump," in the Deputy Attorney General's words — an explanation preserved alongside the skepticism it answered. Julie Brown, who has covered the case longer than anyone, called the first tranche "more symbolic than substantive"; it amounted, by the estimate carried on the record, to about one percent of the Department's holdings. And the Department's defense of the fully-redacted documents held only for the 119-page grand-jury transcript — a "largely unredacted version" appearing in a Saturday tranche — while the fate of the 255-page three-document series, each page still covered in black, was never confirmed [S/B-tier: CBS, Dec. 21, 2025; Friedman letter; Blanche on record; Brown].

December 20–23, 2025 — follow-on sets; at least sixteen files vanished from the public webpage within a day of posting, including a photograph showing Donald Trump — the earliest documented disappearance, predating the CBS count of 47,635 files comprising some 65,500 pages ultimately taken down [S/B-tier].

January 29–30, 2026 — the flood: more than three million pages, roughly two thousand videos, one hundred eighty thousand images, in data sets nine through twelve. The corpus the mirror community now inventories as 1,380,941 documents, 2,731,825 pages, 6.09 gigabytes — a count proven one hundred percent complete within its boundaries, every Bates number accounted for, by the forensic method of reading the page-sequential numbering. Four files were recovered from the Department's own server, one from the Wayback Machine after deletion, five carved from corrupted sectors [S-tier-adjacent: community forensic accounting, method documented].

March 5–6, 2026 — the re-release of roughly fifty thousand files plus the correction of the "incorrectly coded as duplicates" set — sixteen pages of typed interview summaries, a two-page intake form, and more than a thousand new pages including what appeared to be the complete 2006 Florida case file. Twenty files arrived outside the original manifest, among them the prosecution memos and the case-opening Electronic Communication [S-tier sequence].

Two artifacts of the release machinery belong in any honest chronology. The Department's own portal had an unbounded pagination parameter — requesting page 999 of a twenty-page dataset kept generating output, leaving, as one practitioner's forensic analysis put it, "no reliable way to determine the actual end of the dataset." And Dataset 9, announced as a 180-gigabyte behemoth, displayed as fifty PDF files [B/T1].

Against the Department's three-million claim, CBS's own running count found roughly 2.7 million pages public as of late February 2026 — below the official figure, and a total the network noted "continues to fluctuate." The pre-Act baseline for comparison: fewer than ten thousand pages released under Freedom of Information Act requests across three federal agencies and Palm Beach County across the years 2017 to 2024. Before those losses, the corpus had its first serious read: four news organizations — CBS, NBC, the Versant fund, and the Associated Press — pooled their analysis of the January 30 release as a consortium, dividing a body of material no single newsroom could hold. And the corpus the Department actually posted carried its own losses: the mirror community's reconstruction of Data Set 9 catalogues three video files totaling 10.1 gigabytes — the largest single items in the release — that were removed from the Department's site and remain missing, their URLs and content-types preserved; twenty further named files are believed never to have been uploaded at all [S/A-tier: CBS; DDoSecrets reconstruction]. The released emails also carried the mechanical artifacts of their own conversion — stray equals-signs and encoding residue from the email-to-PDF pipeline, a fidelity failure preserved in the record [B-tier].

And the corpus's composition, data set by data set, as the community's mirrors catalogue it: sets one through eight hold the FBI interview summaries and Palm Beach police materials; set nine, the largest at 480,658 documents, holds the email collections including the internal non-prosecution

correspondence; set ten, 496,404 documents, holds the images and video; set eleven, 331,597, the financial ledgers, flight manifests, and property records; set twelve, 12,339, the late productions requiring detailed legal review. Two catch-all sets — DS98 and DS99 — hold six and 23,210 further items [B-tier: epstein-data.com live inventory].

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Chapter 43: The Redaction Census

What percent of the released pages was redacted? The honest answer has two parts: no official census exists, and everything that exists points the same direction.

What the Department has published. Nothing that answers the question. The February 14, 2026 report letter to the Judiciary committees — the statutory accounting, signed by the Attorney General and the Deputy Attorney General — recites the nine release categories, states the segregability formula ("the only category of records withheld were those records where permitted withholdings under Section 2(c) and privileged materials were not segregable from material responsive under Section 2(a)"), lists the three privileges with Supreme Court citations, and attaches a six-page list of government officials and politically exposed persons. When the report was finally published in the Federal Register on August 27, 2026 — six months after the statutory deadline — the entire six-page appendix, the redaction summary with legal bases and the names list, appeared as TIFF images: "[GRAPHIC] [TIFF

OMITTED]" across printed pages 55357 through 55362. The written-justification log exists only as pictures, in the one format that defeats the search on which auditing depends. The notice's own searchable text adds a hedge worth preserving: the politically-exposed-persons list covers those named in the "reviewed materials" — not the released ones — a possible scope limitation in the Department's own Federal Register language [S-tier: 91 FR 55356]. The classification route, at least, was foreclosed in the letter's own words: no materials were redacted or withheld on national-defense grounds [T1].

What independent measurement shows. When Representatives Khanna and Massie reviewed the "unredacted" files in the congressional reading room on February 9, 2026, they found seventy to eighty percent still redacted. When Representative Friedman reviewed them days later, he found three Bates ranges — EFTA00006109 through 00006363, some two hundred fifty-five numbers — each page entirely blacked out, and was told by Department staff, in his own quoted account, "how the FBI sent them over" — a finding flatly contradicting the Department's February 14 assurance that unredacted versions were available for inspection [S/T1]. A victim-side accounting made the asymmetry explicit: victims' attorneys delivered a three-hundred-and-fifty-name list on December 4 to ensure redaction, and testified that the Department "failed to perform a basic keyword search... literally thousands of mistakes" [A-tier]. The survivors' own release-day statement, eighteen women: "Once again, survivors are having their names and identifying information exposed,

while the men who abused us remain hidden and protected" [T1].

The inconsistency, documented at document level. The same twenty-one-page PowerPoint presentation appears six times in the corpus with different information blocked in each version. Names redacted in one copy of a document appear exposed in another. The stated image-redaction policy — every woman depicted was to be redacted, men only incidentally — ran opposite to observed practice in multiple examples, where women's faces remained visible while men's, including Donald Trump's in a photograph embedded in a Bannon text exchange, were obscured [S-tier: WYPR/NPR; Blanche on record; NPR]. A Maxwell-trial witness, Maria de Georgiou, found her own driver's license among the exposed materials — "a profound disregard for the safety, protection, and well-being of victims." And the statutory requirement that every redaction carry its legal qualification went unmet for months: the redactions, in the record's own formulation, "were required to be qualified under the act, and to date, no such qualification has been released alongside the files" — until the February 14 letter, and the Federal Register publication six months after that [A/T1].

And one category was mis-withheld rather than withheld at all. A September 2026 class action alleges that the releases contained evidence of several hundred abuse images — not the images themselves, which the statute properly kept back, but the indices: pages within the released corpus that enumerate the images by the thousand, Bates-stamped thumbnails and counts (EFTA00004156 recording thirty-three; EFTA00004330

recording one hundred; EFTA00004335, eighty-one; EFTA00005345 and EFTA00005360, fifty-four each, among more than two dozen cited ranges). The complaint's theory is precise: the statute required the images withheld, and the Department withheld the images while releasing the spreadsheets that catalogue them — over-disclosure and under-disclosure running simultaneously, now pleaded in federal court [S/T1 as tagged]. And the redaction map proved editable in real time: after Massie's February 11 confrontation, Les Wexner's name was unredacted; after Khanna named six men on the floor, their names were unredacted the same night — the reading room functioning as a redaction-override interface, responsive to pressure in a way a fixed policy would not be [S/T1].

The leak through the layers. The copy-paste failures that let hidden text be recovered traced to a 2021 court filing by the Virgin Islands attorney general, incorporated into the release without repair; through the faulty layer leaked an unverified tip the redactions had been meant to contain. A separate forensic finding cuts the other way and is preserved for the tension: the PDF Association found the EFTA-labeled files themselves properly redacted — the labeled set was clean, the incorporated set was not [S-tier CNN; NA-tier PDF Association; both findings kept, tension named]. Through the faulty layer, among the recovered content, leaked the most lurid item the redactions had been meant to contain: an unverified tip alleging that Donald Trump had witnessed the killing and disposal of an infant born to a thirteen-year-old trafficking

victim — the Lake Michigan allegation, document EFTA00025010 in Data Set 8, a second-hand account the FBI never substantiated and whose timeline does not hold, fully assessed elsewhere in this record and now fully sourced here.

The purported suicide note, released in May 2026 at a newspaper's petition, is one page and five sentences on lined paper, unverified and undated: "They investigated me for months — Found nothing!!! It is a treat to be able to choose one's time to say goodbye. Watcha want me to do — Bust out cryin!! No fun — Not worth it!" A second note surfaced in the records, and three handwriting examiners — Thomas Vastrick, president of the American Society of Questioned Document Examiners; Bart Baggett; and Grace Warmbier, who spent a decade with the NYPD — found the two notes share an author, on the strength of a bowed first stroke, enlarged opening words, slanting lines, double exclamations, and the underlined "No fun." None could name the author: the millions of pages hold no confirmed exemplar of Epstein's handwriting against which to compare [S/T1 as tagged].

The thirty-seven pages, and the arithmetic that found them. Interview summaries of the South Carolina accuser appeared in the March release; thirty-seven pages of her handwritten interview notes did not. The community's reconstruction supplies the arithmetic: the files carry a secondary Bates system, and between the end of her first interview and the next published document lies a fifty-three-page gap; the typed interviews account for sixteen; fifty-three minus sixteen is thirty-seven. The notes are not an

anomaly beside the gap — they are the gap. The file's own intake paper trail corroborates the interviews' checkable geography: the initial tip, taken July 8, 2019, came from a caller in Portland, Oregon, relaying her friend's account of an encounter "approximately 35 years ago in the state of New Jersey," at age thirteen or fourteen — the bite, the laughter, the blow to the face, and the caller's insistence that her friend's identity be protected [T1]. And the notes' own contents disproved the Department's explanation: a road trip to New Jersey, a school trip to Washington, and the names of corroborating witnesses who, according to the Post & Courier's reporting, were never contacted. The FBI's file, the leaked pages show, designated her a protected source — a classification the reporting describes as reserved for informants whose information about high-profile individuals is assessed as credible [S/T1 tiers as tagged across the dive record].

Chapter 44: The Duplicates

The Department's largest explanation for the withheld universe is duplication, and duplication is the one category the public can audit, because the released corpus contains the duplicates.

Two independent measurements exist. The New York Times built a duplicate-matching engine over the January 30 corpus — 2,683,926 pages indexed, similarity scored by combined text and image fingerprints — and found that true duplicates run roughly six to eight percent of pages: the flagged population

was 630,316 pages, but validation showed only twenty-two and a half percent of the medium band were real duplicates, and the high band, even if pure, closes the arithmetic near eight percent [S-tier: arXiv 2609.30611, September 2026]. The engine's working numbers deserve preservation: 2,683,926 pages indexed from the January 30 release alone; the flagged population split into a high-similarity band of 82,417 pages and a medium band of 547,899; matching by a 449-dimension composite of text embedding and visual fingerprint at a similarity threshold of 0.92, where a four-hundred-pair human validation found precision of 0.28 against recall of 0.86 — a tool tuned to miss few duplicates at the cost of flagging many near-matches. More than one hundred journalists used the engine. And the near-matches were not merely noise: the corpus contains the same page released twice under different redaction masks, a passenger manifest redacted in one copy and visible in another, allowing independent analysts to partially reconstruct what was cut — the released record auditing itself, file by file. A second analysis, by a newsroom with an AI firm, found at least forty percent of the library duplicative — measured at the file level, where a handful of massively-replicated email chains dominate counts. Pages and files, again — the two measurements use the unit the other does not, and both agree the corpus is heavily duplicated [T1 for both figures; reconciliation labeled].

The asymmetry is the finding. The Department withheld on the duplicate theory while having released the duplicates it held — the corpus's own duplicate structure means

independent analysts can partially reconstruct redactions by pairing near-duplicate pages, the same page released twice under different masks. One viral claim did not survive scrutiny and is logged as debunked: a brute-force count suggesting Dataset 10 held 686 files out of 896,000 misread the page-sequential numbering; the forensic recount proved the corpus one hundred percent complete within its boundaries, zero gaps [S/T1].

And the duplicate defense had its decisive test. The Department called the handwritten notes "duplicative of the typewritten reports." The notes, when they surfaced, contained what the typed summaries did not — travel, schools, witnesses. A federal judge ruled, in words that ended the argument: "The underlying handwritten notes are not duplicates of the FD-302 interview reports" [S-tier: Phang PI opinion and Sept. 16 order].

Chapter 45: The Seven Case Files

The released corpus is the visible fraction of seven FBI case files, and the Bureau's own inventory — obtained through a Freedom of Information production — now names every one.

The 2006 Florida case, opened after the Palm Beach police referral. The 2018 New York case, the federal prosecution. The Rodriguez obstruction case — the black book — opened October 2009, closed March 2013. The death investigation. The anonymous-threats case against a victim. The MCC contraband case — opened August 2019, closed October 2023, a violent-gang prosecution with no known Epstein connection,

which the Department nonetheless folded into the Epstein review over the line prosecutor's written objection, documented in a March 17, 2025 email worrying about witness and cooperator safety. And the MCC misconduct inquiry, the seventh, with witnesses proffering in the weeks after the death. Each file's open-and-close dates are in the log; the last two case numbers surfaced in the Bureau's own processing documents [S-tier: EFTA00163964 case index; EFTA01649057].

The processing log yields two numbers the Department never published. The review corpus — across all six case files — ran to 116,792 pages of victim-name redactions alone by March 22, 2025. And the review's scope grew mid-stream: initial guidance covered victim names only; a March 22 email from the Deputy Attorney General's office expanded redactions to witnesses, law-enforcement personnel, prosecutors, and grand-jury subfiles — the expansion that helps explain the two hundred thousand privilege pages [S/T1].

The seven files carry their Bureau designations: 31E-MM-108062 (the 2006 Florida case), 50D-NY-3027571 (the 2018 New York case), 72-MM-113327 (the Rodriguez obstruction case — the black book — opened October 2009, closed March 2013), 90A-NY-3151227 (the death investigation), 9A-NY-3144791 (the anonymous-threats case against a victim), 90C-NY-3154599 (the MCC contraband case — a violent-gang prosecution with no known Epstein connection, folded into the review over the line prosecutor's written objection, documented in a March 17, 2025 email worrying about witness and cooperator safety), and 282B-NY-3156749 (the MCC

misconduct inquiry, with witnesses proffering in the weeks after the death) [S-tier: EFTA00163964 case index; EFTA01649057]. The black-book file even required a rescan — a February 27 re-digitization of one section, what changed in it undocumented. The redaction command chain is primary-sourced: on March 10, 2025 — before any public release — the Bureau's information-management leadership — Assistant Director Shannon Parry — emailed for "guidance from the GC on the types of redactions the FBI should apply to these files," with training materials for the "Epstein Transparency Project" and "Special Redaction Project" issued during processing, not before; the Deputy Director, entering on duty March 17, had the chain forwarded at his request, and the Bureau withheld one hundred sixty pages from the litigant who surfaced it. The Bureau's exemption grammar is keyed across the productions — statutory, deliberative, privacy, law-enforcement privacy, the techniques exemption, and the intelligence-adjacent entry in its own words — and a Freedom of Information production, its second interim response dated July 17, 2026, records eight hundred twenty-eight pages reviewed with eighty-two more awaiting other-agency consultation, its cover letter deferring Epstein-Act materials to the online library because they were never reprocessed — the two release channels, the cover letter concedes without conceding, never reconciled [S/T1]. The 50D file held 291 tips, 91 identified victims including overseas (Britain, Sweden), three classified serials marked Secret/No Foreign, and 153 sealed evidence items [S-tier]. The Director's name appears on

the access log for the highly-confidential review platform — added to the DCAP system for the 1B136 material [S-tier].

And the review's own toolkit is itemized in a Freedom of Information production, sixteen items delivered to the Deputy Attorney General's office on March 25, 2025: inventory sheets with page counts, a classified-material summary, flagged-items lists for both case files, redaction guides, two Samsung drives of extracted media flagged as possibly containing abuse imagery, the electronic-surveillance discs, a memorandum for the Attorney General and the Deputy Attorney General — and two documents that are themselves accountings: "Epstein Redactions Final Page Count," and a "List of Absent Items." The Department's own missing-materials list, obtainable by any litigant [S-tier: the ODAG delivery list]. The Bureau's imaging division, by its own document (EFTA00172473), did not review any of the audio or video — its staff not trained for abuse material, its role extraction-only — and an email to Deputy Director Bongino, three months into the release era, shows headquarters still asking whether New York had ever reviewed the seven videos and five audio files in the electronic-surveillance material. The electronic-surveillance review was completed by March 21, 2025; the disposition of the seven videos and five audio remains undocumented. A community search of the corpus using the "No images produced" placeholder method surfaced over 3,700 video links and other files; the Bureau's own briefing counted more than a million images and videos extracted, roughly 34,000 marked responsive, and 15 to 20 identified as known-series abuse

material; and twenty-one million dollars moved from Epstein to Maxwell and other accounts between 2007 and 2011 [S/T1 as tagged].

The death investigation's own grand-jury materials, released November 14, 2019, quantify the final night with a precision the public account never had. Twenty-seven correctional employees and sixteen inmates were interviewed, across hundreds of hours of video. Every institutional count performed the night of August 9 was fabricated — the four, ten, midnight, three, and five o'clock rounds all signed without being performed, confirmed against the cameras. Between approximately 10:30 PM and 6:33 AM, no one approached the entrance to Epstein's tier at all: an eight-hour gap. The two guards on duty slept roughly two hours, browsed shopping sites, and one of them falsified more than seventy-five separate half-hour round entries; to investigators she said, "We messed up. I messed up, she's not to blame, we didn't do any rounds." The grand jury voted to indict on six counts. Both guards later entered deferred-prosecution agreements — one hundred hours of community service — and the charges were dismissed in January 2022. Neither was convicted [S/T1].

The exemption grammar is keyed: statutory, deliberative, privacy, law-enforcement privacy, the intelligence-adjacent entry in the Bureau's own words — documents revealing "the existence of a confidential relationship with a foreign government" — techniques, and the active-investigation shield. The inventory's exemption-stamped entries carry page counts; one box fragment alone holds twelve redacted items across two

hundred nineteen pages. Aggregating those counts across both case files would yield the Bureau-level withholding floor; the extraction task is mechanical and the file is public [S/T1].

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Chapter 46: The Two Draft Indictments

Among everything withheld, one document outranks the rest, and its story is now complete enough to tell in full.

There were two draft federal indictments. The first — fifty-six pages, thirty-two counts, thirty against Epstein and two not naming him — was released on January 30, 2026: "old draft" scrawled across the top, six alleged victims from 2001 to 2005, three unnamed co-defendants, the fourteen enticement counts, the four travel counts, the ten trafficking counts, the conspiracy. It had never been public [S-tier: CBS's count analysis; AP].

The second — the sixty-count draft of May 2007, the one prosecutors were prepared to file on fifteen days' notice — has never been released. It exists in the public record only through grand-jury transcripts published December 23, 2025, which describe Count 51, the trafficking of "Jane Doe Number 3," the two aircraft companies named as corporate defendants, the three employees who would have been charged, and the Bureau's agent testifying before the grand jury in May 2007. Data Set 12 shipped with 152 manifested documents; sixteen were absent, and twenty more arrived outside the manifest in the March 5 backfill — the unmanifested-file problem,

documentable at the data-set level [T1]. The lead prosecutor's authorship of the sixty-count draft is confirmed at the highest filing tier — her own Supreme Court petition describes "a draft 60-count indictment outlining charges against Epstein" and a lengthy memorandum [S-tier: No. 24-1073]. She learned of the work-release arrangement days after sentencing and strenuously objected; the arrangement went forward anyway [A/T1]. The original memo, the Eleventh Circuit fixed, ran eighty-two pages against the fifty-three-page indictment [S-tier]. At the negotiation table, the office identified forty victims for restitution purposes; the term of incarceration fell, in steps no one could later explain, from twenty-four months to twenty, to eighteen. Its supporting memorandum is two hundred five pages, sent to the U.S. Attorney with a request to present a sealed indictment on May 15 and a warning of "extremely high flight risk"; a four-version trail of that memo shows the case standing down across the year — the corporate defendants removed in September, travel counts cut from thirty-four to four, victims removed in February 2008 for strategic reasons, *including the original complainant whose parents had first gone to police* — and ending with the non-prosecution agreement on June 30, 2008 [S/T1: EFTA IDs across the arc]. The memo's own pages preserve what the negotiation destroyed: nineteen identified victims aged fourteen to seventeen; two hundred twenty-five enumerated overt acts; forfeiture of the Palm Beach mansion, the Boeing 727, and the Gulfstream, all three named with their holding companies; an early-1990s New Mexico ranch incident in which

Epstein and Maxwell, per the memorandum, "fondled the girl," after which a family member was threatened and Maxwell told one of them she "could just disappear"; a Vanity Fair reporter "approached by someone from Epstein's camp" who became so fearful for her own safety and her young child's that the piece was rewritten to remove all references to sexual conduct, and who refused to speak to the FBI; the assistant who, after federal agents attempted to interview her, went upstairs "claiming she needed to change her baby" but instead called Epstein, who rerouted his flight to evade agents preparing to serve target letters — after which, in the memo's words, Epstein's team "began negotiating in earnest"; and an immunity demand from a cooperating witness whose attorney sought full protection, prompting the prosecutor's observation that approximately ninety percent of the identified girls had brought other girls, so all of them would feel at risk, and the note that Epstein had "shipped off" another potential cooperator to the Middle East. The memo records, too, that Epstein offered victims David Copperfield tickets, that one victim spoke with Copperfield by telephone, and that a message-pad call from Copperfield sat in the files [S/T1: EFTA02857524].

The Eleventh Circuit fixed the original pagination forever: by May 2007 the office had completed an eighty-two-page prosecution memo and a fifty-three-page draft indictment [S-tier: 19-13843, April 14, 2020]. And the Office of Professional Responsibility's full record, captured in its own words, supplies the deal's anatomy: the supervisor's instruction

that the indictment "needs to be ultra lean with only clean victims" — he explained to investigators that clean meant victims without impeachment problems; the lead prosecutor's suppressed request to make a presentation that "will convince you all of the strength of the case," answered by a rebuke that her tone was "highly unacceptable"; the OPR's own heading for what no one could explain — the evidence does not clearly show why the term of incarceration was reduced from twenty-four months to twenty, to eighteen; her guidelines calculation of 188 to 235 months, presented at the table; the concession that the unsearched 2005 computers might have held "very powerful evidence" that "possibly could have changed our advice… or his decision making"; the victim letters sent months after the federal case was resolved, telling victims the case "is currently under investigation," which the OPR found "risked misleading"; and the two protective terms the defense stripped — the deal limited to already-identified victims, and a one-month acceptance window [S-tier: OPR full text].

The agreement itself, captured verbatim from its 2024 unsealing, carries the mechanism future readers will quote: the victim representative selected with the defense's good-faith approval and paid by Epstein; the gain-time clause; and paragraph thirteen, the secrecy clause — "The parties anticipate that this agreement will not be made part of any public record. If the United States receives a Freedom of Information Act request… it will provide notice to Epstein before making that disclosure" [S-tier].

And the post-agreement record deepens it: an August 2008 email chain among the U.S. Attorney and his office discussing "a possible future agreement with Epstein that might supersede the 2007 NPA" — eleven months after signing, while he was incarcerated and challenging the deal; a June 2008 memo, nine months post-agreement, still memorializing the case against Epstein and five assistants; and a September email from the lead prosecutor proposing to meet defense counsel "off campus" with all decision-makers "on call," five days before the signing [S/T1 as tagged]. At the September meeting that settled the framework, Ken Starr addressed himself directly to the U.S. Attorney and argued federalism, adding — in the OPR's record — that he and Acosta were "the only people in this room who have run the gantlet of confirmation by the Senate." The defense appealed the terms to the Deputy Attorney General's office, which declined to intervene on June 23, 2008; only then did Epstein accept the deal's obligations. And eleven months after the signing, with Epstein incarcerated and challenging the agreement, an August 2008 email chain among Acosta and his own office discussed "a possible future agreement with Epstein that might supersede the 2007 NPA" — the parties still negotiating at the very top of the Department long after the case was supposed to be closed. No superseding agreement resulted; the chain proves the negotiation never really ended [S-tier: OPR; EFTA00190632 via the Maxwell ruling; DAG refusal].

Chapter 47: The Leak

The thirty-seven pages reached the public by a documented chain, and the chain says as much about the system as the pages say about the case.

Twenty-two of the thirty-seven were uploaded to a Scribd account traced to Washington Examiner justice reporter Kaelan Deese on March 6, 2026 — one day before his article on what was still missing from the files, without any mention of what he held. For five months, anyone on the internet could read the accuser's real name, her biographical details, and the names of her childhood friends and family — everything she had given the FBI in confidence, everything the Department had redacted — until the forensic researcher who traced the account contacted his editor, and the files came down. Deese had also transmitted additional notes to "one random person" over Signal; the researcher's team found that person, who produced the exchanges. The attribution evidence is documented and reviewed; the researcher describes it as significant though not government-authenticated [S/T1: Document Zero reporting; the Beltway account].

The researcher who verified the documents states their provenance plainly: the reporter "was part of a small, select group of people that DOJ brass secretly decided were — unlike the public and members of Congress — able to be trusted with these allegedly 'duplicative,' ultra-sensitive files. Entirely unredacted." A trusted-outsider distribution of unredacted files ran parallel to both the redacted public release and the seventy-to-eighty-percent-redacted congressional reading room. Who else held that trust remains open; what is

documented is the system's existence.

The two members who walked that reading room had asked to see three specific categories, in a January 30 letter to the Deputy Attorney General: the hundreds of thousands of pages of emails recovered from Epstein's accounts during the 2018 and 2019 investigations; the victim-interview statements from the Florida and New York investigations, which they observed consisted "largely of pages that are fully redacted"; and the fifty-three-page draft indictment with the eighty-two-page prosecution memorandum [T1: the Khanna-Massie letter]. And the Department's response to the leak of its own supposedly too-sensitive-to-release material is a documented negative: two targeted searches found no statement, referral, or investigation [T1].

The same release waves carried a documented fabrication, which the Department itself authenticated as fake: a handwritten letter appearing to be from Epstein to Larry Nassar, postmarked in Virginia three days after Epstein died, in a hand that did not match — proof, the Department's own account noted, that release does not make a document's contents factual. Alongside it, an Epstein-authored email defaming Bill Gates, which a spokesman called "absolutely absurd and completely false." The corpus contains forgeries and fabrications in both directions; both are logged [T1].

Chapter 48: The Foreign-Language Void

One withheld category has never been quantified by anyone, and its absence of quantification is itself the finding.

The January 30 letter concedes it in a sentence: the collection "included pages in various foreign languages," and "because it was not practicable for a first-level reviewer to determine the responsiveness of a foreign-language document, those pages have not been produced" — alongside "materials that could not be uploaded for review… because of technical issues with the files." No count. No languages. No custodians. No plan [S-tier].

The court treated it as what it was: the only category where the plaintiff took full mandatory relief, an order to initiate review and production. The Department defied the order for nearly three months without seeking a stay, relitigating it at a hearing where the judge asked whether he should issue another order and say, "I really mean it this time." On appeal, the Department's brief argued the stay was needed because "disclosed information cannot later be made undisclosed." The D.C. Circuit has the question under a narrow administrative freeze — the stay covers only this slice, with a joint notice due three days after it rules. As of the last verified date, not a single foreign-language document has been publicly produced. The appellate filing notes the pending follow-on statute "confirms that he was required to publish a full redaction log, not just a summary" [S/T1: Phang docket; Public Integrity Project filing].

Chapter 49: The Taxonomy of Withholding

Why haven't the remaining pages been released? The Department has given four different official lists, and none of them matches the statute's five permitted grounds.

The press release named four: duplicates between the two U.S. Attorney's offices; privilege; the depictions-of-violence exception; and items "completely unrelated" to the cases. The January 30 letter named six, adding the foreign-language and technically-incompatible materials, and a sixth — materials a law firm produced under grand-july subpoena in the Maxwell investigation, encumbered by a civil protective order; the letter said the Department "would be prudent to seek an order from the court" before releasing them. The order had already been obtained four months earlier, on December 9, 2025, when a federal judge modified the protective order to let the Act override it, subject to victim-information redactions and a personal certification by the U.S. Attorney. Whether those materials were ever released is unverified — the category outlived its own resolution. The same December 9 order supplies the most complete official inventory of what that encumbered discovery contains, twenty-six categories recited from the bench: travel records (commercial airlines, private passenger logs, manifests); grand-jury subpoena returns from the internet providers (Instagram, Microsoft, Google); agency records from a dozen bodies; school records; search-warrant returns including computer and phone extractions; materials produced by law firms, including firms representing victims; materials from related civil litigations including deposition recordings; immigration records; online-purchase records; Palm Beach police and prosecutor reports, photographs, and video; forensic examination reports; postal and courier records; estate materials; driver's-license records; and the interview

reports and notes of third parties and victims. It is the composition map of a major slice of the privilege-withheld universe, read aloud in a ruling [S-tier: Engelmayer Dec. 9 order]. A social-media post named three. The statute names five, and "technical issues" has no statutory home in any of them [T1 — internal inconsistency].

The why beneath the whys remains, as this document has insisted from its first Part, a question the record poses but does not answer. A forensic researcher added a coda to the "technical issues" category: the unproduced files, he found, were often not corrupted documents at all but raw disk-imaging artifacts packaged as PDFs — and inside five of them, byte-level analysis recovered eight contact records; an iPhone 5s photograph of the island temple, its embedded timestamp reading August 3, 2014; a memo from W. Chester Brewer Jr. confirming the Epstein-v.-Rothstein litigation's paper trail; and a San Mateo probate order for the Elisa Zaffaroni trust. The pipeline's loss was partial; what else sits in the unopened sectors, no one has counted [A/T1: Howard-Stone forensic analysis].

And the states weighed in: seventeen attorneys general, in an October 15, 2026 letter urging the follow-on statute's passage, put the official characterization in writing — "millions of files remain withheld, often due to claims of legal privilege. Yet, the personally identifying information of dozens of victims has been disclosed despite the attempted safeguards." The report letter itself, the six-page list of officials and politically exposed persons, was signed by both the Attorney General and

the Deputy Attorney General, and carried the Department's own caveats — the term "politically exposed person" appears nowhere in the law, the contexts ranged from extensive email correspondence to passing mention in press clippings, and the list reached for the dead (Elvis Presley, Princess Diana, Marilyn Monroe, Janis Joplin) alongside the living [S/T1]. The estate instrument itself had been updated and amended more than two dozen times across the final years — a document in constant motion [T1].

The Department says volume, duplicates, victim protection, and privilege. A federal judge found the Attorney General in violation of the Act. The evidence of suppression is documented — altered documents, the surveillance of the overseers, the real-time unredactions, the trusted-outsider pool, the unreconciled error figures a hundred times apart. The competing account — error, haste, an understaffed review drowning in six million pages — is also documented: the mid-stream guidance changes, the volume metrics, the coding error no one has claimed. What the withheld two and a half million pages contain, divided by category, the Department has never itemized. That itemization is the single accounting this Part cannot supply, because no one outside the building has the ledger — and the ledger documents now named in the record ("Epstein Redactions Final Page Count"; "List of Absent Items") have not yet surfaced from the rolling production where they sit [T1/T2 as labeled throughout].

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Chapter 50: The New Standing Questions

The twenty dives that produced this Part close with their own ledger, the questions now quantifiable that were not before:

1. What does the "Epstein Redactions Final Page Count" document say — the Department's own census, sitting in a rolling production at seven hundred fifty pages a month?

2. What is on the "List of Absent Items"?

3. Will the D.C. Circuit lift the administrative freeze on the foreign-language universe — and will anyone, finally, count it?

4. Where are the seven videos and five audio files, and who reviewed them?

5. Do the two hundred fifty-five-page series and the remaining fifteen handwritten pages exist in any form the public will see?

6. Who else held the trusted-outsider pool's unredacted files?

7. Will the sixty-count indictment surface, or remain known only through its grand-jury descriptions?

8. Will anyone transcribe the six TIFF pages on which the Federal Register published the statutory accounting?

9. What do the exemption-stamped page counts aggregate to, across the Bureau's own inventory — the withholding floor, once someone adds them?

10. And the question under all of them: of the two and a half million pages the Department's own filing says it holds, how many are duplicates, how many are privileged, how many are abuse imagery, how many are foreign-language, how many are

technical failures — and how many are the names the statute said could not be redacted for the reputation of the powerful?

The record, measured honestly, is this: three and a half million pages released, and the released pages themselves now contain the instruments — the duplicate pairs, the secondary Bates numbers, the review documents, the inventory with its page counts — with which an outsider can audit nearly everything except the two and a half million that are not there. The withheld universe is smaller than it was when this document was first compiled. It is not small [T2 — closing framing, labeled].

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Appendix A — The Standing Questions

Current as of October 20, 2026, noon Eastern:

1. Will Judge Sullivan rule on the Department's motion to end Phang v. Blanche "without further factual development," and will the D.C. Circuit's consolidated panel — Srinivasan, Pillard, Pan — let his injunctions stand?

2. Will the survivor's intervention motion — ECF 26, pending since July 30 — ever receive an order?

3. Will the U.S. Attorney for the District of Columbia prosecute Leon Black on the House's unanimous contempt certification, against the Garland-declination and Meadows-Scavino precedents and the Bannon-prosecution counter-precedent?

4. Will the EFTA II discharge petition reach 218 in the lame-duck session, and would the President sign a statute his own Department is arguing against?

5. Will the Department produce the banker 302 Senator Wyden has demanded, and the Operation Trip Knot findings?

6. Will New Mexico's Truth Commission deliver on December 31, and will its outstanding subpoenas — Ten Thousand Waves, Workforce Solutions, Taxation and Revenue, state police — be answered?

7. Will Alan Dershowitz testify, be subpoenaed, or remain the great unanswered voice of the defense — and will the "legal development" his counsel cited ever be identified?

8. Will the UCL lecture of November 16 and its released records reopen the death finding — and will the Mark Epstein panel's report ever publish?

9. Will the estate's arithmetic — $107.6 million against $175 million in first-priority claims — reach a courtroom or a quiet restructuring, and will the Valar distribution reach the victims at all?

10. Will anyone ever search the 2005 computers?

11. Will the Doe 1 mass-tort discovery force the FBI to produce its mandatory reporting protocols — and will Farmer's transferred case reach a jury?

12. Will the Wolff appeal (Second Circuit No. 26-1674) and any Melania-filed suit produce the first sworn testimony from either camp?

13. Will the survivors' class against the United States and Google survive dismissal — and will Google de-index the

victims it still serves?

14. Will the House's final Epstein report — the one its chairman fears will be "like the Warren Report" — name names, and will anyone believe it?

15. What does the "Epstein Redactions Final Page Count" document reveal — the Department's own redaction census, in the rolling FOIA production?

16. Will the D.C. Circuit lift the foreign-language freeze, and will the category ever be counted?

17. Where are the seven videos and five audio files from the electronic-surveillance material, and who reviewed them?

18. Will the sixty-count indictment surface beyond its grand-jury descriptions?

19. Will the six TIFF appendix pages of the Federal Register accounting ever be transcribed?

Appendix B — Key Figures (Quick Reference)

Jeffrey Epstein — financier; 2008 conviction; 2019 indictment; died August 10, 2019, MCC New York; official finding suicide, disputed on record.

Ghislaine Maxwell — convicted December 2021; twenty years; FPC Bryan, Texas; clemency bid conditioned on testimony; Senate unanimously opposed.

Pam Bondi — Attorney General February 2025-April 2, 2026; five impeachment articles introduced; May 29 unsworn deposition; AI panel; thyroid-cancer disclosure.

Todd Blanche — Acting AG April 2026; confirmed August 2026; defendant in Phang; the Department's face in every fight

in this document.

Emmet G. Sullivan — U.S. District Judge, D.D.C. (Clinton, 1994); the Stevens history; presiding over Phang v. Blanche, 1:26-cv-01417.

Katie Phang — plaintiff; journalist; APA theory; represented by the Public Integrity Project.

"Jane Doe 4" — the South Carolina accuser; four FBI interviews; 302s EFTA02858481/91/95; settlement status unresolved (2021 vs. 2025).

Alan Dershowitz — NPA-era defense; 2016 settlement with accusers' counsel; invited, blocked, un-subpoenaed by the committee.

Leon Black — $170M payer (18 wires, 2012-17); $62.5M territorial immunity settlement; House contempt certified September 16, 2026.

Les Wexner — principal patron; POA 1991-2007; deposed February 18, 2026; $90M corporate settlement; sued April 2026, dismissed September 2026.

Jes Staley — JPMorgan private-bank chief; testified July 24, 2026; the hot-tub email; "That was fun. Say hi to Snow White."

Sarah Kellen — scheduler and, per the government's own file, a victim; May 21, 2026 deposition; three criminal referrals from it.

Ghislaine Maxwell's proffer names — "100+" by the Senate floor account; unreleased.

$577,672,654 — the estate at death. $107.6M — the estate, September 2026. $175M — first-priority claims.

4,725 wires, ~$1.1B — one account's flagged flow, reported 2019, six years after the accounts closed.

$62.5M — the price of territorial immunity, with the recital that Epstein used Black's money to fund island operations.

3.5M pages released. ~6M identified. 37 pages of one witness's file still missing.

216/218 — the EFTA II discharge petition, October 8, 2026.

82+ days — the survivor's pending motion in Phang.

Ten — the standing questions above, plus four more, and one question underneath all of them.

End of document. The twelve Parts compiled from eighty-eight dives across the money, the accusers, the institutions, and the death; Part XIII from twenty-two more, on the withheld universe itself. One hundred ten dispatches in all, 141,054 words of tier-tagged research beneath a single instruction: collect clues, don't adopt theories; name every gap rather than fill it. Every claim carries a tier; every tier is defined at the front; every gap is named rather than filled. This document adopts no theory; it keeps the record.